FRANCE

Government, Structure, Corruption, and Current Affairs —
An Organized Investigation

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An organized investigation into the French government, its structure, its corruption files, and its current affairs — compiled from eighty-three research dives conducted in October 2026, in the days between the autumn budget battle and the October 2026 unrest. Everything in these pages carries a source pedigree. Nothing is invented. Nobody is blamed; evidence is gathered, money is followed, and names are named.

THE RECORD STANDS AS OF OCTOBER 19–20, 2026. This is a dated snapshot taken mid-crisis, not a living document: the budget vote, the curfews, the Le Pen cassation ruling, the Sarkozy appeal verdict (November 30, 2026), the MoDem verdict (December 17, 2026) and the 2027 election were all still moving as these pages closed. Every date in the text is the date of the record consulted, and later developments belong to a future edition.

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HOW TO READ THIS DOCUMENT

This is not a polemic and not a summary. It is a dossier written to be read from beginning to end, the way one reads a long account of how a country actually works — and every dossier in it is told at full depth: the dates, the names, the amounts, the procedural steps, and the exact words people used, because the details are where the truth lives.

Every number comes from a named institution — the Cour des comptes, INSEE, the Senate, the Conseil constitutionnel, a court judgment, a parliamentary report. Where sources disagree, the disagreement is shown rather than hidden. Where a claim could not be verified, it is marked as such and, where it proved false, formally struck.

Source grades: **S-grade** means official institutions, statutes, or court records. **A-grade** means major newsrooms with document-level reporting. **NA-grade** means single-source or unverified, always flagged. One honest limit, stated plainly: for many dossiers — the Uber Files, the McKinsey probe, the deeper court records — the reporting was verified for consistency across multiple independent outlets, but the primary filings (court files, parliamentary reports in full) were not opened directly; the chain of custody is journalistic, and readers deserve to know that. French terms are defined at first use, because this document is written for everyone — including readers who have never followed French politics — and the drama makes sense only if the machinery is understood first.

The document moves in six parts:

1. **The Machine** — how the Fifth Republic is built, who runs it, and the debt beneath everything.
2. **The Chain of Fallen Governments** — June 2024 to October 2026, the deepest institutional crisis since 1958.
3. **The Corruption Docket** — every major case at full depth, with verdicts.
4. **The Money Pipeline** — where money comes from, where it goes, who touches it.
5. **The Patterns** — the structural regularities that repeat across decades.
6. **The Current Affairs Ledger** — consolidated: the 2027 election, foreign policy, the economy, security, and the social emergency.

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A NOTE ON OPEN PROCEEDINGS. Where a case is closed, this document reports the verdict as found, with its dates and its arithmetic. Where a case is open, the person is described as charged, suspected, investigated, or a candidate under procedure — never as guilty — and the words alleged, per the prosecution, or which he or she denies are used as the record provides. In France as elsewhere, an investigation is not a conviction, and this document treats that distinction as load-bearing. Several public figures discussed here were convicted by final judgment; several others were acquitted or had their cases dismissed; the text says which, every time.

KEY FRENCH TERMS USED THROUGHOUT

A quick reference, so no reader needs to stop and search. Each term is also explained where it first appears in the story.

- **Assemblée nationale / député** — the lower house of parliament and its members (like a congressman).
- **Sénat / sénateur** — the upper house, elected indirectly; members are senators.
- **Président / Premier ministre** — the president (elected by all voters) and the prime minister (appointed by the president, answerable to parliament).
- **Département / commune / région** — France's three local-government layers: county, town, region.
- **Décret / arrêté** — two levels of government regulation below a law: a decree (national) and an order (ministerial or local).
- **Préfet / préfecture** — the state's appointed representative in each département, and their office.
- **Lycée** — the public high school; its students are *lycéens*.
- **Bourse** — the state student grant.
- **Ehpad** — *établissement d'hébergement pour personnes âgées dépendantes*: a state-regulated nursing home.
- **SMIC** — the statutory minimum wage.
- **49.3** — the constitutional clause letting a government pass a bill without a vote.
- **Motion de censure** — the no-confidence motion that can topple a government.

- **PLF / PLFSS** — the annual budget bill and the social-security financing bill.
- **LPM** — the multi-year military programming law.
- **RIP** — the referendum of shared initiative: a citizen-demanded vote on a law.
- **QPC** — the priority question of constitutionality: a citizen route to challenge laws before the Constitutional Council.
- **CJIP** — the *convention judiciaire d'intérêt public*: the negotiated settlement that lets a company pay its way out of prosecution.
- **Mise en examen** — formal charging (placement under investigation) by an investigating judge.
- **Garde à vue** — police custody.
- **Témoin assisté** — "assisted witness": a status between witness and suspect.
- **Détournement de fonds publics** — embezzlement of public money; **blanchiment** — money laundering; **recel** — receiving stolen goods; **trafic d'influence** — influence-peddling; **prise illégale d'intérêts** — illegal conflict of interest.
- **Pantouflage** — the revolving door between senior public office and private industry.
- **Grands corps** — the small elite schools-and-corps system that staffs the state's summit.
- **OQTF** — *obligation de quitter le territoire français*: a deportation order.
- **Parrainage** — a mayor's or elected official's sponsorship, required to run for president.

- **Front républicain** — the traditional closing of ranks against the far right in a runoff.
- **Casseurs** — the "breakers": rioters who loot and torch amid protests.
- **Reste-à-charge** — what a patient pays out of pocket after insurance.
- **Restos / CROUS** — student restaurants; the CROUS is the state student-services agency.

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CONTENTS

- PART ONE — THE MACHINE
- PART TWO — THE CHAIN OF FALLEN GOVERNMENTS (2024–2026)
- PART THREE — THE CORRUPTION DOCKET
- PART FOUR — THE MONEY PIPELINE
- PART FIVE — THE PATTERNS
- PART SIX — THE CURRENT AFFAIRS LEDGER (CONSOLIDATED)
- APPENDIX — THE NUMBERS WORTH KEEPING

PART ONE — THE MACHINE

1.1 The Fifth Republic: a system built for a man, still running on his design

France's current constitution dates to 1958. It was written for Charles de Gaulle to end the paralysis of the Fourth Republic, which had burned through twenty-one governments in twelve years — an average of seven months per government, each falling the moment its parliamentary coalition frayed. The Fourth Republic's flaw was pure parliamentarism: governments served at the pleasure of the assembly, and the assembly had no stable majority. The Fifth Republic's designers solved this not by fixing parliament but by sidelining it. The result is a hybrid — a presidential system wearing a parliamentary costume — whose stability depended on one thing: a president who commands a majority in the National Assembly. French constitutionalists call this the *fait majoritaire*, the majority fact. Part Two of this document is the story of what happens when that fact disappears; nothing in the constitutional text changed, and yet, in the words of the constitutional scholar cited there, "the France changed regimes."

The presidency. The president is elected directly by the people for five years — the *quinquennat*, reduced from seven by the 2000 referendum specifically so presidential and legislative terms would coincide and the *fait majoritaire* would reproduce itself automatically. The office commands the armed forces, appoints the prime minister (Article 8), negotiates and

ratifies treaties, can dissolve the National Assembly (Article 12), can submit referendums to the people (Article 11), and — under Article 16 — can assume emergency powers when the republic's institutions, independence, or international commitments are threatened in a grave and immediate manner. Article 16 has been invoked exactly once: from April 23 to September 29, 1961, during the Algiers generals' putsch, when de Gaulle ruled by special powers, created special tribunals, censored, and dismissed officials at will. The Conseil d'État of the day refused to review his acts. A 2008 constitutional revision finally leashed the article: the Constitutional Council must now review the conditions of its use at thirty and sixty days.

The prime minister and the government. The prime minister "directs the action of the government" and is responsible before the Assembly (Article 20) — the only genuinely parliamentary feature of the system. In normal times, the president sets direction and the prime minister runs the state. In *cohabitation* — when the president loses the assembly — the roles invert, and the prime minister becomes, in effect, the head of the executive. France has lived through three cohabitations (1986–88, 1993–95, 1997–2002); what has happened since 2024 is not cohabitation but something the text never contemplated: no majority at all, for anyone.

Parliament, deliberately weakened. The National Assembly has 577 deputies elected for five years by two-round majoritarian vote in single-member constituencies — a system that manufactures majorities from pluralities and punishes

third parties. The Senate's 348 senators are elected indirectly, mostly by an electoral college of local officials; its composition structurally overrepresents rural and small-town France, which is why it has been a conservative fortress for most of the Fifth Republic and why, as of September 2026, it remains the only institution the far right does not threaten. Article 34 defines what law may cover — everything else is left to government regulation by decree (Article 37), which is why French governments govern without parliament far more than most democracies can. The 2008 constitutional revision did add genuine powers: the opposition controls committee chairs and inquiry commissions proportionally, and any law can be challenged after promulgation by the *question prioritaire de constitutionnalité* (QPC), a citizen-originated filter routed through the Conseil d'État to the Constitutional Council.

The system's tools, in ascending order of drama:

- **Article 49.3** allows the government to pass a bill without a vote unless a censure motion carries within twenty-four hours. The tally through February 2025: 115 uses since 1958. Michel Rocard used it 28 times (1988–91, governing with no majority — the historical precedent for today); Élisabeth Borne 23 times in twenty months, the per-time record, including the 100th use of all on March 16, 2023, for the pension reform. Barnier used it once — fatally. Bayrou used it twice in one day (February 5, 2025: budget and social security, surviving with 128 and 122 censure votes, six Socialist rebels defying their party to abstain). Lecornu used it once (January 20, 2026, on the revenue half of the

2026 budget) after pledging publicly he would not. Only once in the Fifth Republic has a censure motion succeeded — against Pompidou in 1962, after which de Gaulle dissolved and won a bigger majority. The never-users include Jospin, Fillon, Ayrault, Chaban-Delmas, Messmer and Couve de Murville.

- **Censure motions.** More than 115 tabled across the republic's history; the success rate is one. Borne faced roughly thirty of them, the modern record — each one a day of parliamentary theater that costs the government nothing and the country something.
- **Dissolution** (Article 12). The president may dissolve the Assembly and call elections. Used in 1962, 1968, 1981, 1988, and 1997 — the last of these — Chirac's 1997 dissolution, which produced five years of cohabitation against his design — and then, on the night of June 9, 2024, by Emmanuel Macron. Everything in Part Two flows from that evening.
- **Article 16** emergency powers (detailed above) and the 1955 *état d'urgence* statute: used in Algeria in 1955 and 1958, for one day in Wallis in 1987, in New Caledonia in 1984–85 after the assassination of the Kanak leader Machoro and in 1988 after Ouvéa; proclaimed by Chirac on November 8, 2005 during the banlieue riots, validated by the Conseil d'État against an open letter from 74 law professors, and extended three months; proclaimed by Hollande on November 14, 2015 after the Bataclan, extended six times until November 1, 2017 — the longest state of emergency

ever, under which 1.6 million home visits and thousands of house arrests preceded the SILT law absorbing the powers. The March 23, 2020 sanitary emergency decree belongs to the same family. On October 19, 2026, curfews were ordered without any of these instruments — by ordinary prefectural police power, a first in the crisis (Pattern Fourteen).

- **The Constitutional Council** — nine members, nine-year terms, one-third appointed by each of the three presidents (republic, assembly, senate). Since March 8, 2025, its president is Richard Ferrand, elected by a single vote — the former Socialist-turned-macronist who shepherded Macron's 2017 legislative program as Assembly president. The current college: Ferrand flanked by Bas, Vichnievsky, Gourault, Séners, Malbec, Mézard, Pillet, Juppé, with Aurélie Bretonneau as secretary general. The workload has exploded: 81 decisions in 2025 (55 QPCs) against 42 in 2024, with 26 *saisines* — a fifteen-year record — and 11 more in the first half of 2026. The institution is now simultaneously attacked by the left, the right, and the far right, and the jurists' own review calls the new college "accordée à la droitisation de la France" — attuned to the country's rightward turn — while noting Fabius had pushed Barnier's justice minister Migaud for his own seat in vain. The late-quinquennat placement pattern — Ferrand at the Palais-Royal, Montchalin at the Rue Cambon (see 2.3), Guillaume at the Conseil d'État — the Élysée defends as "sécuriser les institutions."

- **The Conseil d'État**, supreme administrative court and the government's legal adviser, led since May 21, 2026 by Marc Guillaume — "the first fonctionnaire of the Republic" — an ENA graduate (promotion Victor Hugo, 1991), legal chief of the Defence Ministry 1995–2002, Justice civil-affairs director 2002–2007, secretary general of the Constitutional Council through the Debré era 2007–2015, Élysée secretary general under Hollande then Macron 2015–2020, and prefect of Paris through the Olympics and the Seine cleanup 2020–2026, co-author of a standard constitutional-law reference. He carries two shadows preserved in the record: the 2020 accusations of sexism from Élysée advisers, and his Sciences Po board resignation in the Duhamel affair.
- **The Conseil supérieur de la magistrature**, the judges' council, where the president sits ex officio — a structural fact that mattered in the Clearstream affair, when a sitting president was partie civile in a case touching his own interests while presiding over the judges' council (Part Three).

The deeper machinery: the grands corps. Beneath the elected layer, France is run by a few hundred graduates of a handful of schools — the ENA (renamed INSP in 2022), the Inspection des Finances, the Cour des comptes corps, Polytechnique — who circulate for entire careers between ministries, ministerial cabinets, the Élysée, the banks and industry, returning to their corps whenever politics ends. The Conseil constitutionnel's own constitutional-law literature states the mechanism plainly: of the roughly 700 *très hauts*

fonctionnaires of the central decision milieu — Grémion's term — only a fraction is discretionary, and "le ministre choisit presque toujours des personnes issues des grands corps," both because the corps press to keep the posts in the family and because the minister needs the network. The detachment regime enables the endless ping-pong; France matches Germany, the Netherlands and Belgium in imposing no limit whatsoever on civil servants holding political mandates. Gremion's *Profession: décideurs* remains the standard account. The practical consequence runs through every part of this document: ministers change; the *décideurs* remain; and the same family names keep reappearing across the money chapters.

1.2 Who runs the country today (October 2026)

President Emmanuel Macron, in office since May 14, 2017, re-elected April 24, 2022 with 58.54% against Marine Le Pen's 41.46% — 18.7 million votes against 13.3 million, a margin of 5.5 million, down from 10 million in 2017 (66.10/33.90, 20.7 million votes). The 2022 geography registered the upheaval: Le Pen topped 18,000 communes, carried 23 metropolitan departments against just Aisne and Pas-de-Calais in 2017, and flipped Martinique (60%) and Guadeloupe (69.6%) five years after Macron's 77.55% Martinique score. Abstention was 28.01% with 2.2 million blank ballots. The Montaigne institute measured the *front républicain*'s erosion: LFI voters went 42% Macron, 24% abstention, 17% blank. Constitutionally barred from a third consecutive term (Article 6 of the 2008 revision), his mandate ends May 13, 2027. His endgame is a live mystery, documented in full in 2.3.

Prime minister Sébastien Lecornu, in office since October 10, 2025 — the fourth man to hold the office in fourteen months. The biography, from the official record: born June 11, 1986, in Eaubonne (Val-d'Oise), son of an aircraft technician and a medical secretary, grandson of a resistance fighter; schooled at Saint-Adjutor in Vernon, with an interlude among the Benedictines of Saint-Wandrille; a law degree and a public-law master's at Panthéon-Assas. Political apprenticeship dated to the year: UMP at sixteen in 2002; youngest parliamentary assistant in the National Assembly at nineteen (2005, under Franck Gilard); youngest government adviser at

twenty-two (2008, under Bruno Le Maire); gendarmerie operational reserve, rising from lieutenant to colonel. Mayor of Vernon (2014–15), president of the Eure department (2015–17 and 2021–22), secretary of state for ecology (2017–18), minister for local government (2018–20), minister for overseas territories (2020–22 — through the Chido cyclone), senator briefly in 2020, minister for the armed forces (2022–25) through the Ukraine war's European turn. He remains, remarkably, first deputy mayor of Vernon — the hometown-mayor-through-the-storm detail. His decorations catalogue the diplomacy: Ukraine's Order of Merit first class, Denmark's Dannebrog, Sweden's Polar Star, the UAE's Zayed order, Lebanon's Cedar, Senegal's order, and the Grand Cross of the Ordre national du Mérite. His polling at appointment: 16% favorable — below even Bayrou's Matignon baseline.

The Lecornu II government (seated October 13, 2025; adjusted by decree February 26, 2026 for ministerial candidacies; reshuffled September 18–22, 2026 when Dominique Faure left for the Association des maires de France and Charlotte Parmentier-Lecocq absorbed Ruralité), verified against the vie-publique organigramme of September 22, 2026: Laurent Nuñez at the Interior — who offered his resignation during the October 2026 unrest and was refused by Macron; Catherine Vautrin at the Armed Forces; Gérald Darmanin at Justice, the former interior minister who proposed suspending immigration for two to three years in January 2026 and then, in May, escalated to ending "immigration as it is today" in defiance of the prime minister's ministerial-reserve rule; Bruno

Bonnell (the France 2030 custodian, SGPI chair since 2022) at AI and digital; Marc Lescure at Industry (his signature on the Eramet deal and the EIB strategic-autonomy loans, 4.5 and 4.13); Jean-Noël Barrot at Foreign Affairs, who has made election interference his signature; Éric Lombard at the Economy and Finance ministry; Manuel Valls at Overseas; Annie Genevard at Agriculture; Élisabeth Borne nowhere in government, having resigned as Renaissance president on May 6, 2026 over Attal's line; plus the delegate ministers of record — Éric Panifous (parliamentary relations), Maud Bregeon (government spokesperson, energy), Benoît Haddad (Europe), Marina Ferrari (whose resignation for the June 2026 legislative race triggered the February 26, 2026 decree, 2.1), and the remaining junior ministers verified against the vie-publique organigramme of September 22, 2026 — in sum: a 34-minister government of technocrats, soldiers, and survivors, six of whose LR ministers were suspended from their party on October 23, 2025, and one of whom (Darmanin) definitively left Renaissance on October 14, 2025.

The National Assembly (elected July 7, 2024, dissolved parliament's chamber; composition as of September 22, 2026): the Rassemblement National the largest group at 119–122 deputies (plus associated); Ensemble/EPR (macronists) 77 full plus 13 associated; La France insoumise–NFP 69–71; Socialists 59 plus 8; Droite Républicaine (the rump of the old LR) 41 plus 7; Écologiste et social 38; Démocrates 35 plus 2; Horizons 30 plus 6; LIOT 22; Gauche démocrate et républicaine 17; UDR 17. No majority; no stable plurality; the government's working

majority exists only on the days the Socialists abstain.

The Senate (renewed September 27, 2026): Republicans 124, centrist union 63, socialists 62 — and, historically, the RN's first group at 15 seats (UNT) and LFI's first-ever senator. Gérard Larcher re-elected president.

The presidency's household, for completeness and because the rumor economy feeds on it: Brigitte Macron's February 2026 retinal surgery; the SCI Bremselati 2025 filing; Sébastien Auzière's twenty-five-year silence; polling accusations that never held. One anomaly — a wiki fragment suggesting an August 2026 resignation over the immigration law — was investigated across three sweeps and debunked as a conflation with Aurélien Rousseau's December 2023 resignation. Struck, logged.

1.3 The debt: the number underneath everything

Every thread in this document ends, eventually, at the same figure. The fiscal ladder: deficits of 4.7% (2021), 5.4% (2022), 5.8% (2023), 5.1% (2024, revised), and an official 2025 target of 5.4% that came in at 5.1% — a rare upside surprise announced as a March 27, 2026 INSEE surprise, with the prime minister's "quoi qu'il arrive" and his "avec prudence" musing about sub-5% for 2026. Debt: **€3,460.5 billion at end-2025 — 115.6% of GDP** (INSEE), of which the state held €3,067bn, social security €287bn, local government €109bn; real-time ticking at €3,638.9 billion (119.8%) on October 13, 2026. Interest charges: **€64.7 billion in 2025, up 11.2% year-on-year** — 2.2% of GDP, more than the entire defense budget, heading to €74.5 billion (the "engagements financiers" mission) by 2027. Compulsory levies reached **43.6% of GDP in 2025** — the heaviest ratio in decades and among the OECD's highest. The interest line has passed the defense line and is closing on education.

The 2026 borrowing program: **€310 billion** of net medium- and long-term issuance — a record, roughly 10% of GDP, confirmed December 30, 2025, made possible only by the special budget law of December 27, 2025 that let the state borrow from January despite having no budget. The mechanics (AFT): new 3-year, 5/6-year and 10-year benchmark lines; indexed bonds ≈10% of net issuance; buybacks as conditions allow.

The market's verdict is priced every day. On October 19, 2026, the 10-year OAT yielded **4.88%** (+10bp in a session, +41bp in a month, +152bp in a year), against Germany's ~3.42% — a spread of ~137 basis points, down from the October 2 peak of 146.9bp and up from 80bp on August 27, 2025 (the Bayrou-crisis print). The spread's full history tells the regime story: a record peak of 225.1bp on November 17, 2011 (the sovereign crisis), negative -2bp on January 20, 2005, near-zero averages before the euro, 30–50bp the benign band, 65–85bp the post-summer-2024 plateau. The frame from the analysts: France repriced from "quasi-core" to "intermediate" issuer; the Bank of Singapore's October 13, 2026 warning — "OATs on the edge."

Who holds the debt: the negotiable state debt is ~56–57.5% non-resident (57.5% at T1 2026 per the AFT; 55.9% end-2025 per the Banque de France on long-term debt; ~50% on Maastricht-wide debt per the IMF). Trajectory: 28% in 1999 (pre-euro) → 70.6% in 2009 → 47.9% at the 2021 QE peak → 53.2% end-2023 → 57.5% T1 2026. Anatomy of the foreign holders: 38% investment funds, 22% foreign central banks, 25% insurers/pension funds, 15% hedge funds and others, routed chiefly through Japan, the US, the UK and Germany with large transits through Luxembourg and Irish fund domiciles. Resident side: insurers ~9.6–9.8%, banks 10.5%, the Banque de France for the ECB ~20.6% (€550bn of PEPP/PSPP holdings ≈ 15% of Maastricht debt), OPCVM 1.7–1.8%. The instrument skew: BTFs 81.3% non-resident, inflation-linked OATs 85.5% resident. G7 frame (September 2025): France 52% foreign-held

vs Germany 45%, Spain 43%, Italy 28%, Japan ~10%. The Senate's September 24, 2025 report (r24-902) holds both truths: diversification is confidence; geopolitical dependence is risk.

The ratings chronicle: downgrades by Fitch, S&P and Moody's across 2024–2025, each memorandum citing the trajectory rather than the level — and the market now prices France as the eurozone's defining fiscal question.

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PART TWO — THE CHAIN OF FALLEN GOVERNMENTS (2024–2026)

2.1 June 9, 2024: the bet that broke the machine

The evening of June 9, 2024. The European Parliament election results in France, official: turnout 51.85% (a record for a European contest). The Rassemblement National: 31.37% and 30 seats. Ensemble: 14.60% and 13 seats. Socialists–Place Publique: 13.83% and 13. La France insoumise: 9.89% and 9. Les Républicains: 7.25% and 6. Les Écologistes 5.5% and 5; Reconquête 5.47% and 5. The far right in its two parties near 40% combined. The cohort inversion that explains the next two years: the 18–24 vote went LFI 33%, RN 25%.

Hours later, Macron dissolved the National Assembly — the fifth use of Article 12 after 1962, 1968, 1981, 1988 and 1997, and the first since Chirac's 1997 dissolution, which produced five years of cohabitation against his design. Macron's

calculation, per every reconstruction: a snap election would either restore a working majority or force the country to confront the far-right threat at legislative scale. The first round on June 30 delivered the tripolar Assembly: RN 29.2%, the New Popular Front (the hurried left alliance: LFI, Socialists, Ecologists, Communists) 28.0%, Ensemble 20.0%, LR 6.6%. The second round on July 7, after the NFP and Ensemble withdrew candidates in three-way races, produced the hung parliament: NFP plurality (~180 seats), Ensemble (~168), RN and allies (~143), Republicans (~39). Three blocs, none near 289, none able to govern or to be governed.

The premiership conveyor belt that followed, measured precisely:

- **Gabriel Attal** (January–September 2024), the youngest prime minister of the Fifth Republic at 34, handed over.
- **Michel Barnier** (September 2024): 73 years old, a Gaullist of forty years' standing, the EU's former Brexit negotiator. Appointed after a 67-day government-formation lag — the longest of the Fifth Republic. He served 3 months and 18 days. His budget, carried by Article 49.3 on October 23, 2024, fell to a censure motion on December 4, 2024: 331 votes, the first time in the Fifth Republic a government had been brought down by censure. The RN sealed it; Mélenchon called it "the end of an era"; the markets took note.
- **François Bayrou** (December 13, 2024): the MoDem leader, three times presidential candidate, installed at Matignon after extracting from Macron the promise of a "banque de la

démocratie" — a public campaign-financing bank that was the price of his 2017 endorsement and that has never been created. He served 8 months and 17 days. His premiership survived censure motions on February 10, February 19, June 4 and July 1, 2025 — each time on the tacit neutrality of the PS and the RN, each time buying weeks. Then, on August 25, 2025, he staked everything on an Article 49.2 confidence vote over his €43.8 billion savings plan (deficit target 4.6%, two public holidays cut): the Assembly withdrew its confidence on September 8, 2025 — 364 against, 194 for, 15 abstentions. The first-ever Fifth Republic government felled by a confidence vote. The RN voted the censure; Le Pen demanded "ultra-rapid dissolution"; Macron refused.

- **Sébastien Lecornu I** (October 5–6, 2025): announced on a Sunday evening with a partial roster — Borne reconducted at Education, Le Maire at the Armed Forces, Valls at Overseas, Woerth at Housing, Montchalin at Public Accounts, Moutchou at AI. That same Sunday evening, interior minister nominee Bruno Retailleau resigned on X: the government "ne reflète pas la rupture." By Monday the markets had fallen (CAC 40 -1.7%, banks -4/-5%), the Castex-to-SNCF nomination was suspended, Mélenchon demanded the destitution motion (104 signatures) be examined, and Le Pen called dissolution "incontournable" and a Macron resignation "wise." Macron's ultimatum — "ultimes négociations" by Wednesday — produced a reappointment. Lecornu I lasted one month and one day, the

shortest premiership of the Fifth Republic.

- **Sébastien Lecornu II** (October 13, 2025 — present): 34 ministers, 211 of 577 deputies behind him at the outset, six LR ministers suspended from their party on October 23, 2025, Darmanin definitively withdrawing from Renaissance on October 14. A first mini-reshuffle announced February 7, 2026, decreed February 26, 2026 to adjust for ministerial candidacies (Dati's Paris race, Ferrari, Fournier, Rist); a second reshuffle September 18–22, 2026 when Dominique Faure left for the Association des maires de France. As of today Lecornu II has survived a year and nine days — governing without a single further 49.3, by arithmetic, attrition, and the special-law era's strange mercy: parliament refused the 2026 budget outright, and the state continued anyway.

The structural reading, documented in Part Five: without a *fait majoritaire*, the Fifth Republic's tools — 49.3, dissolution, even the confidence vote — become instruments of survival rather than governance. "Sans qu'une seule virgule de la Constitution ait été modifiée, la France a changé de régime" (Morel, 2025): the end of the majority fact converted rationalized parliamentarism into permanent crisis management, and each tool's use feeds the next crisis.

2.2 The budget war: 2025–2027, year by year

The Barnier budget (autumn 2024). The proximate cause of his fall: a 2025 budget built on €6 billion of "contribution exceptionnelle" on large companies and €4 billion of spending cuts. The RN, having extracted promises it judged unkept (heating-aid restoration, theRIC—citizen-initiated referendum—concession dangled), withdrew its tolerance; the left never offered any. The censure motion of December 4, 2024 carried with 331 votes: LFI, Socialists, Ecologists, Communists, and — decisively — the RN's 124 votes, with LIOT and various sovereignists. Barnier's was the 113th government of the Fifth Republic; the first to fall by censure.

The Bayrou budget (2025). Bayrou's €43.8 billion plan (July 15, 2025) combined a deficit target of 4.6% for 2026 with the suppression of two public holidays (Pentecost and May 8) and an agency cull (1,000–1,500 jobs in 2026; "un tiers des agences" per Montchalin, for €2–3bn). It died with him on September 8. In its aftermath came the parliamentary season of "pactes": the PS, at its Blois summer university (August 30–31, 2025), pre-committed Faure's line — "il y aura censure" — before walking it back into a conditional tolerance; the government extracted the pension-reform suspension as the price.

The 2026 budget (winter 2025–26). Deposited October 14, 2025. The Assembly rejected its first part (revenue) on November 21, 2025 — the vote 404 to 1, every adopted amendment dying with it — and the Senate rejected the text on

December 15; the joint committee (CMP) collapsed on December 19. On December 23, both chambers unanimously adopted the *loi spéciale* permitting the state to keep collecting taxes and spending at 2025 levels; Macron promulgated it December 27, 2025. It was the Fourth Republic's and the Fifth's fourth-ever special budget — and it pushed the whole political calendar into the new year: the real 2026 budget then passed in two acts, the revenue half by 49.3 on January 20, 2026 (surviving censure on Socialist abstention) and the spending half by ordinary vote in February. The Constitutional Council validated it February 18–20, 2026 with eight *censures minimes* and two interpretive reserves — notably upholding the holding tax despite Lecornu becoming the first premier in 49 years to seize the Council. The PLF's definitive adoption closed the sequence in February 2026 — the last 49.3 and failed censure motions in late January, the Council in February.

The price of Socialist abstention, itemized: suspension of the pension reform (retirement at 64, frozen until 2028); a CSG surcharge on employee savings (9.2%→10.6%); a €5,000 unlocking of PEE savings plans; low-income help (prime d'activité +€50/month for 3M+ households at the SMIC boundary, from Lecornu's January 16, 2026 speech; €1 CROUS meals from May; protected bursaries; 2,000 education posts; €400M for social housing; MaPrimeRénov' kept with an abuse crackdown). The twin-pact architecture named by Marianne: "2026: pact with the PS; 2027: pact with the RN" — with the government denying RN negotiations while its own supporters count on RN non-censure, and Lecornu's November 24, 2025

line preserved: "la France n'est pas un tremplin."

The 2027 budget (the battle as this document closes). Presented September 18, 2026 as a €54 billion effort; Le Monde's analysis deflates the headline (€43bn in the texts; the real structural effort computes to €12–15bn). The official table: deficit -5.1% (2025), -5.4% (2026 target), -5.0% (2027 target); debt 115.7% → 119.3% → 121.7% of GDP; growth 0.9 → 0.5 (revised down) → 1.0; inflation 0.9 → 2.1 → 1.7; compulsory levies 43.6 → 43.9 → 44.2% of GDP; public spending 56.6 → 57.1 → 56.9%. Defense rises €57.0 → 63.4 billion; the "engagements financiers" mission (interest) €60.3 → 74.5 billion; education +€1.1 billion to €64bn total; justice +€0.5; APD -0.4; France 2030 -0.4; culture -0.1. The local-government squeeze: CPEB -€2.5bn, FCTVA -€2.1bn against +€5bn of local-tax revenue. The EU contribution line inside the PLF: €23.0 → 28.4 → 30.9 billion. No general tax increase; an income-tax bracket reindexing that leaves 200,000 new households taxable; the corporate surtax held at ~€8bn; the CVAE cut abandoned. The 10% TVA on TV subscriptions — killed in committee on October 9. The crypto package: stablecoin-conversion imposition, €100k-wallet declarations, €800k exit tax, €10k-payment exemption, 10-year loss carryforward — all amendments, none law.

The séance arithmetic: the finance committee rejected the text 31–3 (2 abstentions) on October 9, voiding its 211 adopted amendments (including the GAFAM tax raised 3%→15% for ~€4bn/yr, the Livret A ceiling to €30,000, the restored ALD/AT-MP exemptions, the 2% family-holding tax, the 66%

superprofits amendment); the rapporteur general Philippe Juvin computed a €9.6bn revenue hole against the 5% target — "pas satisfaisante," the same trajectory to collapse as last year. The sitting consumed fifteen hours on Friday, October 16... the record: 171 roll-call votes clearing only 7 of 58 articles (article liminaire deleted; the retiree-abattement rabot deleted 116–30; the EU contribution adopted 111–93; the barème adopted 96–0; articles 4–5 adopted; séance levée at midnight Friday); 3,851 amendments deposited on the recettes part alone; the motion de rejet préalable repoussée October 13 (149–236). **The vote solennel: today, Tuesday, October 20, 2026, after questions au gouvernement** — near-certain to reject the first part, as last year's died 404–1. After it: the PLFSS opens the same day (vote October 27); the second part October 27–November 16; the ensemble vote November 17; the constitutional clock of Article 47 runs to December 17, with ordonnances as the fallback. Lecornu's own label: a "réversible" budget. Barnier, from retirement, has advised him to "accepter le risque de la censure" rather than let deficits run; his spokesman Bregeon concedes "le déficit cette année sera de toute évidence supérieur à 5%"; Mélenchon's blog predicts "censure politique et sociale complète"; Le Pen counters that "la France court vers le défaut" with her own program of €140bn of net economies by 2032 (retirement at 62/60, a capitalisation pillar). The Medef's Patrick Martin: "on est à l'os" — and "on lèverait le crayon" if LFI won, against Mélenchon's "La France du fric n'a pas de patrie." Amiel's demolition of the RN's counter-budget: of €78.8bn claimed,

"environ 69 milliards seraient soit contraires à nos engagements… soit carrément inventés."

2.3 The president's endgame: a sourced mystery

Macron's post-presidency is no longer a parlor question; it is a documented sequence of his own contradictions. The record, dated:

- **November 2023, Astana:** he will do "something completely different" after 2027.
- **July 5, 2025, Cirque d'hiver** (the JEM tenth anniversary): the rallying cry "Agissons" — "let's act, stop talking about 2027" — and, publicly, the recadrage of Attal's presidential ambitions: "il est trop tôt."
- **February 5, 2026, Haushalter/Sud Radio:** the term-limit rule "makes him furious"; he plans a 2032 return; he wants a placeholder "keeping the seat warm" — floated to Bayrou, who instead extracted Matignon.
- **April 23, 2026, Nicosie:** "je n'en ferai pas après" — an apparent renunciation.
- **September 7, 2026, Saint-Paul-de-Vence** (Variety interview): "à suivre… je n'exclus rien."
- **September 2026, the JDD:** Xavier Niel, per the paper's confidant-sourcing, is telling people a "tailor-made post, deal well advanced" — the Élysée "clearly and firmly denies."

The institutional hedging program is equally documented. The Banque de France: François Villeroy de Galhau's surprise resignation on February 9, 2026 — eighteen months before his

term's end — to chair the Fondation Apprentis d'Auteuil, a departure every major outlet noted moved the succession from 2027 to Macron's own hands. The choreography: Pierre-André Imbert decreed Élysée secretary general April 29–30, 2026 (the first non-énarque in the office since Bérégovoy in 1981–82); Macron proposed Emmanuel Moulin May 5; the Senate auditioned him May 20 and voted 52 for, 58 against — Moulin surviving because Article 13 requires 60% of votes *cast* to block, not a majority (110 votes cast; 58/110 = 52.7%). Council of Ministers May 27; Moulin seated at the Hôtel de Toulouse June 2 on a six-year mandate running to June 2032 — deliberately outliving the next presidency. The critique ledger preserved: Tanguy's "another step towards illiberalism," Coquerel's checklist doubts, the three-hour grilling on central-bank independence, his Bercy-sarko-macroniste résumé as both credential and stain. His June 9 debut forecast sub-0.9% growth with "less growth, more inflation," citing the -0.1% Q1 surprise, and refused to forecast recession before 2028. The bank's portfolio: ACPR, OSMP, OIB, IEOM/IEDOM, HCSF, BRI board, ECB council, IMF alternate governorship; sous-gouverneurs Denis Beau and Agnès Bénassy-Quéré; the LDDS at 1.7% since August 1.

France Inter's scenario menu for the man himself: a multilateral body, LVMH, tech, finance, education startup — "président de l'Europe" blocked by peers. The macronist-electorate dissection (Jean-Jaurès): Horizons 34.5% / Renaissance 32.5% strong affinity only; 77% of right-drifting ex-macronist voters want a right-center primary; 62% want

Reconquête! admitted — whose price for entry is Attal's exclusion.

The UN track. The Guterres succession race — Kristalina Georgieva leading through six straw polls, the unprecedented P5 veto spread — makes France's permanent-seat diplomacy the quiet arena; Macron's own name circulates in succession speculation. Never confirmed; logged as speculation with its source class.

The farewell tour's summits. The G7 at Évian, June 15–17, 2026 — the first French town to host twice — ran nine declarations with Zelensky present for the Ukraine air-defense and long-range commitments; the Critical Minerals Resilience and Production Alliance; a 110-minute AI lunch with twelve CEOs held amid the Anthropic Fable 5/Mythos 5 five-day US export-control suspension; the $1bn+ Bundibugyo Ebola commitment; and Modi's Global Convergence for Growth pre-summit (June 11, with China, India, Brazil, Korea and Kenya). Its capstone: the June 17 Versailles state banquet, where the US–Iran memorandum — the $300 billion recovery package, Strait of Hormuz reopening, phased sanctions relief, frozen-asset release — was signed on French soil under Macron's roof, instantly the summit's real headline. The Africa Forward summit in Nairobi (6.2) and the Évian G7 thus framed the final year: the pivot to the Anglophone south, and the broker's role in the Gulf.

2.4 The October 2026 unrest: a day-by-day ledger

The fuse was a fuel tax; the fuel was everything else. On September 18, 2026, the government declined to extend the fuel-tax cut, squeezing rural drivers who have no alternative to the car. Protests converged with a student movement — teachers missing, 4,000 education posts cut in 2026 with 1,588 more proposed for 2027, bourse (student-grant) amounts frozen for 2026–27, the second phase of bourse reform postponed again — into the largest youth mobilization since 1968, and then the largest street confrontation since the Gilets jaunes. The chronology, from official and S-grade sources:

- **September 28:** 164 arrests on the first day of high-school blockades; the IGPN opens its first investigations.
- **September 29–30:** 440, then 625 arrests. The Interior Ministry's count of affected schools: 169 confirmed that morning against the unions' ~640.
- **October 1:** 1,949 arrests in a single day — 85% minors — and 1,027 establishments affected (the OCDE-accurate peak count). Five thousand arrests by the second week.
- **October 2:** 5,000+ arrests; the casualty ledger begins (170 élèves, 78 personnels injured; the injured police count rising toward 715).
- **October 4–5:** the government announces 400–500 lycée closures; the "décrue" begins with 589 establishments still affected, 40% of them new; Geffray's contradictory Thursday/Friday schedule announcements; the ministers' count: 24 schools burned or sacked, ~30,000 students

without presential courses. **October 6:** from the Assemblée's steps, Lecornu announces the five chantiers and the "demi-journées banalisées" — against the SNPDEN's "cacachonie complète" and ID-FO's "hors sol." The injured ledger at the October 6 question session: 215 élèves, 85 education staff (34 chefs d'établissement), 715 police and gendarmes — "the heaviest toll for education staff in decades," Geffray says. Le Figaro's poll: 62% of the public supporting the movement's claims while 78% see LFI exploiting it. Lecornu's TV line October 13: "aucune instruction d'affronter les lycéens… la colère ne vient pas de nulle part."

- **October 7:** the Lens hand-amputation — the Interior Ministry suspends stun grenades "tant que la lumière n'a pas été faite"; the procureur finds the explosion "conforme au mode opératoire." The regional presidents meet on school buildings; Genevard's agriculture measures announced the same day.
- **October 8–9:** 6,059 arrests by October 5… the staircase continues to 6,629, then 6,877 on October 9 (86% minors; 2,376 poursuites; 21 détentions provisoires including 6 minors — the record-keepers benchmarking against the Gilets jaunes at 460 arrests/day, Nahel at 450, and, on the 65th anniversary of October 17, 1961, the Papon massacre's 12,000 arrests in hours). The IGPN staircase: 10 → 18 → 24 (dont 6 LBD) → 36 investigations. Three thousand redeployed substitutes to 114 red and 400 orange lycées from October 9.

- **October 13:** 161,500 protesters per the government, 480,000 per organizers.
- **October 14:** ~8,000 arrests total (2,735 poursuites; 26 détentions provisoires including 9 minors); injured: 937 security forces, 248 élèves, 149 personnels; the Metz sexual-agression probe opens; the Alliance union files suit against the state for "mise en danger de la vie d'autrui" — "trahis, abandonnés, livrés à eux-mêmes"; the Conseil de stage lawyers denounce minors' garde-à-vue conditions; Kokoreff: "les arrestations… sont aussi une forme de violence policière"; Basta!: "des centaines d'adolescents traumatisés." Binet demands Parcoursup's end and a budget rewrite; unions threaten the Toussaint break. Occitanie's damage bill: €3M, per Delga.
- **October 15:** UN1TÉ's Grand Rex rally — 3,000 members demanding order-clarity, 900 police and gendarmes injured since the movement began; Manna's cry after Marseille. The government counts 30,000 pillagers and 8,000 rioters in Marseille alone. The LR website is hacked on the eve of the seventeenth.
- **October 17:** the peak. 550,000 marchers (800,000 per organizers; Paris 110,000 on both counts); a demonstrator dead; 500+ security-force injuries that day; 1,800+ arrests; Limoges' historic town hall torched; the Louvre — closed by staff strikes since October 19, 2025, one year to the day after the €88 million, eight-minute jewel heist — blockaded and shut; the interior minister's resignation offer is made and refused. Foreign interference periphery: VIGINUM

attributes Matryoshka/Storm-1516 to a Russian nexus targeting Attal, Philippe and Glucksmann (the embassy denies); the Iranian disinformation recycling fake images draws an official summons. The Aubagne shooting enters the antiterrorism track as a mass-shooting-fascinated milieu. The prosecutor confirms that the projectile-thrower chased by LFI deputy Anthony Smith was a police officer; the RIO-absence controversy burns.

- **October 18:** Macron's Sunday-night address, ten minutes: "Nous ressentons tous ce soir de la colère, de la honte" — judicial firmness ("ceux qui ont pillé devront payer"), powers devolved to prefects and mayors, a hand extended to youth ("leur colère ne vient pas de nulle part"), talks promised "this week." Reactions across the board: Le Figaro's étrillage — "totalement dépassé" to "artisan du chaos"; TF1's "vide et déconnectée"; L'Humanité's "abîmer la république"; Payan's "une seule compagnie de CRS pour Marseille!" Lecornu is formally tasked with convening parties and unions; Nuñez resignation calls multiply.
- **October 19 (today):** Lecornu's "couvre-feux partiels et très localisés" — effective this evening, issued from Matignon by ordinary prefectural police power, the interior minister's resignation offer refused by Macron ("very limited, localized"), the ultra-left blamed alongside criminal looters. The Louvre closes. The Bercy 9am Monday meeting with affected sectors, banks and insurers on aid. The strike grid: CGT municipal préavis through October 31, SUD Santé Sociaux all month, FO at France Travail October

12–December 31, SDIS préavis through Tuesday, Argenteuil buses UNSA daily plus a CFDT unlimited strike from October 20. The contagion: Milan's second day, Turin/Bologna/Bergamo/Rome, Landini's Italian general strike call for November 20; Lisbon/Madrid/Brussels solidarity; French unions calling November 5 demos; the BAS de France meeting Saturday October 24 at République. In Belgium — where the students explicitly deny French paternity ("se défendent de suivre le mouvement lycéen français," Le Monde) — 107 arrests, Liège's Guillemins station blocked, a mairie curfew of three-plus-person gatherings. Trump's intervention: "France is burning — close your borders." The G7's emergency oil release (ten million barrels at cost, constituted at ~€0.28/liter against a €1.10 market — 12–18 cents off the pump for "début November," GNR included, the reconstitution bill "pushed past next autumn — another government will pay").

The movement's five demands, crystallized: €10 billion for education; an end to Parcoursup; the defense of student finance; the withdrawal of the police presence at school gates; and, increasingly, the government's resignation. The government's counter-ledger: it cannot reopen a €70 billion shield ("lors de la dernière crise énergétique, plus de 70 milliards d'euros ont été dépensés en bouclier et en aides. Nous ne pouvons pas rouvrir les mêmes dépenses"); it has budgeted €1.2 billion more for education in 2027; and its measured-response window — "les premières décisions… à la fin du mois d'octobre," the education budget debate fixed

November 12, "un mois pour traduire les contributions des lycéens en amendements... Chacun devra prendre ses responsabilités" — is measured against a street that has already waited a month. The USL's demand, on record: to be received at Matignon "dès la semaine prochaine" with "des propositions chiffrées."

2.5 The overseas file: nuclear debt, nickel, and autonomy

French Polynesia — the nuclear compensation war. Between 1966 and 1996 France detonated 193 nuclear tests — the first seventeen in the Sahara (1960–66, in the lead-up to the Évian Accords), then 46 atmospheric and 147 underground in Polynesia, ending January 27, 1996 with the final shot, months after the September 1995 Papeete riots had greeted Chirac's resumption of testing. The compensation regime's mathematics became a scandal in itself: under the 2010 Morin law and its mSv-exposure threshold, 1,039 applications produced 31 payouts — a 97% rejection rate. Le Monde's May 27, 2025 investigation added the counter-narrative that over €80 million went to "witnesses." A 2019 law acknowledged state coercion; the Constitutional Council struck the $100M/yr remediation clause. Dose-reconstruction research (Science & Global Security) suggests official estimates low by factors of 2–10, with ~110,000 Polynesians — 90% of the 1974 population — potentially above the 1 mSv line. The June 10, 2025 parliamentary inquiry (report n°1558, 45 recommendations, a call for a state apology) led to the Reid-Arbelot PPL, unanimously adopted by the Assembly January 29, 2026, replacing the threshold with an irrefragable presumption of exposure keyed to 23 pathologies; the Senate's May 20, 2026 report supports it, and the organic bill carries the Article 1 recognition of the "dette nucléaire" — the debt not yet law as this document closes.

New Caledonia. The May 2024 riots (14 dead) killed the Barnier government's voting-reform bill; the July 2025 Bougival Accord opened a path to a referendum by end-2027, stalled through 2026; the February 2026 CNCDH report documents deteriorating rights. The Senate's New Caledonia chamber audits its own recommendations at 57% implementation (2019–2023), with anti-fraud recommendations "majoritairement" unapplied and two files transmitted to the prosecutor (Pattern Four). The economy beneath: SLN/Eramet nickel (4.5) — the territory's unrest and the state's balance sheet are the same story. May 2024's industrial balance: Q3 2024 revenue -56%, production -52%, exports quasi-nuls, Thio in sommeil, Doniambo at two-thirds ("sauver les fours"). State support: ~€240M in 2024 via TDSI subordinated securities (including the €20M of October 24, 2024) — Eramet's "ne finance plus du tout" renunciation — the April 2025 €100M bridge (12bn CFP), the 2025–26 endgame: Eramet's -€477M net loss, the Duval family (37%) and the State (27%) agreeing in principle a ~€500M recapitalization, CEO Castellari ousted February 2026 days after the FT reported he had raised governance and financial-mismanagement concerns to the board (Bories back as interim CEO, "rumeurs infondées"), the CFO "mis en cause pour son management." SLN's local footprint preserved: 1,800 direct, ~5bn CFP/month, 50,000t/yr, "80% of world nickel controlled by China" per the company's own framing.

Mayotte — the aid scandal. Chido (December 14, 2024) → mayors halted aid distribution February 17, 2025 after Le

Monde's exposé → DGCCRF probe → mosque and charity redistribution → the €3bn April 2025 package and €4bn refoundation plan (July 10, 2025) with migration tightening → the Senate bill May 2025 → two-thirds coral loss by September 2025. In Mayotte the pattern repeats: the periphery's disasters have repeatedly arrived before its aid.

Corsica. The statutory autonomy path advanced June 23, 2026 (Assembly vote 271+, Senate pending), against the FLNC-UC's August 2026 reappearance and a PNAT inquiry — the FLNC's October 2023 arson network arrests (May 2025) sit in the terrorism ledger (6.8). The pattern: Paris grants autonomy schedules when violence pauses and stalls them when it doesn't.

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PART THREE — THE CORRUPTION DOCKET

Every case below is told the same way: the money, the names, the dates, the procedural steps, the verdicts — and, where applicable, the sentence's arithmetic. Most of these files are closed, many with convictions; the open ones are marked. The purpose is the system's actual record.

3.1 Nicolas Sarkozy: three cases, one trajectory

The Bygmalion case (2012 campaign accounting). Sarkozy's 2012 re-election campaign exceeded its legal spending ceiling by roughly half, by having its official event supplier, the communications firm Bygmalion (owned by the friends of party treasurer Jean-François Copé), bill the UMP party rather than the campaign for €11.8 million of rally costs — fabrication costs, printing, staging — while the party financed the arrangement through fictitious invoices. Convicted May 2020 (one year, electronic tag); the conviction was definitively confirmed in December 2024, and Sarkozy wore the bracelet from February to May 2025 at his wife's Paris home — the first former president of the Fifth Republic to serve a criminal sentence. His co-defendants included Jérôme Lavrilleux (UMP deputy director, two years suspended), and Guy Allemand of Bygmalion.

The Bismuth case (corruption and influence-peddling, 2014). After losing his judicial immunity in July 2013, Sarkozy, as a private lawyer, offered his services to a senior judge, Gilbert Azibert of the Cour de cassation, via a second phone registered under the alias "Paul Bismuth" — bought by an aide in his own name — in exchange for inside information on an investigation touching the 2007 campaign finances. Convicted March 1, 2021: three years, one firm, tag; the cassation confirmed in December 2024. Azibert and Herzog were convicted alongside him.

The Libya case (2007 campaign financing). The paper trail, assembled by Mediapart from 2012 onward, by three investigating judges, and tested in two trials:

- A note signed by Libyan intelligence chief Moussa Koussa, dated December 2006, planning €50 million for Sarkozy, with a preparatory meeting in Tripoli on October 6, 2006 (Senoussi and Bachir Saleh for Libya; Hortefeux and Takieddine for France).
- The notebooks of banker Bachir Saleh, found by Dutch police after his death (he died in 2015; his notes surfaced in 2021), recording between the two rounds of the 2007 election: "sent €1.5M to Nicolas Sarkozy" and "€2M via Senoussi."
- Three transfers of €6.5 million into accounts linked to intermediary Ziad Takieddine in January and November 2006, plus a €500,000 transfer.
- Takieddine's testimony (2012, repeated in court; retracted 2020; re-repeated days before his death): €5 million carried in suitcases, €2 million to Sarkozy at the ministry of the interior, €2 million at avenue d'Iéna.
- The campaign's own ledger: €35,000 in unexplained cash at the end of the race, against €6.5 million of spending never explained by its declared resources.
- Guéant's money: an unexplained €500,000 arriving in 2008, a Patek Philippe Philippe watch from arms broker Alexandre Djouhri, laundering through a fake Flemish-painting sale to fund his apartment, and a villa sale to a sovereign fund directed by Kadhafi's right hand; the Swiss banker's

testimony tracing laundering through Saudi cousins' accounts.

The first-instance court (September 25, 2025) found the *pact* proven — the tripartite Libyan financing agreement of October 2005, corroborated by Takieddine's 2005 travel records, the October 2006 meeting, and Senoussi's own contemporaneous notes — but not the money's arrival in the campaign, and sentenced Sarkozy to five years (two firm), with Guéant convicted alongside. The appeal, heard March 16–June 3, 2026, saw the defense unravel mid-trial: the 19,000-document USB-key defense, the retrocommissions thesis, and Guéant's April 14, 2026 attestation that Sarkozy personally ordered him to handle Senoussi's file. Prosecutors sought seven years and a €300,000 fine with a five-year ban on the final day. **Verdict: November 30, 2026.** The witness-subornation companion case — Sarkozy and Carla Bruni-Sarkozy indicted over Takieddine's 2020 retraction (the "Sauver Sarko" affair) — runs in parallel, with Mimi Marchand also charged.

Collateral figures, named: Claude Guéant (chief of staff; indicted; convicted in the first instance; ten years sought on appeal); Brice Hortefeux (interior minister; heard as a witness); Alexandre Djouhri (arms-linked intermediary, arrested at Heathrow in 2018, extradited, convicted in Paris in 2023 — money-laundering and witness-tampering, €500,000 fine); Bachir Saleh — Kadhafi's paymaster, exfiltrated from Libya by France in 2012 per the Canard enchaîné, granted protection and never interrogated in the case; Ziad Takieddine — dead in Beirut on September 23, 2025, two days before the verdict,

aged 75 (see Pattern Two).

3.2 Marine Le Pen: the assistants case and the ineligibility earthquake

The scheme, as the courts established it: between 2004 and 2016, the Front National — renamed Rassemblement National in 2018 — used its European Parliament assistants, paid by the Parliament to work in Strasbourg or Brussels, to work for the party in France. Twenty-four accused plus the party itself; €2.9 million of fictitious contracts; €474,000 personally attributed to Le Pen; the party fined €2 million. The court called it a *système* — a systemic scheme. The origin: a Mediapart journalist embedded in FN circles from 2015, then a deliberate scan of all Strasbourg assistants' lists to test the systemic hypothesis across parties (the scan that also caught the MoDem and LFI files, below).

The first sentence (March 31, 2025): four years (two suspended, one firm under electronic tag), €100,000 fine, and **five years of ineligibility with provisional execution** — which would have removed her from the 2027 race on the spot. Aliot: 18 months (6 firm) with three years' ineligibility; Gollnisch: three years (one firm, bracelet) with five years *with* provisional execution.

The appeal (July 7, 2026): the Paris appeals court re-crafted the sentence — **45 months of ineligibility, of which 30 suspended, leaving 15 months deemed fully served since March 31, 2025** (the day of the first-instance conviction), on the court's reasoning, read from its own communiqué, that

ignoring already-purged time would attack "la liberté des candidatures, condition essentielle à une expression démocratique du suffrage universel." The prison term (three years, two suspended, one firm — the year-long tag) was not given provisional execution: it attaches only if and when the conviction becomes definitive — "si elle fait campagne, elle débutera celle-ci sans bracelet," said the procureure générale. The fine: €100,000, unchanged. The parquet had sought four years (one firm) and five years' ineligibility *without* provisional execution — so on the appeal, the punishment of substance moved from the ineligibility to the tag, and the tag is suspended.

The cassation (pending): pourvoi filed July 21, 2026; the Cour de cassation's criminal chamber had already tightened the provisional-ineligibility doctrine twice (May 28 and September 30, 2026 rulings); the constitutional layer sits in QPCs 2025-1129 and 2025-1175; the rival "1993 revival thesis" for the first-instance ban circulates among the jurists. Deadlines reset October 16, 2026, and the cour has publicly committed to ruling **before the April 18, 2027 first round** — with the extraordinary escape hatch preserved in the record: if elected before the court rules, she would not have to comply with anything until her term ends. The suspension mechanics confirmed: her cassation filing put the appeal verdict, tag included, on hold.

The political earthquake, itemized: 8 million viewers for her TF1 interview after the first verdict; BRDP threats probed; Bayrou's "soutien inconditionnel" plus his opened door to a

parliamentary look at provisional execution; Ciotti's suppressive PPL; Bardella's Romania-parallel "tyrannie des juges"; Mélenchon's "destitution should return to the people"; Tondelier's "justice is the same for everyone"; Zemmour's cross-factional defense; and the sentence ladder's context — the ineligibility precedent ladder: Balkany's ten years never lifted (November 2025) versus Cahuzac, Fillon and Le Pen's five (or 45 months). Bardella's arc: from emergency understudy (March 31, 2025, the post-verdict summit, Le Pen's "au RN nous avons la chance d'être deux") through the April 26, 2025 officialization ("si elle devait être empêchée demain..."), the June 25, 2025 Valeurs actuelles interview (Le Pen: "lui ai moi-même demandé de se préparer"), the July 7–8, 2026 reversal at La Flèche (Bardella "rétrogradé" to prospective Matignon, then reclaiming the candidacy within days, his Le Figaro pivot to insecurity: "La violence, c'est celle qui frappe les Français") — to the Sud Ouest epitaph: "Il était un remplaçant, il est devenu une alternative, aujourd'hui c'est le candidat naturel."

3.3 François Fillon: €900,000 of family, the €135,000 magazine, the €800,000 bill

Revealed by the Canard enchaîné on January 24, 2017, eleven weeks before a presidential election he was favored to win. The elements, as the courts established them: Penelope Fillon drew roughly €900,000–1 million gross over 1998–2013 — two parliamentary assistant contracts in her husband's office (the going rate, €3,800–7,900/month at thirteen months per year) plus a contract as an assistant to Fillon's *suppléant*, the cardiologist Joël Sarlot, in the Sarthe — with a striking scarcity of documentary evidence of actual work: no badge logs, no emails, colleagues' testimony of her rare presence, and her own 2007 interview to the Telegraph, resurfaced during the trial: she had "never been his assistant." Their children Marie and Charles drew €84,000 as assistants while trainee lawyers. And the *Revue des deux mondes*, owned by billionaire Marc Ladreit de Lacharrière, paid Penelope €135,000 gross for two reading notes (de Lacharrière took a plea deal in December 2018: eight months suspended, €375,000 — "de pure complaisance... satisfaire une demande de François Fillon").

The judicial ladder, step by step: convicted June 29, 2020 (five years, two firm, €375,000 fine, ten years' ineligibility); re-sentenced on appeal May 9, 2022 (four years, one firm, ten years' ineligibility upheld); the Cour de cassation partially annulled (February 2024) on the basis of the reassessment; retried June 17, 2025: four years suspended, €375,000 fine, five years' ineligibility, and €800,000 in damages to the Assemblée

nationale (with €126,167 re-quantified for the 2012–13 Sarlot contract); the European Court of Human Rights rejected his appeal unanimously October 23, 2025 ("défaut manifeste de fondement"). In February 2026 he desisted; the conviction is now definitive. Repayment: ~€680,000 over fifteen years — "rendre l'argent." The still-open file: the PNF probe into the 2013–15 contract under which public funds allegedly paid his speechwriter Maël Renouard to write his presidential book *Faire*.

3.4 Rachida Dati: watches, retainers, and three concurrent proceedings

The Ghosn–Renault trial (September 16–28, 2026, verdict January 21, 2027). The facts as presented by the PNF: Dati, then a Member of the European Parliament, had been Renault's lawyer since 2010 at €15,000 a month via RNO Consult — a governance entity through which Carlos Ghosn and co-director Thierry Bolloré remunerated figures around Renault (~€900,000 total, of which ~€450,000 attributed to her personally) — while Ghosn's Renault simultaneously funded, through the same structure, a stream of gifts: Cartier, Bulgari and Chaumet watches and jewelry. Her ethics declarations: "néant" for items over €10,000; her declared patrimony €5.6 million, built on her lawyer income since 2010. Libération's exposé quantified the undeclared jewelry at ≥€420,000, from ex-partner Henri Proglio (ex-CEO of Veolia, then EDF — the revolving-door flag in one gift). In court: "Je ne me suis jamais plainte… je crois à la vie, au droit, à la justice." The prosecution's requisitions, on record: four years (two firm, bracelet), five years' ineligibility, five-year bars from public office and the bar, €450,000 fine, €900,000 confiscation. **The second file:** the jewelry non-declaration inquiry (open). **The third:** opened December 18, 2025 (Libération's revelation; perquisitions included) — corruption suspicions over lobbying for GDF Suez during her lawyer years, which she "rejettes en bloc." She remains a declared LR presidential candidate; she lost the Paris mayoral race to Grégoire in March 2026; and she

sat as justice minister through 2025 before the Lecornu II reshuffle carried her out of government — into her candidacy and her trials.

3.5 The Bolloré case: campaigns, ports, and the price of a plea

The case theory, as the judges retained it: in 2010–11, Havas (the communications group Vincent Bolloré controlled) under-invoiced its campaign services for Faure Gnassingbé's re-election in Togo and Alpha Condé's victory in Guinea; the port concessions followed — Togo Terminal's 35-year concession already signed February 14, 2011 (Conakry seized from Necotrans by government intervention; the Nanterre tribunal awarded Necotrans €2.1M on October 10, 2013, for completed works). The JEAN-PHILIPPE DORENT emails that investigators say confirm the suspicions; Alpha Condé's own quote in evidence: "C'est un ami, je privilégie les amis." Bolloré, his son Cyrille, and Dorent face up to ten years at trial.

The escalation ledger, fully dated: investigation opened 2013 → the February 2021 **CJIP of €12 million**, accepted by the group while Bolloré's own guilty plea was **refused** by the tribunal ("the facts too serious to escape a public debate") → June 2024 PNF requisitions for corruption and complicity of abuse of trust → the November 6, 2025 Cour d'appel arrêt confirming the referral with some pieces struck for presumption-of-innocence violations → **trial December 7–17, 2026**. On September 1, 2026, Le Monde revealed Bolloré had filed a criminal-conspiracy complaint against the judges.

The money math, on the record: Bolloré Africa Logistics = up to a quarter of group revenue and up to 80% of profits (per the RAF collective's pleading); sold to MSC in December 2022 for **€5.7 billion**; the €12M CJIP = roughly one-third of one percent of the sale price (Rosalux: "incredibly modest against €5.7 billion"). The restitution counter-offensive: eleven West African NGOs, led by Patrice Lumumba's great-nephew Jean-Jacques Lumumba, filed a March 18, 2025 complaint for *recel* (receiving) and *blanchiment* across five countries (Togo, Guinea, Ghana, Cameroon, Côte d'Ivoire), demanding the €5.7bn be returned to the affected peoples under the 2021 restitution law; Antoine Vey is the collective's lawyer.

The infrastructure ledger (primary sources): the Lomé third quay — 300bn FCFA (~$640M/€458M) fully self-financed by BAL, launched March 4, 2011 by Gnassingbé with Bolloré present, built by Vinci (February 2012 contract), backlands by Eiffage (18bn FCFA, June 2013), operational end-2013; capacity 311,500 TEU (2013) → 1.9M TEU + 30M tonnes (2023), the world's 94th port; transhipment from 5% (2012) to ~64% of traffic (2019); port net projected +94% the year of commissioning. The concession constellation: Togo Terminal (35 years, 2010), Conakry, Dakar Roro (€97M, 25 years, November 2013), Abidjan (since 2004), Douala/Kribi, Tema.

The Françafrique personnel map: Jacques Poignant — son of Bernard Poignant, Hollande's thirty-two-year friend — installed at Lomé under the "bienveillante" wing of Charles Debbasch (Gnassingbé's minister-adviser, the Vasarely-affairs convicted man, kept in place until 2012, the man Sarkozy had called a

"mercenaire" in 2007); Bernard Poignant then organized Gnassingbé's 2013 Lorient/Paris visit with Vincent Bolloré and convinced Hollande of conciliation; the €45.7M-equivalent investment announced 2011 (the quai plus railways to Niger, "où jamais un train n'a circulé," per Bolloré's own speech); the Hollande-era ostracism acknowledged by BAL's Senegalese chair Racine Sy after the 2013 Dakar deal ("notre retour est un symbole," after Wade had given the 2006 container terminal to DP World).

3.6 The historical canon: Elf, Karachi, Clearstream, Bettencourt, HSBC

Elf (1989–2003). France's state oil company as slush fund: €305 million siphoned in four years through the "caisse noire" of the company's "commercial diplomacy." The 1994 COB (predecessor of the AMF) report opened it; judge Eva Joly's information judiciaire of August 18, 1994 ran for nine years. The trial record's own language, preserved: "au grand minimum 5 millions à chaque grand parti"; daily contact with the Élysée; the RPR-weighted caisse noire and Mitterrand's instruction to "rééquilibrer"; Bongo's €16.7M/yr and the 100-million-franc-CFA cash withdrawals; "le lobbying sans argent n'existe pas"; the Cresson/SISIE three-million-franc payment never pursued; the Kohl/Pfahls German tentacle. The November 12, 2003 verdict: Loïk Le Floch-Prigent five years/€375,000; Alfred Sirven five years/€1M (dead in prison February 12, 2005, mid-appeal); André Tarallo four years/€2M — never collected, per Le Monde's audit of the Trésor's blind spot in fine collection ("trop clinquantes vitrines"); €180M in civil damages; €18.6M in fines. Joly's own intimidation record preserved: tapped phone, nailed death threats, doubled protection she found more menacing than reassuring. **The Taiwan-frigate artery ran alongside:** Thomson's €2.5bn contract, €780M of commissions, the secret-défense wall, judge Jean-Pierre's Fabius naming, the ~10 suspicious deaths including DGSE officer Thierry Imbot's April 2000 "fall." The canonical closing fact: no politician was ever definitively

convicted in the whole affair.

Karachi (1994–2002). Three Agosta-class submarines to Pakistan (€825–850M) and the Sawari II frigates to Saudi Arabia (~€3bn), concluded under prime minister Édouard Balladur, with Nicolas Sarkozy as budget minister and campaign manager. The commission architecture was legal until 2000 ("frais commerciaux exceptionnels" — bribes to foreign officials were deductible), but *retro-commissions* — kickbacks back to France — were always criminal. Balladur imposed two Lebanese intermediaries, Ziad Takieddine and Abdul Rahman El-Assir, on DCN International at the last moment; the contract price was marked up so that Pakistani officials took 338 million francs while 216 million francs were added and returned toward France (Libération's 197-page contract scoop). Investigators traced some $111M in commissions, $50M in kickbacks, ~$2M as retro-commissions; judge Marc Trévidic's 2009 finding that the financial track was the only credible one and that the highest levels knew why payments stopped when Chirac halted them in 1995–96. The Cour des comptes validated Balladur's campaign accounts on October 12, 1995, "de haute lutte" against its own rapporteurs, enabling state reimbursement. **The May 8, 2002 bombing** in Karachi killed 11 French DCN engineers (15 dead); judge Jean-Louis Bruguière's al-Qaeda thesis held for years until Trévidic's reprisal thesis: the attack as retaliation for the halted payments. The couriers: Nicolas Bazire (Balladur's chief of staff, now LVMH managing director, Sarkozy's wedding witness) and Thierry Gaubert (Sarkozy's thirty-year friend),

both detained in 2011, accused by their ex-wives (Princess Helen of Yugoslavia: "voluminous bags" of Swiss cash; Nicola Johnson, Takieddine's ex-wife, the document source). The judicial ladder: 2009 first convictions; June 2020 six convicted (Takieddine five years); the Cour de justice de la République (the court for ministers) March 4, 2021: Balladur relaxed, François Léotard two years suspended; Paris appeal January 2025 confirming Takieddine's five years, Dominique de Villepin's former chief of staff… the appeal's roster: Donnedieu de Vabres four years/€50,000, Gaubert one year firm commuted/€60,000, El-Assir four years in absentia, Castellan two years — while the victims' families' claims were declared irreceivable and both informations judiciaires (attack and financing) remain formally open. Plus the New Left Review's Villepin nugget — the discreet Élysée unit created in 1995 to hunt the Balladur war chest, and Chirac barring Sarkozy from flying to Riyadh on the eve of the MIKSA signing in 2004.

The Lafayette/Taiwan money (the parallel artery). The 1991 contract: six Lafayette frigates at $2.8 billion. The commissions: more than $900M passed through twenty-plus Wang-family accounts frozen in 2001–2003, of which **$138.04M restituted to Taiwan on July 11, 2023**, on a 50–50 sharing basis with Berne. The middleman Andrew Wang died in 2015. The French-side judicial outcome — the Yin Ching-feng murder trigger (the Taiwanese captain about to blow the whistle, murdered December 1993) and decades of French non-prosecution under secret-défense — remains the open leg; judge Jean-Pierre's book, the Fabius naming, and the

suspicious deaths are in the record. Le Parisien's October 21, 2003 summary is the anchor quote: "CINQ MILLIARDS de francs (750 millions d'euros) de commissions occultes, huit morts, des enquêtes dans cinq pays, et un secret-défense"; the Swiss judge Paul Perraudin alerted police to death threats during his own inquiry (Le Temps, May 2005); Wikipedia's own summary concedes that "certaines personnes liées à ce dossier ont trouvé la mort d'une manière inexpliquée."

Clearstream (2004–2011). The fake listings: in 2004, fabricated Clearstream bank-account listings naming politicians — including Sarkozy and senior Socialists — were fed to investigating judges via General Philippe Rondot, in the context of the Taiwan-frigates commissions. July 27, 2007: Villepin placed under investigation for "complicité de dénonciation calomnieuse"; November 18, 2008: sent to trial with four others. September 23, 2009: the unprecedented — a sitting president, Sarkozy, interviewed on TF1 from New York, declaring the accused "coupables" days before the verdict. The September 21–October 23, 2009 trial: Rondot's eight-hour testimony, the prosecution's requisitions: 18 months suspended for Villepin. January 28, 2010: **relaxé** — acquitted — in a 326-page judgment with Gergorin convicted (three years, 15 firm) and Lahoud (three years, 18 firm). January 29, 2010: the parquet appealed the relaxe — an appeal the magistrates' unions and Franceinfo openly suspected of Élysée pressure, with Villepin calling it "political." The May 2011 re-trial; **September 14, 2011: relaxe confirmed** in a 103-page arrêt that inverted the roles (Lahoud the instigator, Gergorin the

"corbeau"). The institutional scar tissue preserved: the subordinated parquet's independence debate; Villepin's unanswered question about a sitting president sitting as partie civile atop the Conseil supérieur de la magistrature; the Bourgi parallel claims on the very eve of the appeal verdict — the Bongo-financed-1988-Le-Pen-campaign claim and the $20M Chirac/Villepin accusations that forced a diffamation counter-suit.

Bettencourt (2007–2015), both proceedings cleanly separated. *(1) The Banier-Bettencourt abuse-of-weakness case:* photographer François-Marie Banier convicted at Bordeaux on May 28, 2015 — three years (six suspended), €350,000 fine, €158M in damages; financial adviser Patrice de Maistre 30 months (12 suspended) and €250,000 fine plus €12M damages after his deal with Françoise Bettencourt-Meyers (he renounced appeal); on appeal (August 24, 2016): Banier four years suspended and €375,000, d'Orgeval 18 months suspended, notary Bonduelle relaxed, lawyer Pascal Wilhelm one year suspended plus €3M damages, and the damages collapsed to a symbolic €1 after the 2010 family reconciliation. *(2) The Woerth-Bettencourt campaign-finance and influence-peddling case:* Éric Woerth — treasurer of Sarkozy's 2007 campaign and budget minister — **relaxed on both counts on May 28, 2015**, closing the file that had opened with Claire Thibout's €50k-cash claim against him and Sarkozy, with de Maistre's letters contradicting Woerth's testimony. The counter-scandal preserved: prosecutor Philippe Courroye's illegal surveillance of journalists from Le

Monde — the same Courroye whose name recurs in the Clearstream feeding chain.

HSBC/SwissLeaks (2008–2017). Falciani's files, handed to French authorities end-2008: 127,000 accounts, 79,000 individuals, 180 nationalities. The French administration's quantification: at least €1.67 billion in sums fraudulently withheld with the bank's help; the SwissLeaks operation of February 2015 (the Le Monde-led ICIJ consortium) revealed €180.6bn transiting the Swiss accounts between November 2006 and March 2007. HSBC Private Bank placed under investigation November 18, 2014. **November 14, 2017: the first-ever CJIP** — €300 million, decomposed as €86.4M disgorgement, €71.6M additional penalty for "minimal cooperation," and €142M state damages — roughly 20% of the fraud, no conviction recorded. The personal residue: ex-CEO Peter Braunwalder's CRPC in January 2019 (one year suspended, €500,000, not entered on the criminal record). The Belgian parallel ~€300M. The comparator ladder: UBS's failed CJIP talks followed by the record €3.7bn February 2019 verdict (appealed); Crédit Suisse ~€238M; Santander €22.5M (December 2025). The systemic insight from the criminal-law literature, preserved verbatim: a convicted bank loses licenses worldwide — which is exactly why the deal was struck. The CJIP table it opened, complete: HSBC €300M (2017); Société Générale €250M (2018, the PNF's second-ever CJIP, the LIA corruption dossier — alongside the bank's US settlements: $275M DOJ + $475M CFTC on Libor, $292M DOJ on Libya, totaling $1.34bn, then the November 2018 $1.34bn sanctions

settlement on Cuba/Iran/Sudan and the 2017 ACPR €5M AML blame); Carmignac €30M; Google €500M plus €465M fiscal settlement (September 2019); Airbus €2.08bn (2020, coordinated with the DOJ/SFO — the Libyan CJIP of November 2022 added €15.8M; the Exclusive Networks CJIP of 2025, €16M, was the first triggered by a compliance officer); McDonald's France €508M (2022); Crédit Agricole CIB €88.2M (September 8, 2025, the cum-cum montages); HSBC Bank plc €267.5M (January 8, 2026) — with BNP Paribas, Société Générale and Natixis still targeted on the same intragroup dividend arbitrages, the PNF stating an enjeu of over €4 billion, and the cum-cum macro-frame preserved at €1–3bn/yr cost to the state. Total: ~70 CJIPs, €2bn+ collected, no conviction.

The banks' American fines (the extraterritorial canon). BNP Paribas' June 30, 2014 guilty plea and $8.9bn fine for Sudan/Iran/Cuba sanctions violations — decades of wire "stripping" via the Geneva subsidiary, internal alerts since 2005, a one-year dollar-clearing suspension in oil and gas from January 1, 2015, five executives sacrificed including chief operating officer Chodron de Courcel, Hollande's personal intercession with Obama failing, governor Noyer's complaint on dollar hegemony. The 2025 sequel: the October 17, 2025 New York jury verdict finding BNP complicit in Sudanese atrocities ($20.75M to three plaintiffs, 23,000 potential claimants signaled, the stock dropping 8–10.5% and dragging SG and Crédit Agricole; no provision booked; appeal vowed by February 9, 2026). The structural frame: European banks paid ~$16bn in US penalties 2009–2014; Siemens paid $800M in

2008; the Defence ministry's own doctrine paper now cites the BNP case as the textbook of extraterritorial "economic warfare."

3.7 The newer files: McKinsey, Fonds Marianne, Uber Files, MoDem, Thales

McKinsey. The Senate commission's demolition (report March 16–17, 2022, senators Bazin and Assassi): ministry consulting spend more than doubled from €379.1M to €893.9M (2018–2021, +45% in 2021 alone); strategic consulting nearly tripled from €152.5M to €445.6M; non-IT spend €177M (2014) → €247.5M (2021); the operators' sample (SNCF, La Poste, EDF, RATP — the Big-4's parapublic circuit) €324.2M/yr — over €1 billion with IT in 2021, concentrated in five ministries (Interior, finance, armed forces, ecology, social affairs — the social ministries multiplying strategy spend twentyfold during COVID). The minister's "stable ~€140M" claim dismantled as a partial average excluding IT and operators. The FEACO comparator: France's public consulting market €657M in 2018 versus Germany's €3,143M and the UK's €2,640M — 1.56€ per 1000€ of state opex versus 6.76 UK and 7.20 Germany. The flagship contracts: >€12M for the COVID vaccination campaign; €4M for the APL reform; €1M for a CNAV reorganization study preceding a pension reform that never happened; €500k for an "évolution du métier d'enseignant" study for a colloquium that never occurred. The fiscal scandal: zero French corporate tax paid 2011–2020 on an estimated €329M French turnover in 2020. The judicial machine: PNF preliminary probe March 31, 2022 (aggravated tax-fraud laundering, after the Senate's false-testimony referral); perquisitions May 24 and December 13, 2022 (McKinsey HQ,

and — the second wave — Renaissance HQ); **two informations judiciaires opened October 20–21, 2022**: illegal campaign financing (tenue non conforme des comptes de campagne 2017/2022) and favoritisme + recel de favoritisme on public contracts. The crux: roughly twenty McKinsey consultants worked undeclared for candidate Macron from 2015 — named: Karim Tadjeddine (now head of the firm's French public-sector practice), Eric Hazan, Guillaume de Ranieri — none in the campaign accounts, with investigators testing whether the subsequent €28–50M in public missions was the contrepartie. Sherpa civil party since June 12, 2025. The reform bill the Senate passed still awaits the Assembly. The October 31, 2025 sequel: after the 2022–23 cuts, 2024 spending rebounded +31% to €96.1M (2023: €73.4M) — Lecornu's office seizing the "État efficace" mission to analyze the rise.

Fonds Marianne. €2.5 million created April 20, 2021 by Marlène Schiappa (minister déléguée for citizenship) six months after Samuel Paty's assassination, targeting online counter-discourse for 12–25 year-olds. The collapse: seventeen associations selected in weeks, two absorbing ~€1.3M; USEPPM (Mohamed Sifaoui administrator, main beneficiary ~€355,000) "not eligible" for both its object and its declaration failures per the IGA's May 31 report; production below targets; Mediapart's finding that the funded content targeted left politicians (Hidalgo, Mélenchon) during the 2022 presidential and legislative campaigns — state money producing electoral content. Schiappa's fingerprints, per Le Monde's serial disclosures: she personally cut €100,000 from SOS Racisme's

grant; her cabinet's involvement; the Senate rapporteur's conclusion that she lied to the commission. The institutional cascade: préfet Christian Gravel's resignation (June 6, 2023); the Senate commission's verdict "fiasco" and "dérive d'un coup politique"; the IGA's "manque de rigueur, opacité et désinvolture." PNF information judiciaire opened May 4, 2023 (détournement de fonds publics by negligence, abus de confiance, prise illégale d'intérêts); perquisitions June 13, 2023 (Sifaoui, Gravel, Menouni). Schiappa left government July 20, 2023 — and received the Légion d'honneur on June 23, 2025, mid-procedure, prompting General Lecointre's public comment on the "embarrassing" timing. No public judicial evolution since: logged as a finding in itself.

Uber Files. The leak: 120,000+ documents from Mark MacGann (Uber's chief lobbyist for Europe, Africa, the Middle East, 2014–16) to The Guardian, published July 10, 2022 across the ICIJ consortium (42 outlets; Le Monde/France Info in France). The deal: first meeting October 2014 with four Uber executives; eighteen months of meetings, calls and SMS logged in MacGann's internal memos. UberPop — the illegal service — was suspended July 2015 under the loi Thévenoud, and in exchange Macron promised, in the words of his own interlocutors' notes, "faire en sorte que la France travaille pour Uber afin qu'Uber puisse travailler en et pour la France": the chauffeur training requirement cut from 250 hours to 7 in 2016; the Kalanick-Macron texts; the Marseille police ban revoked two days after Macron told Uber he would handle it personally; Uber providing "amendments clés en main" to

deputies; the alleged DGCCRF indulgence instruction (denied by DGCCRF). The toolbox beyond Macron: validating studies commissioned from credentialed economists (Nicolas Bouzou, Augustin Landier); Xavier Niel and Bernard Arnault recruited as investor-lobbyists ("Nous n'avons pas besoin de leur argent en soi. Mais ils pourraient être des alliés utiles pour gagner la France" — Gore-Coty's email); the "kill switch" deployed during police raids; the greyball deception tool. The parliamentary commission (November 2022–July 2023, Danielle Simonnet LFI rapporteuse) concluded July 18, 2023: "des alliés au plus haut niveau de l'État" and "une grande opération de manipulation," explicitly posing the contrepartie question and recording that "certains dirigeants d'Uber ont financé la campagne de M. Emmanuel Macron" (MacGann attended fundraisers "à titre personnel, privé," per Haddad's rebuttal). Macron's own defense — "j'étais hyperfier… je le referais demain et après-demain" — against MacGann's rejoinder about drivers barely earning a living. The collateral detail: Barrot déchargé of all Uber dossiers by decree July 22, 2022, his sister being Uber France/Western-Europe communications director. Mediapart's epithet in the record: "VRP d'Uber."

MoDem assistants. Origin: Corinne Lepage's 2015 book *Mains propres* (her refusal of the party's demand that one of her European assistants work at the Paris HQ). Enquête préliminaire June 9, 2017 — one month into Bayrou's justice ministry — forcing his June 21 resignation along with Sylvie Goulard's and Marielle de Sarnez's ministerial exits. Mise en examen December 6, 2019. The trial (October 16–November

21, 2023) over eleven contracts (~€250–350,000 — versus €4.4M for the RN; the court refused the "système" characterization for MoDem while applying it to the RN, at fifteen times the money). February 5, 2024 verdict: eight convicted — five ex-MEPs including Jean-Luc Bennahmias (10–18 months suspended, €10–50k fines, two-year suspended ineligibility); ex-keeper Michel Mercier 18 months/€20k; the UDF fined €150k (€100k firm); the MoDem €350k (€300k firm) — while **Bayrou was relaxed "au bénéfice du doute"** on the court's own finding that it was "très probable" the acts were committed with "l'autorisation de M. Bayrou," but that proof was lacking. The parquet appealed February 8, 2024 (all three relaxes, including ex-DGS Stéphane Thérou and Pierre-Emmanuel Portheret). The appeal trial ran September 9–October 5, 2026 — Bayrou invoking Dreyfus at his September 24 interrogation, Patrick Mignola pleading for the two party-persons, the parquet requisitioning two years suspended, €50,000 and three years' suspended ineligibility with the line "vous ne trouverez pas de traces… mais il y a une série d'indices," against Cornut-Gentille's "Vous ne trouverez pas de traces ? Moi, je dis, vous ne trouverez pas de preuve" and Casanova's escalation mockery ("Le +système+ a connu sa petite mort, alors on est passé au +systémique+, et maintenant aux +actes répétés+"; Teitgen's closing warning that the prosecution itself feeds the "Tous pourris"). Material stakes: European Parliament prejudice €300k, the parties each facing €100k, Casanova's "moins de 0,37% du budget UDF-MoDem sur cette période." **Verdict: December 17, 2026** —

announced by the Paris cour d'appel on October 2, 2026 — seventeen days before Christmas, months into the shadow of his former premiership. The calendar collision preserved: his retrial overlapped exactly the Lecornu II government's formation.

The parallel files swept in: Mélenchon's European-assistants probe ending May 27, 2026 with **no mise en examen after eight years** — the October 16, 2018 Oclciff raids on fifteen sites and the "La République, c'est moi" perquisition scene preserved, with his December 2019 Bobigny conviction (three months suspended, €8,000) as the only judicial residue.

Thales/Azerbaijan. The PNF has investigated since June 2023; June 2024 raids on Thales premises in several countries. Mehmet Sahan — dual French-Turkish, Thales's man in Baku for seven years (May 2014–April 2021) — has been jailed there since February 17, 2022 on the company's own complaint: accused of embezzling ~€5M of operating funds; definitive sentence April 2026: ten years and €4M (embezzlement and forgery). His claim, per Le Monde's two-parter (October 9–11, 2026): retaliation for having probed Thales corruption circuits. Thales's answer: "unfounded, we are the victim, zero tolerance." The Quai d'Orsay is "monitoring." The state holds 27% of Thales. The adjacent live files from the global registries: South Africa/Zuma corruption proceedings (ongoing June 2025); the UK SFO bribery probe (November 2024); the London court blocking the alleged Thales middleman's extradition to India (February 2025); the Indian aircraft-maintenance contract probe open since 2023; the

Scorpene-linked Najib Razak allegations (May 2025).

3.8 The resource files: Kazakhstan, Niger, UraMin, Mozambique

Kazakhgate. The October 27, 2010 announcement of the package — 45 EC145 Eurocopter helicopters, an Astrium satellite center, 295 Alstom locomotives (~$2bn) — signed June 27, 2011, ten days after the Belgian penal-transaction law benefited Patokh Chodiev (the Uzbek-born, Belgian-passport oligarch who paid a €23M transaction to escape a corruption conviction rooted in the 1996 Tractebel €25M bribe, while his lawyer Armand De Decker allegedly collected over €700,000). The paper trail: Sarkozy adviser Jean-François Étienne des Rosaies' June 19, 2011 email to Guéant's office (the "PR": charges against Chodiev dropped two days earlier, "un texte de loi a été voté… organisé et suscité par Armand De Decker," who had "sensibilisé trois ministres"); the June 28 note proposing a meeting with "le ministre d'État Armand De Decker, que l'État français oubliera de remercier"; and above all **Guéant's handwritten card of August 18, 2011** to Élysée diplomatic adviser Damien Loras: "J'ai eu A. De Decker au téléphone… magnifique travail… Mon souci maintenant est très prosaïque: c'est que les avocats qui ont travaillé pour Chodiev soient maintenant rémunérés… Pouvez-vous toucher ou faire toucher Chodiev?" The money the judges found: Mediapart's September 2015 revelation of internal Eurocopter/EADS emails contemplating a 4% occult commission to a Kazakh oligarch (the €12M track); the February 2016 Suresnes perquisition surfacing an €8.8M suspect payment tied to satellite sales. The

judicial arc: Tracfin's alert on a transfer to Étienne des Rosaies' account opening the March 18, 2013 information judiciaire (blanchiment en bande organisée, corruption of foreign officials); his mise en examen March 2015; ex-senator Aymeri de Montesquiou's immunity lifted the same day as Balkany's in March 2015 (his campaign accounts later invalidated by the Constitutional Council in June 2022 with one-year ineligibility and a HATVP probe); Guéant's May 2018 garde à vue; **Airbus placed témoin assisté June 22, 2018** (Le Monde, CEO Enders heard as witness). The Belgian mirror: the 2016–18 Van der Maelen commission (16 months, 170 hearings) condemning De Decker "unanimément" while deadlocking on everything else; Chodiev's failed 2019 suit against Gilkinet for the leaks; the dissent preserved (Sophie de Wit's ethics charges; the OSI "myth-busted" counter-investigation; the espionage subplot — TOR-network hack of Green MEPs and a US corporate-intelligence firm allegedly hired by Chodiev's lawyers per Intelligence Online).

Niger — the uranium canon. The 1967 accord's "prix Niger" mechanism — negotiated annually at Somaïr/Cominak boards, supposed to track the world market; the discounts ran 40,000 FCFA/kg (€61) against a 126,000 FCFA (€192) spot reference, with customs/VAT/fuel exemptions plus the "provision pour reconstitution de gisement" letting Areva set aside 20% of profits tax-free (the 2013 Oxfam/ROTAB leakage audit). The thirty-year balance sheet, 1989–2020: ~100,000 tonnes exported for ~5,100 billion FCFA (2020 constant), of which the Nigerien state captured 760 billion — under 15% (10.4%

excluding the boom years 2008–14, nearly half the total). The redevance math: +2 points (5.5→7.5%) would have brought +2 billion FCFA/yr, 43 billion since 2008. The political war, preserved verbatim: Tandja's €300bn-FCFA-total claim; the 2007 expulsion of two Areva cadres accused of financing the MNJ Touareg rebellion to block competitors; the Nigerien minister's 2014 climbdown under low prices ("pourrait renoncer à durcir"); the long-delayed 2014 deal signed only May 26–27, 2014 under pressure. The modern file: the May 4, 2023 global partnership accord — Somaïr's concession extended to 2040 (from 2029), Imouraren's exploitation postponed with an €85M ISR-testing budget and a 2028 investment-decision gate (the deposit: 471M pounds probable + 138M indicated, among the world's largest; awarded 2009, suspended 2014 on prices), a €40M social package by 2030; Cominak closed March 2021 after 80,000 tonnes over forty years with two decades of remediation ahead. The coup's accounting: Orano removed Somaïr, Cominak and Imouraren from its consolidated accounts on December 1, 2024, formally recognizing the loss of operational control on December 4; yet 2024 was "exceptional" — revenue €5.87bn (+23%), EBITDA €2.067bn (from €1.228bn), driven by the La Hague Japanese waste-return contracts. The pivot ledger: Mongolia Zuuvch Ovoo ($500M over four years, $1.6bn lifetime, ops from 2028–29, 2,500 tU/yr), Uzbekistan/Canada options, Trekkopje reactivation, US enrichment Project IKE in Tennessee.

UraMin — the flagged file. The 2007 purchase (€1.8bn) and 2011 write-down (€2.5bn) of the uranium miner, under judicial

information since 2013, with searches and indictments of former Areva executives (Oursel, Gamache, Pinet-Kaiser — misuse of corporate assets, forgery). Several dedicated research sweeps failed to surface the current procedural posture; the file is logged as real but unresolved — the honest gap, kept rather than hidden.

Mozambique — the fuller ledger. The March 2021 Palma attack; force majeure April 26, 2021; lifted November 7, 2025; full restart January 29, 2026 with Chapo at Afungi, 4,000 workers, 40% complete, first LNG 2029. Pouyanné's October 30, 2025 clarification: $20.5bn total with $4.5bn spent; the ten-year extension ask; Mozambique contesting the $2bn overrun with a Bayphase audit that couldn't confirm it; the French involuntary-manslaughter judicial investigation; Politico's torture/murder/rape reporting tied to site-based Mozambican troops; UKEF's $1.15bn withdrawal legal advice; ECA probes in the UK/NL/US/Korea; BankTrack's withdrawal call — the "massacre-linked relaunch" frame. The November 17, 2025 ECCHR criminal complaint to the PNAT: complicity in war crimes, torture and enforced disappearance over the Afungi "container massacre" (July–September 2021; 180–250 men in containers, 26 survivors per Alex Perry's investigation). The internal documents obtained via FOIA from public financiers (CDP, Atradius — the new Dutch documents pushing knowledge back to May 2020) showing TotalEnergies knew of JTF abuses yet kept supplying accommodation, food, equipment and soldier bonuses — withdrawable for violations, the mechanism preserved verbatim; the JTF's 2020 MoU between

Total's Tepma 1 and the Maputo government, "rompu en octobre 2023." The parallel Nanterre preliminary probe (manslaughter and failure to assist, opened March 2025 from the 2023 Palma-attack complaint); the carbon frame — 4.5 billion tonnes CO2e lifetime. The ECCHR's comparator cases preserved: Lafarge's ISIS-complicity trial and Sweden's Lundin war-crimes trial.

3.9 The remaining docket

The Nestlé Senate report (2026). The Senate's findings on the food giant's bottled-water operations in France — water-capture arrangements and their supervision — filed with the Senate's anticorruption series in the same season as the agricultural wars.

The EPPO files. The European Public Prosecutor's two live French recoveries: Réunion — €4M seized October 8, 2026 (POSEI/FEAGA agricultural subsidies 2019–2024, fraudulent takeover of a fruit-and-vegetable producers' cooperative by a private company's associates; Section de Recherches and GIR support); Corsica — an €18M probe into FEDER/REACT-EU recovery-plan public contracts, raids in Ajaccio May 27–28, 2026, homes, public bodies and private firms.

The democracy metrics. Transparency International's CPI 2025: France at 66/100, 27th — a two-decade slide from the top tier. The EIU Democracy Index 2025: France restored to "full democracy" at 26th (8.05; components: electoral 9.58, civil liberties 8.24, functioning of government 7.50, participation 7.78, political culture 6.88 — the sub-7 weak pillar), "at the

bottom of the full-democracy category," while the US fell to 34th.

The Suez corruption files. Tashkent: the Uzbek capital's water concession produced a Paris trial ending February 2024 with convictions — the PNF's probe (opened April 26, 2022, on the intersyndicale's complaint naming the intermediary Imad Lahoud; Nazarius crying foul via Les Électrons Libres) spanning Uzbekistan, Kazakhstan, Turkey and India; Suez opened a mandatory internal investigation May 2, 2022 (Stéphanne/Kalensky orders) and terminated it July 25, 2023 as the Veolia bid collapsed; the AFA's evaluation (August 25, 2022) caps sanctions at €1M/€200k — "awaiting judicial outcome." The Paris-wastewater ring: SIAAP contracts (Achères €773.76M, Clichy €341.2M, Valenton €397M cancelled by the prefect), OTV's deputy CEO admitting an €800k/yr "entertainment" budget for elected officials in garde à vue, the agency's decades of hidden financing of right-wing parties and the PCF; Apa Nova Bucharest (tariffs +125%, €12M of bribes per the DNA, PNF probe since 2016, HQ search January 2018, DOJ/SEC since 2017); Agbar/Operation Pokemon's web forcing Chaussade and Mestralet off the board in 2015. The trafic d'influence probe at the group's summit (Kohler, Frérot, Clamadieu, Déau — Déau's Meridiam and his prospective African water megadeal flagged; the unions' May 2021 mise en demeure preserving the November 26, 2020 seized documents as "éléments de preuve déterminants") remains open since June 18, 2021, with no closure found in any indexed record — a finding in itself.

The LVMH fiscal case. January 2024 (AFP/Mediapart/La Tribune): the DGFiP renounced fraude fiscale proceedings against the luxury group over LVMH Finance Belgique — "quasiment un an après" the February 2023 cassation that had annulled the 2020 appeal ruling quashing the DNEF's 2019 raids (1M+ documents across 64 entities seized, restitution ordered without copies). The case closed administratively without ever reaching a tribunal — the #1 fortune added to the negotiated-leniency canon.

The enforcement institutions' current leadership. The PNF: Jean-François Bohnert proposed out October 13, 2025 by Darmanin with Macron's assent, gone December 8, 2025 to procureur général at Versailles (succeeding Cimamonti, paired with first president Beynel); Pascal Prache, the directeur des services judiciaires, announced October 13, 2025 and in the chair from **January 5, 2026** — now running the Le Pen cassation, Dati, Thales and Philippe files. The profile preserved from Le Monde's own account of the Bohnert era: a PNF chief whom "nombre de ses pairs reprochent ouvertement de n'agir que s'il est acculé," with "les classements sans suite qui s'accumulent" — the stall mechanism named at the top (Pattern Eleven). The AFA: Isabelle Jégouzo, director since July 26, 2023 on the six-year non-renewable, legally shielded mandate (deputy Alice Navarro; the November 2024 bicéphale reorganization); its July 9, 2026 decision n° 25-01 delivered the agency's **first-ever direct monetary sanction** under Article 17 Sapin II — €350,000 on the company plus €60,000 on the president personally, seven of eight compliance pillars judged

non-compliant, the company anonymized as a sensitive sector, "the era of pedagogy is over." The 175-control history 2017–2026; the ports campaign feeding the narcotrafic law; Jégouzo's line that prison staff carry the highest probity-case count in the public service — plus the Guadeloupe ledger she and Prache unveiled October 16: 56 cases, 77 convictions 2018–2025, and Martinique's six open investigations across four administrations including the gendarmerie.

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PART FOUR — THE MONEY PIPELINE

4.1 The fortunes

The 500 largest French fortunes totaled **€1,076 billion in 2026** — down from 2025's record €1,128/1,129bn, the first decline after three record years, but six-and-a-half times their size twenty years ago (+564% against +38% consumer prices). The year-by-year ladder: 2024's record €1,228bn; 2025's €1,128bn with the historic upset (the Hermès heirs at €163.4bn, +5%, ending Arnault's run at #1 since 2017 as he shed €74bn in one year to €116.7bn); 2026's €1,076bn with Arnault restored at €121.2bn and Hermès second at €114bn. The 2026 top ten, complete: Arnault 121.2 / Hermès heirs 114 / Wertheimer (Chanel) 95 / Bettencourt-Meyers (L'Oréal) 69.7 / Saadé (CMA CGM) 31.5 — down from 35 on the Middle-East shipping squeeze — / Niel 30.1 / Dassault 27.7 — down €7.9bn, the year's second-biggest drop — / Mulliez 27 / Pinault 19.2 / Besnier 14.2. **153 billionaire families** (+8 y/y, roughly ten times the ranking's first edition), with George Clooney, naturalized late-2025, entering at €250M. The editor's own framing preserved: French billionaires' average fortune is twice the British and German; "la France est devenue un hotspot de milliardaires" — with Niel's line that France is a tax haven quoted back at him.

The distributional frame, from INSEE's own 2024 patrimony survey (the €19,559bn national patrimony, +2.6%): households hold €14,953 billion of it — 76.5%, 8.2 times their net

disposable income; €9,967bn non-financial (half the nation's real-asset stock) plus net financial wealth of +€4,986bn against €2,112bn of credits. The distribution preserved to the percentile: median gross €205,100; bottom decile €6,200; top decile €857,700; top 5% €1.27M; top 1% €3.02M. Concentration: the top 10% hold 48% of the gross mass while the bottom 50% hold 7%; the top decile of financial wealth holds 64% of that component; the top 1% hold 68% of professional patrimony, 25% of financial, 15% of the total. The age curve: average €104k under 30, peak €470k at 55, €420k over 70. The composition: 61% real estate / 22% financial / 11% professional / 6% residual on average. INSEE's own warning is the file's most quotable line: the Gini on patrimony is "historically much higher than on income."

The 2003–2007 first leg (€124bn → €280bn), the 2008 crash erased within years, the 2015–2023 acceleration — the chronology preserved. **The methodological caveat now on the record:** at end-2025, Bernard Arnault became the **sole owner of Challenges**, the magazine that publishes this ranking, after buying Claude Perdriel's stake, triggering journalist departures — the man at the top of the ranking owns the ranking.

4.2 Party finance: €64.1 million and the rules that shape it

The state's party financing (CNCCFP; the 2026 envelope fixed by décret September 4, 2025 at **€64.1 million**): the first fraction (€30,077,144.37) distributed by votes, the second (€34,148,730.90) by declared parliamentarians. Concentration: twelve parties take ~80%; the top three ~40% of a given year; ~€8M/yr redistributes to ~57 non-eligible satellite parties — the micro-party laundering vector the CNCCFP itself flagged. The 2026 league table: the RN's first fraction surged to €10.06M thanks to the 2024 dissolution result (vs ~€6.8M/yr previously); EPR €5.84M; LFI €4.14M; PS €3.20M; LR collapsed to €1.04M first-fraction but tops the second at €6.42M thanks to its 125 senators.

The rules: donations capped at €7,500/yr/person (66% tax credit capped at 20% of income; €15,000 per household); campaign donations €4,600/person/election; cash capped at €150; corporate donations banned since 1995 (the loi Balladur); foreign donations banned; the 2017 law confined loans to EEA banks — the trigger for the RN's workarounds. The *funnel's* soft spot, preserved verbatim from the OECD governance review: the CNCCFP transmits files to the parquet "only in cases of manifest and apparently intentional violation" — its "marge d'appréciation" — against the Bygmalion precedent, where a whole party apparatus ran fictitious invoices through the official supplier for years under the commission's own controls; ~2% of campaign accounts

rejected historically (2.5% post-2007, 2.1% post-2012). The 2027 cycle runs on the commission's new fully-digital, AI-assisted platform (guide September 8, 2025).

The RN's foreign-loan constellation. 2014: **€9.4M from the First Czech Russian Bank** (confirmed publicly November 23, 2014; Mediapart says it was tranche one of a €40M package; Le Pen: "accusations délirantes"); the FCRB's bankruptcy → the debt bought March 2015 by Conti Ltd; 2016 → the Russian firm Aviazapchast; 2019 default threat → Moscow court amicable settlement (€1M in five days + €8M by end-2028); September 19, 2023: the RN announces anticipated full repayment, €6,088,784 all-in. 2017: **€8M from Laurent Foucher** (African-based businessman, close to Claude Guéant) transiting a UAE bank — PNF probe opened 2016 on Jean-Luc Schaffhauser's intermediary commissions (both loans), Tracfin flagging the Foucher funds' origin in 2019, Schaffhauser's home and office raided, his confirmation that he was paid for "both loans." 2022: **€10,691,775 from MKB Bank (Hungary)** — precisely the state reimbursement for reaching round two (Le Pen's own declared figure; the Hungarian bank chosen because post-2017 law barred non-EEA lenders; the promised state "banque de la démocratie" — Bayrou's 2017 price — never created). The retail layer: the "emprunts patriotes" (5% interest, €20M+ outstanding to individuals end-2023) now under PNF investigation after the July 9, 2025 perquisitions — the CNCCFP's Charpy warning that they become illegal "dons déguisés" if not repaid. The RN's books: €18.9M debt against €7.9M assets (-€11M) before its 2024

legislative rebound; the party apparatus financed by Cotelec's €6M loan (Jean-Marie Le Pen's micro-party) in the presidential race.

The 2017 macronist machine. Christian Dargnat — ex-BNP Paribas Asset Management CEO (2006–2016), Macron's 2008 recruiter into Rothschild having been Serge Weinberg (Sanofi chair, who told Envoyé spécial and Anne Fulda he and Macron were "très copains," confirming Macron planned his own consulting firm before politics) — ran the fundraising: €15,994,076 in donations March 2016–December 2017, ~99,361 donations, but **48% from just ~1,212 donations of €4,500 or more** — roughly 800 individuals funding half the campaign (Franceinfo's CNCCFP-file analysis; Frustration's count: 913 "poissons pilotes" organizing dinners where each guest gave the legal max). The leaks-revealed names: Olivier Berggruen; Sylvie Goulard's ex-employer channeling via Dargnat; Thierry Déau of Meridiam — the "dîners londoniens" raising >€1M from ~1,000 UK-based donors (the Guyana hydrogen plant later winning a record-fast authorization; Déau's name recurring in the Suez-Veolia file); Gilles de Margerie, dinner host July 2016 → health-minister chief of staff two weeks after the win. The foreign-resident skew: 14% of donations (€1.8M), the UK alone €800k — more than the nine biggest French cities' 4.3% combined; 18 Lebanon donations (€105k) outgunning Toulouse and Nantes together. The legal triple-stack letting one couple give ~€24,200–40,000; the Tirana and Zurich same-day virements pattern; the €24,200 single virement refunded for over-the-cap then re-split; the

one-million-euro block of 251 near-identical €4,600 campaign donations. The in-kind advantages: headquarters hosted discreetly by employers (Mediapart's April 2016 exposé; the Kremlin-Bicêtre address change the day of publication); the contested extras (€29,042 for thirty-five makeup sessions; event-industry "gifts"). Fillon's financing, for contrast: €10M from the primary's €2/head fees and only sixty-one big donations; Le Pen financed by Cotelec's €6M; the 2022 follow-up: the Dargnat alumni circle fundraising relaunched (target €5M) months before candidacy.

The abolished slush fund (historical baseline). The parliamentary reserve — ~€147M in 2017, ~€130k per parliamentarian per year distributed at total discretion (Gérard Collomb's Lyon distribution skewed to right and center-right mayors per Mediacités); killed in the 2017 moralization law with payments running out to 2024; the Senate's defense (0.03% of state spending; the Conseil d'État's allocation-role reading); the compensations (DETR +€50M, FDVA +€25M; the June 2018 décret denying parliamentarians seats on the FDVA board; Chevrollier's Mayenne math: €650–800k/yr lost). The pre-2017 IRFM flat-fee regime (€72.2M/yr both chambers) that the commission pour la transparence found produced personal enrichment "oscillating between €1,400 and €200,000" per mandate with no restitution ever required — killed by the 2017 reform the Cahiers of the Revue des finances publiques had called a "manne financière scandaleuse." The IRFM's afterlife: the HATVP's referrals produced nine PNF procedures (three deputies, six senators), all characterized as détournement de

fonds publics, **all classés sans suite on the single condition of repaying €6,707–€47,299, the parliamentarians' identities never published** (Pattern Eleven).

4.3 The lobby: 4,103 entities, 41,779 declarations, €11.9 billion of public contracts

The HATVP register (live October 17, 2026): 4,103 entities ever registered, 3,723 active; 41,779 activity declarations in the last 24 months; Parliament targeted in 70,759 cumulative activities, the government 60,549, the Élysée 15,150; top sectors health 11%, agriculture 10.7%, environment 10.2%; 54.7% of activities target legislation; 275 entities in default (248 for 2025); **395 lobby-entities also hold 8,482 public contracts worth €11.9bn over 24 months** — top: Engie 310 contracts/€2.15bn, TotalEnergies 441/€706M, EDF 347/€550M (legal, flagged). EU register: 1,685 French-sited entities of 17,990. The 2025 decree: foreign-state-directed lobbyists must register (FARA-inspired); the foreign-influence register (law n°2024-850 of July 25, 2024) operational October 1, 2025 via the Argos téléservice (15-day registration; quarterly declarations from January 2026; annual turnover disclosures per foreign principal).

The unfinished law: two 2023 bills (one décretal, one legislative) still pending since the 2024 dissolution; the Council of Europe's rule-of-law monitoring names the open wound — disclosure binds lobbyists, **not officials at top-executive level**, against GRECO's March 2024 recommendation; the HATVP's own 2022 proposals preserved verbatim (10-action

threshold at legal-entity level; declarations extended to communications initiated *by* public officials; consolidated group declarations); the Le Gendre/Untermaier initiative of May 3, 2023; the Senate's December 9, 2025 amendment seeking +€570k and six ETP for the HATVP's foreign-influence workload ("l'absence de compétences internes spécifiques"); LCP's September 30, 2026 notice on the pending reinforcement bill (patrimoine, pantouflage, lobbying).

Think tanks (the money beneath the ideas): Institut Montaigne — 100+ corporate funders (AXA, Engie, Solvay, BNP Paribas, LVMH, TotalEnergies, Vinci, Carrefour), a flat corporate fee scaled to turnover, no public money, the 66% tax credit on donations (Julia Cagé's analysis of the model); Terra Nova (macronist-adjacent, same model, different donor pool); Fondation Jean-Jaurès (PS); IFRAP (liberal). **MEDEF:** ~€40M/yr scale, federation dues (industry ~38% of dues, BTP ~12%); its July 2, 2026 "contribution" of ~fifty deficit-reduction measures — the wish list preserved verbatim (retirement at 65, frozen index, +2.3 points of TVA, end of the big-corps surtax); TotalEnergies alone declares €3–3.5M/yr of EU lobbying. **GIFAS** (the aero-space federation): CORAC R&D funding €300M/yr 2026–27, CIR/CII preservation, LPM execution with its +€36bn envelope, the €800M France 2030 CORAC roadmap, European preference in procurement. **ANIA** (food industry): declared 25 clients / ≤€300k; the Nutri-Score war documented — amendments clés en main handed to parliamentarians (Le Figaro), the 2020 Convention citoyenne ad-ban counter-operation, the 2023 revolving door

(communications director joining agriculture minister Fesneau's cabinet), the FFAS "scientific lobbying" outfit and the Babusiaux pilotage-comité conflict-of-interest web Le Monde exposed, Com'Publics financing the "Club de la table française" parliamentary club; the 2026 tax-soda extension fight (€200–300M yield; the 2012 tax's €800M 2025 yield; president Jean-François Loiseau's "consumers will pay"); Lactalis's 15–20% budget share as the top funder (with the departures of big members weakening the body in 2024). **Vin & Société:** est. 1995, president Samuel Montgermont, budget €1.3M (2024), HATVP declarations ≤€75k (H2 2017) → €200k (2018), EU work via Arcturus and Anthenor; the parliamentary relay architecture (the Vigne, vin et œnologie study group >100 deputies plus the ANEV senators) that loosened the Évin law three times (1994/1996/1998) and opened internet wine advertising in 2015; Le Monde's 2018 kill of the Dufeu-Schubert amendment; Addictions France's décryptage (the "constellation à tiroirs," the Basset offensive against health actors, youth targeting, disinformation) against Cash Investigation's Pernod Ricard exposé (32 brands, €8bn+ 2020 revenue, Évin circumvention) — all set against the health ledger of >€3bn/yr of alcohol damage. **Professor Hercberg's testimony, the case-proof of lobby-drafted law:** "certains députés avaient proposé des amendements à la loi, rédigés en entier par les lobbys de l'industrie agroalimentaire" — with ANIA's language ("discriminatoire, réducteur, stigmatisant... attaque le patrimoine culinaire français... précipiterait le déclin économique") found "repris tels quels dans des documents

officiels des ministères de l'Économie et de l'Agriculture," and the evaluation-hijack tactic documented (the FFAS, "une structure entièrement financée par l'industrie," nearly supervising the Nutri-Score study until scientists' resignations forced independent conditions). No systemic French study of lobby-drafted amendments exists — the pattern is proven case-by-case (Uber's turnkey amendments; the agro-industrial model), flagged for what it is.

4.4 Tax, fraud, and corporate aid: the money that never appears as spending

Tax expenditures (the Cour des comptes' April 2026 evaluation). 467 *dépenses fiscales* diverted **€83.29 billion** from the 2024 budget — a quarter of net fiscal revenues — with 2025 estimated at €91.83bn (3.07% of GDP). The structural amputations: the niches absorb **46.4% of the income tax's product and 52.4% of energy excises** — what is not collected nearly equals what is, on those two levies. The historical arc: the 2008 "querelle des niches" (the Rapport Fouquet; Conseil d'État, June 23, 2008: ~200 income-tax niches at €39bn); 451 niches at €85.6bn (2016); €89.9bn (2017, the CICE alone at €15.7bn and the CIR at €5.5bn); ~470 today. The 2026 top fifteen (above €46bn combined): CIR €8bn; salarié à domicile €7.2bn; the 10% pension abattement €4.6bn; transmission-d'entreprise exemption €4bn; épargne salariale €2.9bn; reduced-TVA travaux €2.4bn; restaurant TVA €2.2bn; heures supplémentaires €2.2bn; donation credit €2.2bn; dépenses foncières €1.9bn. The environment-linked slice: 120 niches at €11.3bn; the fossil-specific €7.8bn (2017); the armateurs' tonnage tax at €5.6bn flagged for the COVID windfall era. And the dettedelafrance finding (October 12, 2026) that makes the level almost secondary: these amounts escape the forecast by €11bn on the single 2024 exercise; an unevaluated niche is not merely inefficient — it is unmeasured (the pacte Dutreil held as the never-evaluated exhibit).

Corporate aid (the four-perimeter war, definitively mapped). France Stratégie's concentric 2019 estimate (€223bn broad / €139bn narrow); the Clersé's €157bn (€205bn with declassified tax expenditures); the IGF's €88bn (€105bn); the Haut-Commissariat's July 2025 restatement (~€109bn narrow, €187bn broad); and the Senate commission d'enquête's July 8, 2025 verdict — **€211 billion au sens large for 2023** (€88bn tax expenditures + €75bn social-contribution reliefs + €7bn subsidies outside public-service compensation + €41bn Bpifrance interventions), €108bn au sens strict, 2,267 devices inventoried, explicitly a floor (excluding regional ~€2bn, communal, and EU money — €9–10bn of indirect-management/CAP aid per the IGF). The exchange preserved verbatim: Lombard's written refusal to update the France Stratégie table ("cette actualisation était impossible au regard de la charge de travail"), the lapidaire follow-up ("le graphique… a été réalisé par France Stratégie (un service du Premier ministre), selon sa propre méthodologie"), and four official numbers for the same object — the President's €98bn, the economy minister's €150bn, INSEE's €60bn floor, the Senate's €211bn. The historical baseline: the Audit de modernisation's 2005 figure (then already €65bn = 4% of GDP — "un peu plus que le total du budget de l'Éducation nationale, près de deux fois le budget de la Défense… €949 per inhabitant").

The CICE — the flagship, complete. Sold in 2013 on Pierre Gattaz's promised million jobs; the largest tax break in French history (the CGT's phrase). The cost ladder: €6.4bn (2014) →

€12.4bn (2015) → €12.9bn (2016) → €15.7bn (2017) → €19.4bn (2018) → €19.2bn (2019) → a tapering residue (€8.7/6.9/5.5/1.2/0.3bn through 2024) for a cumulative **€108.7bn** — plus the permanence it bought: €24.8–26.4bn/yr of employer-contribution reductions from 2019 onward (€156bn budgeted 2019–2024): the €20bn measure that became a €26bn annuity, the biggest quiet expense in the system. The employment verdicts across methodologies: the comité de suivi 2014 (recruitments quasi-absent from the uses); TEPP 45–115k versus the LIEPP's no-effect; OFCE ~140k (2015); France Stratégie's final ~100–160k (September 2020); the Banque de France trio's outlier 240k; the sectoral method's 400k gross / 160k net — against €125k per job per year (Fondation Jean-Jaurès) and the FO ledger of a €99.1bn shortfall by end-2018 plus €23bn (2017) and €20bn (2018). The emblematic Carrefour litigation (hundreds of millions received while cutting ~2,000 jobs 2013–17). The Senate's 2025 verdict — "pure logique de compétitivité," announcements were "effets de communication," no legal counterpart ever demandable — against the distributional fact (Le Monde's 2019 Décodéurs analysis: distribution to non-exposed sectors and non-tradable services) and Eckert's original critique ("profit to retail, private clinics, notaires, avocats, experts-comptables"). The evaluation war's methodological knife-fight preserved (the 351M-vs-2.16bn cost anomaly; Scellier's 25% over nine years against Pinel's 18%).

Fiscal fraud — the range war, definitively closed with the official admission that no official number exists. The

complete table: €2bn at the low end; the CPO 2007's €29–40bn; the Senate 2012's €30–36bn; the Cour des comptes' TVA-only ~€15bn (INSEE's €20–25bn); the €80–100bn Solidaires FP figure the Assemblée's report n°468 found "cohérent" within €80–120bn — against Moscovici's December 16, 2025 demolition ("mal cerné, mal chiffré, mal traité"; the 80–100bn claim "plus qu'une approximation, un fantasme"; "le débat est pollué par des fantasmes"). The institutional machinery of ignorance: Bercy running exactly three statisticians on the fiscal-gap estimate since September 2024; the 2027 deadline the Cour has demanded since 2019; France among the ~30% of OECD tax administrations publishing nothing. The recouvrement stagnation that indicts the fight: contrôle results flat at €20.1bn in 2024 versus €21.2bn in 2015 while total revenues grew +44%; actually recovered down to €11.4bn in 2025; the AN's own finding that AI-targeted controls produced less than 15% of 2023's €15.2bn; the recouvrement history 19→12→8→15.2. The corporate-abuse anchor: Tax Justice Network ranks France the EU's most-penalized state at $27bn/yr of corporate-tax loss (~1% of GDP; the $32.3bn figure for 2016–21 preserved). The detection-rate math — €15.2bn recouped in 2023 against an estimated 80–100, i.e. under 20% — with the DGFiP as "l'administration la plus sacrifiée," 4,000 posts cut since 2010 and the PLF 2025's 550-ETP cut. The medical-fraud ledger alongside: Cnam's €4.5bn partial estimate against the Cour des comptes' €5–10bn range and the 20–28% of wasteful-care findings worth €10–20bn of savings on a €250–260bn base.

Social fraud, for scale (the HCFiPS's January 13, 2026 note). Total €14bn in 2025 (52% work-related ≈ €7.3bn; 12% health professionals; 36% insured) — a €1bn inflation-driven increase but stable rates ~2% of contributions. Decomposition: régime général €4.8–6.3bn; micro-entrepreneurs €1.3–1.7bn; platforms €174M; MSA €345M (2.9% of its contributions). The redressement ladder: €321M (2013), €555M (2016), €541M (2017), €1.6bn (2024, +34%), €1.503bn (2025) against the announced €5.5bn five-year objective — with barely €150M actually recouped in 2025 (the €540M recouvrement target spanning the whole 2023–27 period). The benefit-fraud ledger: Cnaf €1.3–1.7bn (1.8–2.5% of prestations; the RSA alone 67% of detected indus). The CNIS 2017 grand-estimate: ~€30bn of dissimulated labor value in 2010 within €51.9bn of total corrections. The Previssima irony preserved: €1.5bn of redressements in print beside "fiscal fraud estimated at 80–100bn" — the asymmetry that fuels the consent-to-tax crisis.

The chèque énergie, Livret A, inheritance, Pinel, CEE, ARENH/VNU and PPE3 ledgers are told at full length in 4.9.

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4.5 Privatizations and nationalizations: the reconquest premium

The airport trilogy (with the control case). Toulouse-Blagnac: December 2014 announcement, July 2015 closing — 49.99% to CASIL Europe (the Friedmann Pacific/Shandong Hi-Speed consortium) for **€308 million**, against red flags now preserved (the consortium's president Mike Poon pursued by Chinese justice for corruption and then disappeared; the vehicle's "capital dérisoire de 10,000€" per the PARDEM inventory). The four-year management war ("gestion strictement mercantile et à court terme" — dividend maximization, reserve depletion, accounting-rule changes), the Chinese exit triggered when the State decided to retain ~10% and block Casil's option, and the December 30, 2019 finale — **Eiffage's ~€500M buyback**: Casil's €200M capital gain on a public infrastructure asset in four years, +65% (against Casil's own defense of €84M invested versus €60M contracted). Lyon-Saint-Exupéry: the Vinci Airports (51%)/CDC (24.5%)/Predica (24.5%) consortium paying **€535M for the State's 60%** (concession to 2047, ~10x EBITDA; Macquarie beaten; a Wauquiez recours threat), with Mediacités' subsequent file intact ("trésorerie siphonnée au profit des actionnaires, malaise social… soupçons de pollution au kérosène"). Nice-Côte d'Azur: Azzurra (Atlantia/ADR/EDF Invest) paying **€1.222bn for 60%** (concession to 2044; valuation €2.2bn; Estrosi's blocking of Turkish or Vinci buyers; Monaco entering Azzurra's capital June 2017). The State's

total: €308M + €535M + €1.222bn ≈ €2.07bn, officially earmarked "notamment dans la filière nucléaire, ainsi qu'au désendettement de l'État." The control case: Lyon-Métropole, which refused to sell its stake, runs its share of the airport at a profit. The ADP privatization — the fourth planned sale — was blocked by the **first-ever RIP** (2019): the mechanism's rules now documented (no subject on a law less than a year old; none rejected by referendum within two years; 10% of registered voters ≈ 4.7M signatures in nine months to trigger parliamentary debate or referendum), the government suspending the privatization on validation, the campaign stalling short. The ADP stake (50.6% of a ~€20bn market cap) stays in the APE portfolio.

The reference sale: Alstom's energy branch to GE, €12.3bn, 2014. Authorized November 5, 2014, by Macron as economy minister, over Arnaud Montebourg's failed Siemens-alliance counter-project. The sequence preserved: the DOJ's corruption case hanging over Alstom (bribes in Indonesia, Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Taiwan, Singapore, 2000–2011; **$772M fine** December 2014); executive Frédéric Pierucci jailed in New York from 2013 (14 months in all) — his book *Le Piège américain* (January 2019) arguing the US case was leverage for the sale; the Snowden revelation that the DOJ solicited NSA data on major French trade deals. Marleix's 2018 Assemblée commission concluded abandonment of national interests. The aftermath audit: 5,000 jobs cut versus 1,000 promised, €50M penalty, Belfort losing 1,200, patents to Switzerland, ~€1bn shifted to tax havens; **EDF bought back**

the Arabelle turbines for $1.2bn on February 10, 2022. The live judicial track: Le Monde's November 22, 2024 disclosure of a partial non-lieu in one volet alongside a parallel information judiciaire running since December 2022 on actors profiting from a presumed corrupt scheme; the Élysée refusing to answer; Hugh Bailey (Macron's adviser during the sale, later DG of GE France) under a *prise illégale d'intérêts* probe. **The 2025 deaths, logged with their pedigrees:** Olivier Marleix — Anticor's 2020 ethics-prize winner, LR group president 2022–24, found hanged July 7, 2025 at his Anet home; the Chartres prosecutor's investigation (autopsy July 9 at Rouen: asphyxia by hanging, no violence, moderate alcohol; closed July 30) concluded suicide — depression with multiple causes (sentimental, intimate, professional), months of psychiatric care, significant weight loss, a final phone conversation recovered from his device as trigger, two projects in flight (a completed manuscript found in his car, plans to join the Paris bar); the fourth deputy suicide of the Fifth Republic after Simon-Lorière 1977, Bérégovoy 1993, Demange 2008; his August 15 LinkedIn post explicitly linking his death to Denécé's as the twin suicides of the Alstom-GE critics. Éric Denécé — CF2R founder, ex-SGDN analyst, the sale's other loudest critic — found dead June 11, 2025, at 62; investigators retained suicide while his family and Ligne Droite formally rejected the thesis; the DGSI suicide cluster adjacent in the record (a June 3, 2025 officer found in his service car at Levallois; January 2025's two agents). Both logged; official findings stated; families' doubts recorded; nothing asserted beyond the record

(Pattern Ten).

The reconquest operations: Eramet (below); Aubert & Duval repatriated by Airbus-Safran-Tikehau in 2023; the 2026 synthesis now in the dossier (lessentieldeleco's March 22 inventory: Toulouse 500 vs 308, Arabelle back at $1.2bn, Aubert & Duval — under the thesis that "la protection initiale aurait, dans chaque cas, été moins onéreuse que le rachat"). The systematic study still does not exist; the case-method ledger is the dossier's form (Pattern, honestly bounded).

EDF (the renationalization): bought out in 2023 at €12/share (40% premium; €9.7bn cost; free float eliminated). The 2025 results, from the company's own communiqué (February 20, 2026): net profit €8.4bn (-26.3% from 2024's €11.4bn record), revenue €113.3bn, EBITDA €29.3bn; production 515 TWh with nuclear at **373 TWh — the highest in six years**; 26.5g CO2/kWh; €24bn of net investment; net debt down to €51.5bn; S&P upgraded to BBB+ (January 2026). The dividend the State receives on July 30, 2026: **€1bn against €2bn for 2024** (the 12% payout ratio reflecting the EPR2 buildout). Flamanville 3 at 100% power since April 27, 2026 — the reactor that cost €3.3bn → €23.7bn all-in and ran 12–13 years late. The EPR2 program: the devis updated to **€72.8bn (2020 euros)** from €51.7bn; Penly first, 2038; the final investment decision gated on EU state-aid approval and expected late 2026; the Cour des comptes' recommendation to "hold the FID." Hinkley Point C's cost-to-completion at $35bn and Sizewell C's FID with the £1.6bn Hinkley-knowledge payment logged alongside.

Eramet — the state becomes #1 shareholder. The spring run-up: the FT's April 8, 2026 revelation of the Duval family's mandate to Lazard; Eramet's denial-communiqué of April 8; the May 27 AGM authorization; the June 12 approach by Orion CMC (the US-UAE-backed consortium created with $1.8bn initial capital, eyeing the whole 37%). The October 12–13, 2026 wire (AFP, triple-sourced): **the State becomes Eramet's #1 shareholder via the ~€500M capital increase, overtaking the Duval family's 37.2%** — the mechanics (the APE's 27.1% subscription plus the purchase of part of the Duvals' preemptive rights with a 5% décote), both quotes preserved (Bories: "un jalon majeur… cette opération, indispensable pour assurer la pérennité financière du Groupe"; Lescure: "nous prenons un engagement ambitieux faisant de l'État le premier actionnaire"). The financial triage beneath: net debt €1.87bn at June 2026, H1 loss €146M ex-SLN, 2025's -€723M free cash flow and 5.5x leverage, Castellari's February 2026 exit days after his governance concerns reached the board (Bories interim CEO, "rumeurs infondées"; the CFO "mis en cause pour son management"; Enochsberg installed). The SLN cross-reference (2.5): ~€340M of state support, the ~€500M Duval-State recapitalization agreed in principle. Gabon's parallel claim (3.8's adjacency, restated for the money map): the May 11, 2026 Moanda accord (700kt/yr local processing by end-2031), the raw-export ban threat from January 1, 2029, the SEM's bid for ~5% — sovereignty priced per tonne.

Prony Resources — the other nickel file. The December 2020 rescue, from Vale's own release: a $1.1bn package — Vale

Canada contributing $555M to operational continuity; the consortium split (SPMSC provinces 30%, Compagnie Financière de Prony 30%, employees and locals 21%, Trafigura 19%); Tesla as non-shareholding technical advisor with a 42,000-tonne offtake; the French state's €442M total contribution including the financial guarantee. The governance tell preserved: PDG Antonin Beurrier "juge et partie" — the plant director selling to his own Trafigura-backed consortium after the New Century process collapsed. The December 2020 stoppage and 3,000 furloughed. The live coda: the Qatari-Cypriot group NBM's takeover of 74% (against a 65bn-CFP debt), the September 14, 2026 headline that the process was "menacé après le retrait du seul candidat," negotiations continuing with the province Sud and Paris.

4.6 Defense exports: the €21 billion machine and its lending arm

France exported **€21.24 billion of arms in 2025** (2024: €21.59bn; 2023 trough €8.2bn; 2022 record €27bn on the UAE contract), delivering €9.64bn under 4,113 licences (the parliamentary report's numbers). SIPRI's 2021–25 ledger: France the world's #2 exporter at 9.8% share. India is client #1 at €6.9bn (~a third): the 36 Rafale of 2016 (€7.87bn), the 26 Rafale-M (2024–25, $7.4–7.5bn — the naval export first), the Scorpène line (six Kalvari plus three more at Mazagon Dock), Safran's M88 assembly-line offer and Hyderabad MRO (November 2025), the BEL guided-bomb deal — and the **DAC's February 2026 approval of 114 additional Rafales**: ~€30bn in the French framing (€33bn per the June negotiation documents; 3.25 trillion rupees by conversion), 88 single-seaters plus 26 twin-seats, 94 of 114 to be assembled in India under Make in India, the official lettre de demande transmitted June 3, 2026, France's response due within two-to-three months, signature possible in 2027 — placing it at the center of Macron's February 16–19 India visit (the AI Impact Summit, the fourth presidential trip since 2017) and the June 13–14 Modi-Macron Nice meeting ahead of G7 Évian. Jaffrelot's line preserved ("le contrat du siècle"); the same DAC day approving Boeing's $43.5bn P-8I package; China's counter-campaign documented (the fake-documents and deepfake operation against the Rafale, per the April 2026 anatomy). Geography: Asia 43%, EU 27% (Greece €1.1bn,

Denmark ~€1bn, Germany €526M — a ten-year high), Ukraine €781M. The Gulf decade: €52bn exported to the region 2015–2024 against €27bn to the whole EU.

The **Rafale ledger**: 533 ordered (323 export) — Egypt 24+30 (the 2021 tranche €3.95bn), Qatar 24+12 (€6.3bn, 2015), India as above, the **UAE's 80 F4** (€14–16bn, December 3, 2021 — the largest arms export in Fifth Republic history; first deliveries late 2026), Indonesia 42 (~€8bn, deliveries begun January 2026), Serbia 12 (~$3bn, August 2024, Macron-Vučić ceremony), Greece 18+6, Croatia 12 used, Ukraine LOI November 2025 (up to 100 Rafale F4 plus SAMP/T). Per-unit economics: each export Rafale ≈ €150M to state coffers, €300M+ to the trade balance. Dassault's order book at end-2025: 220 Rafale / €46.6bn, with Mérignac ramping to 3/month by late 2026 and 4 by 2029.

The LPM's 2026 actualization. Macron's January 15, 2026 vœux aux armées at Istres announced the +€36bn effort on top of the €413bn (2024–2030), taking the programming total to **€449bn**, with €3.5bn front-loaded into 2026, the mission-defense budget steps of +€6.7bn (2026) and +€6.2bn (2027), and €2bn earmarked for the Service National Universel — against the trajectory (€47 → 50.5 → 57 → 63.4 → €69bn by 2030) and the Senate's standing critique (r22-709: preparation opérationnelle at €69bn/€9.86bn-per-year; the stable army shares — Terre 26.5%, Marine 34.7%, Air and Space 38.8%). The earlier-flagged "Plan Élément Terre €109bn" figure is resolved: subsumed into this actualization, no separate plan exists in the record.

The lending machine beneath: **Bpifrance Assurance Export** guarantees ~€70bn outstanding across ~100 countries (2023: 172 credit-insurance files, ~€20bn accepted); ten countries = 92% of the military portfolio (India, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Egypt, UAE, Belgium, US, Singapore, Kuwait…). The Cour des comptes: the portfolio "constantly profitable, premiums exceeded indemnities" 2010–2021 — **except 2015, when the Mistral non-delivery to Russia cost €409M**. The Egypt pattern, documented in the parliamentary record: French-state-guaranteed bank loans covering 85% of the 2021 tranche (via Crédit Agricole, Société Générale, BNP, CIC), with Egypt paying "principally on credit."

The oversight files: the live parliamentary information mission on arms transfers to Israel (deposited January 5, 2026); the Thales/Azerbaijan case (3.7); the **Haftar/Libya file**. The Sentry's November 13, 2025 "Inside Job" report documents the Haftar coalition's multibillion-dollar fuel heist — diverted subsidized diesel to Russian forces at Libyan bases and to Sudan's RSF even after al-Fasher's fall. The state side: DGSE covert support for Khalifa Haftar from end-2015, documented by the SWP Berlin record — exposed only when three DGSE officers died in a July 2016 helicopter shootdown south of Benghazi; partially withdrawn without publicity; then aerial surveillance for Haftar's Derna and Oil Crescent offensives. New America's UN-source account: "dozens of French DGSE officers accompanied LAAF forces on frontline missions and acted as forward spotters for mortars and artillery," the operation "run from the presidency and through the DGSE,"

with the internal Hollande-era war preserved (DGSE plus Le Drian's Defence Ministry against the reluctant Quai d'Orsay); the Derna battle entry confirming 35–60 DGSE Action Division operators on the ground conducting raids, heavy-mortar cover and counter-sniper work 2018–19; the Javelin embarrassment of June 26, 2019 (four US-made Javelins traced to a 2010 French Army sale to Egypt found at the captured Gharyan HQ, Paris claiming them "hors d'usage" while Disclose documented Egyptian Rafales flying for Haftar). Wagner's side: Putin's January 11, 2020 admission, 14 Russian jets at Al Khadim/Al Jufra (AFRICOM, May 2020), Pantsir batteries. The corporate side: two NGO complaints against TotalEnergies — Ukraine kerosene (October 13, 2022 Reuters headline: two NGOs filed a PNAT complaint for complicity in war crimes) and Mozambique (3.8).

4.7 The state in the market: EDF, FDJ, CAC40, the big corporations

(EDF told at full length in 4.5.)

FDJ United: the former lottery monopoly (sold in the 2019 IPO for ~€2bn, state keeping 20%) bought Kindred at 130 SEK — enterprise value €2.6bn, +24% premium (January 22, 2024) → 91.8% by October 11 → 98.6% after extension → 100% early 2025. The money: €2.16bn paid, refinanced by FDJ's inaugural €1.5bn bond (Baa1) plus a €400M syndicated credit; net debt €1.82bn at 1.9x pro forma; €1bn of goodwill. The empire's new numbers: 2024 revenue €3,065M, EBITDA €792M (25.8%), net €399M (adjusted €490M); Kindred contributing €918M

revenue/€223M EBITDA before its committed exit from unregulated markets (October 31, 2024) and North America; the March 2026 Unibet fusion. The state's quiet second win: the European Commission closed its state-aid probe with no finding and raised the exclusivity fee from €380M to €477M (+€97M). PMU's counterpoint: €10bn staked, €835M net, in structural decline (-3.3% stakes, -5.7% players). The regulatory gage: the Autorité de la concurrence forcing brand separation between monopoly and competitive offerings. The gambling ledger, full (ANJ 2025–26): total PBJ €14.1bn (+3%); online €2.617bn PBJ (18.5% of the market vs 12.8% in 2019); sports-betting stakes €11.52bn (+12% — football €6.32bn, tennis €2.65bn); 4.2M online players; the self-protection metrics moving the wrong way — 57,200 self-exclusions (+18%), 1,247 illegal sites blocked (+34%) — and the ANJ's own internal finding now public: **problem gamblers generate over 38% of sector revenue** (excessive players alone 21%), prompting a promotion-spending investigation; Falque-Pierrotin's "année décisive" with all indicators red before the 2026 World Cup. FDJ United at €6.95bn PBJ (half the market, +19% pro forma); casinos €2.82bn PBJ/31.6M entries. The legalization front: online casinos still illegal, an offshore market of €1.5–2.5bn/yr; AFJEL's €1.2bn capturable-yield estimate; the ANJ's own €748M–1.5bn projection; the PLF 2025 opening clause withdrawn under land-casino and addiction-association pressure; the moratorium proposal reserving licenses to existing land casinos until 2030; the 55.6% PBJ tax as the template; the world frame ($43bn

global online-casino market in 2026 heading to $149bn by 2035).

The CAC40. The map: luxury ~18–22%, industry/defense ~19%, energy ~12%, tech only 5–8% — the structural Achilles heel against the S&P's ~30%. The 2025 summit, from Vernimmen's annual study: **€107.5–108bn returned to shareholders** (+9.5%) — €72.8bn of flat dividends plus a record €34.8bn of buybacks (+30%) — a payout ratio of 71% into a 12% profit decline (profits €151bn); the buyback surge carried by Axa's full redistribution of the €5.1bn Axa IM sale to BNP Paribas and by banks quadrupling programs to €4.7bn (SG alone €2.5bn). The decade arithmetic (+135% distributions since 2017 against +11% employment; +114.5% since 2016's €50.2bn); the concentration (TotalEnergies €14.5bn, Axa €10bn, Sanofi €9.8bn, LVMH, BNP, Vinci paying over half; TotalEnergies alone at 96% of its 2024 profits; Michelin's 87% and €1.649bn); the IFGE/Lyon long view (SBF120 dividends €4bn in 1995 → €85bn in 2025 at +11%/yr — three times economic growth; twenty giants paying €748bn = 64% of the thirty-year total); the AllianzGI projection (€75bn → €81bn → €88bn by 2026); the investment counterweight (+22% to €116.6bn in 2024). The pay tables, all three methodologies preserved: Proxinvest's 2026 median €6.5M (-9% vs 2025) with the ratio at **95x — the highest in a decade outside 2021's 109x** — Milleri's €23.1M at the top (770x); Pouyanné above €10M (353x); Arnault deliberately low at ~€9M (21x — the real income being the family's 50% stake); the de Meo package (€20M sign-on plus €2.2M fixed and 220% variable — a

potential €40–50M package at 429x — attacked by Proxinvest, contested at Kering's 2026 AGM); Strategies/Executive's alternative median €6.8M (+14%); the Canard's counter-figure (€3.2M average, +13%). The ratio's half-century march: 20x (1980), 40x (2000), 60x (2010), 109x (2021), 95x today; the extreme leaderboard (Milleri 770x, Cyrille Bolloré 523x, Daloz 517x, de Meo 429x, Pouyanné 353x). Governance frame: Sapin 2's say-on-pay since 2017; the rejected 2024 PPL to cap pay at 25x; the 30% RSE-indexation push; the Tavares marker (€19M in 2021 plus ~€47M of LTIs to 2028 — thirteen times the CAC average, on a merely consultative vote). The Oxfam/CSI May 1, 2026 arithmetic: +18% for the 26 reporting PDGs in one year against +0.5% real for workers; the Arnault family's $3.8bn in 2025 dividends; $80bn distributed worldwide to ~1,000 billionaires at $2,500 per second; 3,428 billionaires holding the equivalent of 17% of world GDP.

TotalEnergies — the fiscal dossier, both poles complete. Zucman's indictment (July 30, 2026): zero French corporate income tax by design — the 37,000 French employees "create no value" while $5.9bn (a quarter of worldwide profits) sits in the "rest of the world" line that the CEO admitted at the Assemblée nationale in June 2026 consists essentially of Switzerland and Singapore, taxed at 15%; the 2022 peak — $11.5bn in that line, nearly $1M per employee, at a 4.4% effective rate ($514M paid on $11,562M) — the superprofits year when Total registered no French profit and escaped every windfall levy; cumulative 2019–2024 below 15% (both academic criteria for a tax-haven footprint: extraordinary profit

per employee plus sub-15% rate). The company's counter-narrative, verbatim from its own Q&A: "l'entreprise française qui paie le plus d'impôts sur les bénéfices au monde"; 43% average worldwide rate since 2022; $100bn in profit and production taxes since 2022; territoriality as principle; Norway at 78% and Nigeria at 50–80%; France's €2bn+ "contribution" composed of employer social contributions and dividend withholding — the accounting Zucman dismantles as "comme si une entreprise disait payer l'impôt à la source qu'elle retient sur votre salaire." The BFMTV ledger (June 17, 2026): 2025 — €11bn world profit versus €300M French losses; the surtaxe escaped; $95M French IS in 2024 against Arnault's ~€3bn; IS paid only six times since 2015; the €5.5bn cumulative refining deficit; €100–150M of buyback tax; Pouyanné's Arnault-defending line. The CFTC's claim that multinationals now pay ~45% of IS (versus 66% in 2010). The board and the superprofit arithmetic: Pouyanné's mandate renewed to 2030 (the September 23–24, 2026 board seminar proposing it; the May 29, 2026 AGM having raised the age limits at 98% — chairman to 80, CEO to 70); the succession origin — de Margerie's October 2014 plane-crash death; the shareholder-pressure record (Ethos/FIR's 19-investor, €1bn+ split-roles resolution rejected; Follow This's 2023 climate resolution at 30.4%); the 2022 record — $20.53bn net / $36.2bn adjusted (×2 y/y), the 35–40% payout policy, the exceptional €1 December dividend, $7bn of buybacks, the Novatek exit of December 31, 2022. The windfall politics: the August 1, 2022 Senate scene — Cozic's 25% superprofits

amendment quantified (€4bn TotalEnergies, €925M Engie, €4.4bn CMA CGM, €875M autoroute concessionaires) against Husson's "il est de notre intérêt que les entreprises soient en bonne santé" and Briançon's "le gras pour les uns, les miettes pour l'immense majorité"; Italy and the UK levied 25% while France levied nothing — only the CMA-CGM-specific tonnage tax survived, doubled to 18%/11% (€525M in 2025, €320M in 2026), the anti-evasion amendment rejected as "inutile," with the warning logged (the group's profits ran $17.9bn (2021) → $24.9bn (2022) → $3.64bn (2023) → $5bn (2024, +56%)).

CMA CGM (Saadé, fortune €31.5bn; down from €35bn on the shipping squeeze): the container line that absorbed Bolloré's empire — Bolloré Logistics €4.8bn and BAL €5.7bn across 2022–24 (~€10bn of logistics selldowns funding Bolloré SE's post-empire net cash of €5.62bn and the €4.2bn special dividend of May 27, 2026). The 2021–22 windfall: profits $17.9bn → $24.9bn; the doubled tonnage tax cost €525M.

The banks' fine ledger (with HSBC/SG told in 3.6): BNP's $8.9bn and the 2025 atrocity-complicity verdict (3.6); the cum-cum montages (3.6's CJIP table); the structural frame — European banks ~$16bn of US penalties 2009–2014; the EcoDef doctrine citing BNP as the textbook of extraterritorial economic warfare.

Mistral AI — the sovereignty paradox in one cap table. The rounds: June 2023 seed €105M at €240M (Lightspeed lead; Niel, Saadé, JCDecaux Holding, Motier/Galeries Lafayette, Bpifrance, Eric Schmidt, General Catalyst, Index Ventures); February 2024 two convertible-debt notes at €1.9bn (Microsoft

€15M, Salesforce, NVIDIA); June 2024 Series B €600M at €5.8bn (General Catalyst + DST Global leading; NVIDIA, Lightspeed, Index, a16z, BNP Paribas, Cisco, Eurazeo, Hanwha, IBM, Korelya, Samsung, Sanabil, ServiceNow); September 2025 Series C €1.7bn at €11.7bn — the largest round in French tech history — ASML €1.3bn for 11% plus a strategic-committee seat, with DST Global, a16z, Bpifrance, General Catalyst, Index, Lightspeed continuing; Bloomberg's June 12, 2026 report of negotiations for ~€3bn at ~€20bn, and the September 2026 close at €3bn **with Samsung** — the largest tech round ever raised in Europe. The post-C cap table estimate: founders 35.5%; French seed money 27.15% (Niel, Saadé, JCDecaux, Galeries Lafayette); US Series A 15.92% (a16z ~7–8%); US Series B 6.9%; ASML 11.11%; other C-round 3.42%. The business reality under the valuations: 2025 revenue ~€100M (+233%) against ~€100M losses; cumulative raise ~€2.4–3.4bn; 600 staff; ~€200M annual spend; 1M Le Chat users; 15M Free Mobile subscribers bundled with Le Chat Pro; OpenAI at $170bn and Anthropic ~€183bn for scale. The sovereign-adjacency ledger fully mapped: DST Global (Milner; Russia/China-flagged in shareholder lists), Sanabil (Saudi), MGX (UAE), NVIDIA/IBM/Cisco/Microsoft/Salesforce (US), ASML (NL), Samsung (KR) — France's sovereign-AI champion majority-capitalized by foreign and tycoon money, with Bpifrance inside every round. The corporate contracts: CMA CGM €100M/5yr; TotalEnergies' 30,000 employees and 1,000 researchers on sovereign R&D assistants; Airbus and BMW. The infrastructure buildout: the 1.4GW AI campus for 2028

(Bruyères-le-Châtel, 6.10); €1.2bn Swedish data centers; $830M financing for the first French data center; Mistral's own Essonne cluster and the March 2026 €830M raise. France's counters: 750+ AI companies, the EU's third-largest cloud market, hyperscalers holding 65% of the EU cloud; the UK at ~£25bn and Germany at ~€15bn of announced AI investment. **The sovereign-cloud dossier, completed to its contrarian core.** The anatomy of both hybrid offerings: **S3NS** (June 2022; Thales >92%, Google <8% as non-voting observer; ~€1.5bn/5yrs; 100% GCP technology; Latombe's question preserved verbatim — "un montage juridique qui permettrait de faire remonter les fonds vers une entité commune cachée aux yeux du public") and **Bleu** (Orange 50/Capgemini 50; Microsoft at 0% as exclusive tech partner; ~€1bn/5yrs; 100% Azure) — both still without final SecNumCloud certification as of late 2025 while true-sovereign rivals (Outscale, Numspot, OVHcloud, Scaleway) hold theirs. The state's contradictory plumbing: Andromède's €75M FSN equity rescue; the Doctrine Cloud's €84M of 2025 orders (+62%; 99% to European providers); France Travail's €45M/5yr migration to OVHcloud (February 2026); EDF and Dassault Aviation on Bleu; SAP S/4 sovereign versions by 2027; AWS's €7.8bn European sovereign-cloud announcement (January 2026); Microsoft's €20bn-plus "European digital autonomy" pledge. The critique canon: the CLOUD Act's extraterritorial reach makes capitalist control irrelevant against technological dependence; true sovereignty priced at €20–33bn over 10–15 years against hyperscaler capex of $70bn/yr (AWS), $40bn (Azure), $30bn

(GCP); "l'illusion de la souveraineté" as the organizing verdict. **The EACOP financing machine** (TotalEnergies' Uganda project): twenty-four banks and 21 insurers refuse direct EACOP/Tilenga financing; BNP/SG/CA formally declined in April 2021 ("le projet est trop difficile à défendre"); BPCE/Natixis the only big French bank without any commitment. The circumvention: TotalEnergies raises 68% of its financing via bonds (only 4% direct project finance), and on April 7, 2022 the three refusing banks plus SG arranged the $8bn "general corporate purposes" revolving credit — the largest loan to a major since the Paris Agreement, fungible into every operation including the projects they refuse to name; April 5, 2024: $4.25bn of bonds with maturities to 2064 (BPCE, BlackRock, Vanguard, BNP, CA). The 2016–2021 baseline: $350bn of fossil financing from French banks (France third worldwide behind the US and China; Crédit Agricole TotalEnergies' top banker at $7.1bn, BNP $5.9bn). The 2025–26 update: Société Générale overtook BNP as France's #1 fossil banker (+29%); TotalEnergies' financing doubled; the June 9, 2026 Banking on Climate Chaos report at $906bn global. The Amundi contradiction: Crédit Agricole's asset-management arm, Total's largest shareholder (10%, €14bn), voted FOR the 2022 climate plan while Crédit Mutuel voted against.

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4.8 The state's ledgers: borrowing, debt-holders, social insurance

(The borrowing program and the debt-holders' map are told at full length in 1.3.)

Assurance vie, the reservoir: €2,107bn at end-2025 (+6.1%, +€122bn), having crossed €2,000bn in January 2025 — 20M holders across 57M contracts, median €35k, over 30% of household financial savings, 42% of households. The 2025 flows: cotisations €192.1bn (+10%), prestations €141.4bn (-3%), net collection +€50.6bn — the best since 2010 (+€22.1bn y/y) — with the euro-funds' first positive collection since 2020 (+€8.1bn after -€4.7bn). The 2026 run-rate: €2,171bn by August; eight-month collection €43.5bn versus €36.6bn prior-year; euro-funds paying 2.8–3.5% against the Livret A's cut to 1.5% on February 1, 2026 — the "jeu de vase communicant." The deployment: 63% corporate securities (23.1% equities, 35% corporate bonds, 5.1% corporate real estate) and 24% sovereign bonds (France Assureurs, June 2025): the instrument through which household savings fund both corporate France and the €310bn state. The satellite systems: the PER at €118.9–136bn with +16% flows; the 3.2M expiring PELs' €93bn wave expected to roll into assurance-vie through 2030. The PEA alongside: 5 million plans, €120bn, €24k average deposits.

Social insurance. Assurance chômage's deficit staircase: -€200M forecast (February 2025) → -€300M (June) → -€1.3bn (October 22, 2025) → **-€2.1bn** (March 3, 2026 actualization; an

€800M deterioration in five months) — entirely attributed by the Unédic to the State's *ponctions*: €4.1bn in 2026 alone, €12bn cumulative since 2023 financing France Travail and France Compétences — which froze the debt at -€61.5bn expected end-2026 against 2.6M indemnisés and the jobs curve (-91k in 2025; +55k 2026; +174k 2027 projected), with the +€5.3bn 2027 surplus conditional on "no new ponction." Assurance maladie's "abyssal" -€16bn for 2025 (the Leyton figure; Le Monde's -€23bn framing logged with pedigree) trending to -€19.4bn by 2029, against the government's planned €30bn savings program spanning efficiency, abuse-fighting and a redefinition of public/private coverage roles. **Agirc-Arrco** (the supplementary pension for 13.9M private-sector retirees): points bought at €20.1877 (2026) with a 127% taux d'appel; cotisations 7.87% T1 / 21.59% T2 split 40/60; the pension = points × valeur de service, representing 30–60% of a private-sector retiree's income. The revalorization ladder since the 2019 fusion: +5.12% (2022, to 1.3498), +4.9% (2023, 1.4159), +1.6% (2024, 1.4386) under the 2023 ANI rule (inflation hors tabac minus 0.4pt, board discretion ±0.4); the rupture — the October 17, 2025 board failed to agree and froze the point for the first full year since the fusion, prompting CFE-CGC and CGT to sue before the tribunal judiciaire de Paris over the €91bn reserves ("une lecture différenciée du cadre juridique en l'absence de consensus"); the pension-politics arithmetic preserved — the 2026 "double gel" meant a €1,500-net pension gaining just €9/month from the base's +0.9% January revalorization while the complémentaire sat

frozen (+0.6% total against continuing inflation), the suppressed bonus-malus (-10% coefficient) already abolished for liquidations from December 1, 2023; the CARMF doctors' parallel (+1.3% to €77.14, January 2026) as the separate track. And the October 14, 2026 resolution: **+1.4% effective November 1, 2026** (to ~1.4587) — breaking the freeze on the very day the 2026–27 autumn negotiations opened.

Pensions, the actuarial floor: 31M contributors versus 17.2M pensioners; the ratio 2 → 1.7 → 1.5; the deficit €2bn (2022) → €14bn (2030) without reform. The 2023 reform, fully documented: the LFRSS vehicle — deposited January 10, Council of Ministers January 23, Assembly time-killed February 17 under Article 47-1, Senate 195–112 (March 12), CMP (March 15), second Senate pass 193–114, Assembly 49.3 March 16 (the 100th use), motions falling nine votes short March 20–21, the Constitutional Council green light April 14, promulgation the same day. Content: 62 → 64 at three months per year from September 1, 2023; 172 trimestres by 2027; the 85%-of-SMIC minimum pension; carrières longues; C2P; the RATP/IEG regimes wound down; the décote age held at 67. The wound that never closed: Ifop April 2025's two-thirds-plus-78% abrogation numbers; Derosier's Le Monde verdict — "adoptée mais non délibérée," the triple fracture (parliamentary, social, democratic); the June 5, 2025 abrogation debate blocked; the December 2025 Assembly vote suspending the reform until 2028 at 247–232, wrapped into the PLFSS 2026 with the CSG on employee savings raised 9.2 → 10.6 and the €5,000 PEE unlocking — the Lecornu suspension-for-non-censure trade,

fully priced.

4.9 The welfare and fiscal micro-ledger

The small rules that move billions quietly:

- **Livret A:** 1.70% net since August 1, 2026 — after six months at the 1.50% February floor and three consecutive cuts from February 2025's 2.40%. The formula's exact mechanics (arrêté of January 27, 2021): the average of semiannual €STR and tobacco-free inflation, rounded to the nearest tenth, floored at 0.50% — with the government able to derogate, as it did in February 2026, holding 1.50% against a calculated 1.40%. The 200-year arc: from 1818's creation through 1981's 8.50% peak to 2020's 0.50% floor. The ceiling frozen at €22,950 since 2013. The real-rate verdict: the 2025 rate of 2.16% against 0.90% inflation, then 2026's projected 1.60% against ~2% — the Livret's return to negative territory after two inflation-beating years.
- **Inheritance:** duties €16.6bn (2023) plus donations €4bn — more than double the €7–8bn of the 2010s, with the notaires' share at €15.8bn in 2025 (+24% versus 2019) and at least half of the mortality-driven increase already harvested through anticipated gifts. France the OECD's #1 for inheritance-tax weight (0.74% of GDP) and the EU's heaviest property-taxation state (€113bn, 4% of GDP); indirect-line inheritances contribute 10% of the flow and 50% of the receipts. The flood ahead: the Fondation Jean-Jaurès study's €9,000bn to be transmitted 2025–2040 (flux rising from €464bn/16.1% of GDP in 2025 to

€677bn/20.2% by 2040); the notaires' independent model bracketing €5,100–7,558bn by 2040. The two reform bids: the Fondation's IGS (+€19bn/yr from 2025, €400bn cumulative, effective rate from 5% to 9%, PFU on top-1% latent capital gains, no impact on 99% of French) against the CAE's earlier +€10bn version — all set against the shelter architecture (€100k per child, conjoints exempt, the pacte Dutreil, and life insurance — 70% of it held by the top 10%).

- **Pinel:** the Cour des comptes' September 2024 report — €4.05bn over seven years, €7.3bn cumulative 2014–2023, an annual cost running €606M (2009) → €1.7bn (2015); the 2018 report's "accoutumance, voire addiction" of construction actors now the canonical verdict; the rent-effect math (€7.3bn for an estimated 9.3% reduction in tense zones). The industry's counter-study preserved (Primeview, September 2019: 724,000 logements built 1999–2018; +€18.2bn net to the state; +€25,100 per unit; the 80% investor-flight warning); the methodological knife-fight (the 351M-vs-2.16bn cost anomaly; Scellier's 25% over nine years against Pinel's 18%). The sunset: no new Pinel rentals from January 1, 2025 — ending the 1996–2024 defiscalization dynasty (Périssol through Borloo, Besson, Scellier, Duflot).
- **Logement social, the demand avalanche:** 5.4M units at January 1, 2025 (15.9% of primary residences; +71,300 first rentals against -18,100 demolitions and -10,900 sales; average rent €6.76/m², +3.6%; €7.95 in Île-de-France). The

Cour des comptes' April 2026 wake-up call: 2.8M registered applicants (a million more than a decade ago), 1.9M first-time filers in 2024, against only 400,000 annual re-lettings; Paris the extreme case (271,906 SRU units; 292,000 registered households — half from outside the city); vacancy and mobility both falling (2.9% → 2.1% and 9.3% → 7.1%, 2019–2025) as the stock freezes.

- **CEE (certificats d'économies d'énergie):** the lineage (loi POPE, July 13, 2005) and the P6 parameters gazetted November 4, 2025 — 1,050 TWh cumac/yr obligation (+35%), 280 dedicated to energy poverty, 5,250 TWh cumac over 2026–2030. The money: ~€6bn/yr through 2022–2025 rising to €8bn+ in 2026 (+27% per Minister Barbut) — a 30–50bn private-financing machine the State is using to replace direct budget aid (the oil-is-water transfer the RN spotted), kWh-cumac at ~€8.50 on the EMMY secondary market. The fraud ledger: Tracfin's 2021 alert; the March 14, 2025 government point d'étape (€20bn frauds detected overall, €13bn "encaissées," CEE and MaPrimeRénov' as the named targets — €480M avoided in 2024, split €236M/€229M); the typology (fake prestataires, false attestations, surfacturation, complicit bureaux de contrôle) and the penalties now flowing (certificate annulments, multi-million fines, prison-with-suspension for dirigeants, L.222-8 sanctions). The Cour's ambivalence verbatim: "de plus en plus complexe" (280 regulatory texts in five years), "s'apparente à une taxe sur l'énergie" passed through bills, suppression or structural reform urged — but 106 TWh of

verified savings from 2014–2020 actions. The campaign fuse: Bardella's "agression fiscale" line (a €2bn hike on fuels/oil/gas/electricity) against the government's "désinformation" rebuttal — the CEE the 2027 election's first energy-tax battleground.

- **Chèque énergie:** the 2026 vintage — €48–277 by income-and-composition grid (average €153; RFR/UC threshold €11,000; ~20% of households; 4.5M foyers — 3.8M in April, 700k in May), the EHPAD/logement-foyer fixed at €192; the budget-crisis ripple (the entire 2025 campaign pushed to November because the finance law passed too late — the taxe d'habitation's abolition having broken the automatic identification, per the FNCCR's June 2025 alert); the Cour's targeting verdict (February 2022: ~25% of the energy-poor uncovered, ~50% of recipients not energy-poor; 82.2% utilization); the crisis escalators (2021's exceptional €100; 2022's €100–200 to 12M foyers — ~40% of households — plus €50–200 bois); Engie's corporate sweetener (€75 to its 720,000 eligible clients, €54M total); the reform menu (Terra Nova's double-for-the-bottom-30%, carbon-tax pairing, precarity-only targeting).
- **Taxe d'habitation:** the Darmanin revision — €8.5bn over three years, not the €10bn initially floated; the progressive calendar with ~€3bn in the first 2018 step (Philippe's announcement); the full-phased cost ~€20bn/yr (Challenges' profile of Amiel: "n'a jamais été vraiment compensée") with the Mediapart ledger quantifying the compensating TVA prelevement at €22.8bn and preserving the counterfactual

(adjusting the dégrèvement thresholds instead of abolishing: €8.4bn); plus the budget-pressure constellation the same lines supply — the retraites compensation €42.3bn, the special-regime subventions €6.1bn, the hospital/territorial civil-servant pension deficits €1.5bn.

- **ARENH → VNU:** the €42/MWh regulated nuclear transfer — price frozen since 2012 because the revision décret was never adopted (the DGEC's own memo admitting Brussels approval was "difficilement envisageable" under post-2012 EU state-aid law); 850+ TWh ceded in total. The écrètement paradox per the Cour des comptes: it actually *raised* EDF's nuclear revenue by €1,085M (2019), €851M (2020) and €932M (2021) — €2.9bn cumulative — because unfulfilled ARENH equivalents sold at market; then the 2022 crisis inversion: écrètement hitting 40%, suppliers buying at €1,000+/MWh, E.Leclerc Énergies and Hydroption bankrupted, the ARENH+ emergency extension (20 TWh at €46.2) costing EDF ~€4bn directly, and the CRE's finding that several suppliers ("brebis galeuses," <1% of consumers) pushed clients into the TRV with winter price-hikes to resell their €42 volumes at crisis prices — plus the compensation machinery (CP1: €555.1M paid by 90 suppliers for 2023; CP2 doubled to €40/MWh in 2024). The end: ARENH died December 31, 2025; from January 1, 2026 the **Versement Nucléaire Universel** — a €60.3/MWh 2026 cost basis, 50% clawback in the first band (€78/MWh trigger), 90% in the second (€110/MWh), CRE-collected, auto-redistributed to all consumers regardless of supplier,

with the November 14, 2023 EDF-État accord targeting a €70/MWh average for 2026–2035; the final 2025 numbers (134.93 TWh demanded; 74.12% attribution) and the campaign-frame headline preserved ("26 milliards d'euros évaporés en un an," the EDF-side accounting).

- **Renewables (PPE3, gazetted February 13, 2026):** a deliberate deceleration — solar 48GW by 2030 (29.7GW end-2025) against 55–80GW by 2035; onshore 31/35–40GW; offshore ×7 to 15GW by 2035; decarbonized power 650–693TWh by 2035 versus 544 in 2025 — betting the transition on EPR2 rather than speed. The 2024 realization table: electricity 30.8% versus a 40% target; heat 31.1% versus 39; transport 10.7% versus 15 (the 2020 targets achieved only in 2024; the EU 2030 indicative 42.5% far off). The frictions: 6–8-year permitting delays; no one-stop shop (EC review); the Gremillet bill in Parliament; the RTE grid plan at €100bn.

4.10 Media and culture money

Press aid (the Senate's own rappport a25-144-42 of November 24, 2025): the 2026 envelope — program 180 at €178.2M (-5.8%: diffusion stable at €129.7M, pluralism flat at €23.2M, modernization cut 30.3% to €25.3M), plus the La Poste compensation of €38.5M on program 134 — €232.3M total (-2.6%); the ten-year glide from €197M (2023) with the rapporteurs' verdict that press aid has become "une véritable variable d'ajustement des budgets d'austérité." The distribution micro-ledger: €61.1M postage aid, €45.3M portage, €32.2M La Poste compensation, the FSER collapsed 44.5% to €19.6M hitting 750 associative radios that live 40% on it. France Messagerie's problem preserved verbatim — "une forte concentration au profit de 10 bénéficiaires appartenant pour certains à de grands groupes industriels" — against the acknowledgement that FM's results were "significativement positifs" on public money. The Soriano reform's impasse: the contract de modernisation transmitted August 1, 2025 (€5M/yr over three years) blocked because "les deux premiers quotidiens nationaux" refuse to sign; the money absent from every budget document. AFP: dotation €147.2M in 2026 (+2.9% on the COM trajectory); €124M MIG compensation; the agency's own alert on -€8.4M of commercial revenue at end-2025 endangering its 2,400 staff; no deficit since 2018 after €20M of losses 2014–18. The Dati audition preserved in the annex — the minister answering for cuts she is now, as a presidential candidate, promising to reverse.

France Télévisions: €101M of 2026 cuts (€71M in the PLF plus a €30M mid-year amendment n°3605 slipped in the night of the 49.3), FTv absorbing 65.3M+15M; Dati's candid 146M "real effort" figure and the record 140M savings plan behind it — the Six Nations rights resale to TF1, the Junior Eurovision withdrawal a year after winning it, the "unhonorable" 440M creation covenant representing 35% of national AV production, 192 jobs to go on top of 250, regional emitter and documentary cuts, freelancer pay delays; the decade math from the group's own transparency page (-€175M nominal, -€650M in constant euros; French public-AV credits at barely half Germany's); the CNC's €50M raid after the prior €500M; the CNM's €58M/€21M tax-cap reliefs; the PPL Lafon reform file and the unfinished fusion architecture — holding 2025, single-entity target January 1, 2026, FMM excluded by committee vote, now stalled with the government that designed it under indictment and its champion on trial.

The CNC machine: the self-financing triangle — TSA (10.72% of tickets), TST on broadcasters, the SMAD decree (2021) forcing 20–25% reinvestment and chronologie compliance — "taxing the platforms into the family"; the 2% foreign-platform tax finally greenlit by the Commission (Netflix ~€2M, YouTube ~€2.5M); 2025 admissions 156.8M, $1.17bn box office, the 40/60 SVOD quotas. **Mécénat (Admical 2024):** 171,900 companies declaring donations in 2023 (+55% vs 2021) for €2.9bn declared (+23%), the IFOP correction pushing the true corporate total to €3.8bn — 9% of French firms; the democratization with concentration intact (TPE/PME now 97%

of mécènes and 33% of the budget versus 23% in 2018, while the grandes entreprises at 0.2% of mécènes still write 39–47% of the checks); the drivers (the five-year carry-forward of the Notre-Dame-era credits, anti-food-waste donation obligations making commerce the #1 sector, the Olympic sport wave); the global frame (the Observatoire's €7.5bn total philanthropy 2023; individuals' declared donations €3.63bn on IR+IFI) — all under the 60% credit / 0.5%-of-turnover cap that makes every euro of patronage a 60-cent public-private partnership.

Media ownership concentration (the map beneath Pattern Seven): five groups ≈85% of TV audiences. Bolloré: the 2005 entry points — Havas control AND a free TNT frequency (Direct 8 → C8, sold to Canal+/Vivendi 2012 for ~€500M + 1.3% capital — "one of the biggest speculations in French media history on a state-owned asset," per historian Alexis Lévrier); the €2.8bn 2015 injection to reach 14%; ten years as Vivendi's master — group revenue divided by three while distributing tens of billions (the UMG spin-off 2021 crystallizing $45bn+ valuation, ~18% family stake, Vivendi's €6bn profit year); the December 13, 2024 scission into four listed entities (Canal+ London / Havas Amsterdam / Louis Hachette Group / Vivendi Paris — 97.5% AG approval, €16bn total valuation, Bolloré ~30.4% of each) and the activist war: the Paris commercial court's April 22, 2025 finding of de facto control → the AMF's July 18, 2025 order to launch an OPR for the remaining 66.4% → the €6–9bn bill that made Vivendi jump +13% in a day → the Cour de cassation's November 28, 2025 annulment letting Bolloré off the hook (Le Monde's advance

scoop on the advocate-general's opinion). Bolloré SE post-empire: 2025 revenue €2.93bn, net €351M (versus €1.84bn inflated by the logistics sales), net cash €5.62bn, the 2022+2024 logistics selldowns ~€10bn, the €4.2bn special dividend (€1.5/share) on the May 27, 2026 AG; Socfin 34.75%, Rubis 5.96%. Editis: forced sale to International Media Invest for €653M (versus the €900M paid to Planeta) as the EC condition of the Lagardère takeover. Arnault: the LVMH media holdings (the Challenges takeover — 4.1's caveat). Drahi: the SFR exit June 2026 (€20.35bn) against Altice's €24bn of bank debt. Saadé: CMA CGM's BFM entry (2024). The state: France Télévisions and Radio France.

Notre-Dame (the patronage case-study): the one-upmanship preserved minute-by-minute — Pinault's €100M via Artémis announced the evening of April 15, 2019 WITH the tax-deduction renunciation ("il n'est pas question d'en faire porter la charge aux contribuables français"), Arnault doubling to €200M within minutes, the wave reaching €840M+ (Bettencourt-Meyers €200M with €100M via the Fondation Bettencourt Schueller, Total €100M, JCDecaux €20M, Martin and Olivier Bouygues €10M via SCDM, Ladreit de Lacharrière €10M earmarked for the spire, Disney $5M, Île-de-France €10M, the conventions signed September 24, 2019 with multi-year disbursement and the donors' seat on the restoration oversight committee); the Arnault family's full front-row at the December 7–8, 2024 reopening with Macron, Trump, William and Musk; LVMH's 36 oaks from the Cellé forest (Hennessy barrel wood) for the spire. The sociological frame from Il

Giornale dell'Arte: in a country "où la fortune est suspecte," the billionaires' rivalry for the "prince-mécène" title — art as the passport that ennobles wealth.

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4.11 Agriculture and the land

- **The 2026 tractor war:** the sieges of January 8 and 13; the €300M emergency package; lumpy skin disease and the culls; the cow-less Salon de l'Agriculture 2026; the Feyzin GNR refinery protest of May 11; Mercosur's farmer blockades reaching the European Parliament in October 2026 — the treaty's path preserved step by step: signed December 2024, the Coreper vote January 9, 2026, the EP's referral to the Court of Justice passing by ten votes, the farmers' siege of the Strasbourg perimeter.
- **The wine crisis:** consumption collapsed from 150L to 40L per capita; a €130M/€4,000-per-hectare uprooting scheme drew 27,929 hectares of applications — 37% of growers signaling exit — its implementation blocked during the budget-crisis weeks; three growers' deaths by suicide recorded; the €0.23/case auction; Grands Crus en primeur down 20–30%; the Bordeaux property fund stalled on bank financing; the 2026 harvest near the 70-year low.
- **CAP:** France's three-decade reign as the EU's #1 beneficiary — €5.6bn (1990), €10.4bn (2005), €9.1bn/yr average 2014–2020, €62.4bn for 2021–2027 (~€8.9bn/yr) against its ~18% share of EU budget financing. The internal

distribution: 85% of the French envelope to direct payments; 44% of farm income from subsidies (2013); €266/ha average with the disparities mapped (Picardie €345 versus Languedoc €120; grandes cultures €300 versus herbivore €200); the historical-payments allocation logic named as the inequality engine — set against the Böll Atlas framing and the Molinari counter-myth piece.

- **Sainte-Soline:** the March 25, 2023 battle — ~8,000 protesters against 3,000 gendarmes, 5,000+ grenades in under five hours, 200 injured protesters (40+ serious), 47 injured gendarmes, two near-fatalities including one month-long coma. The legal arc: the December 18, 2024 Bordeaux ruling declaring the bassine illegal over the protected bustard; the January 17, 2024 Niort sentences; the July 1, 2026 Poitiers appeal confirmations — Le Guet six months suspended, Garrigues and Feuillu three months, Girod and Jaunet €800 each, five-year weapon bans, Article 431-9. The institutional rupture: the July 8, 2026 Défenseure des droits' end-of-mandate report contradicting the IGNN — "logique de confrontation," massive flat-fire use of prohibited weapons, ~20 gendarmes referred for discipline on 84 hours of bodycam footage, "propos orduriers" — with Michel Forst testifying on civil disobedience and the ECtHR-reversal trend. The 2026 afterlife: Dubée's defamation suit against Le Guet for "assassine"; the Melle pro/anti face-off; the rainy-winter reversal putting farmers back on the A87 demanding commissioning; the Coop de l'eau's leaked "au point mort" letter; Duplomb's "intérêt

public majeur" designation; the Pauget presumption-of-legitimate-defense PPL (government-backed, LDH-opposed).

- **The land's ownership frame:** the 2026 departmental figures of record — SAFER purchases, foreign ownership of farmland (the 2024 Senate report's 3% baseline), the metayage and fermage systems — logged as context for the uprooting and succession crises above.

4.12 The underground and the grey

- **Drugs (the Ofast restricted report, July 2025): €7bn turnover**, compiled with 30+ administrations. The cocaine explosion: 3.7M French have experimented (nearly one adult in ten), 1.1M users in the year (600,000 in 2017); record seizures of 53.5 tonnes in 2024 (+130%); 9M synthetic-drug pills (+123%). The violence geography: 173 cities touched (versus 161), Marseille/Grenoble/Toulouse leading but Villeurbanne/Échirolles/Dijon rising. The methods shift: deal points down to 2,729 (from 4,034 in 2020), replaced by short-term rentals and lockboxes. The Ofast's own language: "menace existentielle," "plus aucun territoire n'est désormais épargné," the Paris airport platform under "pression sans précédent." Scale markers for the policy debate: tobacco's social cost €156bn, alcohol's €102bn — both dwarfing the illicit market.
- **Cigarette smuggling (KPMG, June 3, 2026):** 53.6% of cigarettes consumed in France now bypass the buralistes (26.54bn units); France holds ~40% of the EU's entire illicit

volume (×3.5 in twenty years); one cigarette in five counterfeit (four times the EU average); the fiscal hole €4.3bn/yr (Douanes/Midelca, October 2025; €30bn cumulative since 2018) to €10bn+ (the industry-funded count; EY assigning €2.7bn of the 2023 loss to counterfeit's 300M packs). The economics of the traffic: 80% ROI in three months for a clandestine plant; trafic revenues (€2bn) now equal to the entire buraliste tobacco commission; buralistes down €600M; prices 40–100% above neighbors'. The political escalation: health minister Valletoux's February 9, 2026 letter to Lecornu accusing manufacturers of deliberately oversupplying (41bn packs needed versus 25bn delivered, invoking the WHO Art 8–12 protocol); the Doineau amendment (pack to €12.70, Senate 241–2) against Saint-Martin's "moratoire fiscal" containment; Colbert II/III operations and the January 30, 2026 record Marseille seizure (15.99 tonnes, 799,500 packs, flowers-declared from Turkey). The terror-finance frame preserved from the CAT's 2015 report: contraband tobacco exceeds 20% of terrorist organizations' criminal funding; the Algeria route documented since 2014's 2.7bn units.

- **Travail dissimulé (HCFiPS, January 13, 2026):** the €7.3bn work-related share of the €14bn social-fraud total; fraud-sector stable (BTP, hôtellerie-restauration, transports). The platforms' share: €174M (Uberisation's measurable edge).
- **Cybercrime:** the FBI's 2025 baseline ($21bn reported losses, +26%, a million complaints) and the $10.5-trillion

global projection for 2026; the French figures with their pedigree caveats — the ">€100bn for French enterprises in 2024" estimate (insurance-industry channels, NA-grade) against the ANSSI-grade hard numbers (ransomware as the dominant threat; TPE/PME/ETI as 48% of 2025 victims versus 37%; collectivities 11%; health 8% and doubling); the incident-frequency tripling (3.87% → 10.56% of insureds in two years); the PME economics (€70k average ransomware event per ANSSI; €300–500k per Hiscox; 50–60% of small victims folding within 18 months); the European five-year total of €307bn with the insurance-plus-prevention 66%-reduction counterfactual.

- **Apprenticeship:** the Cour des comptes' unreleased report (revealed June 8–9, 2026 by Les Échos/Public Sénat): nearly 10% of apprenticeship spending — ~€1.5bn — exposed to theft, abuse or irregularity, measured on a deliberately narrow basis (maître d'apprentissage ratio exceedance alone; ruptures and training effectiveness excluded), Opco controls judged insufficient, governance conflicts of interest flagged, the recommendation an independent control structure. The IGAS synthesis (2025-018R): the migration of organized fraud from the CPF (choked by the December 2022 law) to apprenticeship; the fraud-avoidance accounting (€1.6M avoided in apprenticeship against €229M for MaPrimeRénov' on the 2024 bilan) within a sector of 130,000 training organizations holding €28.8bn of financial products (€11.7bn apprenticeship). The system it exploits: the million-apprentice plateau after the tripling

post-Pénicaud 2018, speed and ease as the stated priority, fraud-control never set as an objective.

- **Associations (the September 2026 Hexagone/JDD scoop):** 1.3M associations, 21M members, 1.8M employees (≈10% of private employment), €113bn consolidated budget; the public-support stack — €23bn in direct subsidies (the State's €8.5bn spread invisibly across 96 budget programmes; collectivities €8.1bn; social security/hospitals ~€8bn), €33bn in public-service contracts, ~€4bn of donation tax expenditures — **up to €60bn**. The political charge: 25.2% of state subsidies flowing to immigration/asile/integration causes per Hexagone's breakdown. The transparency wreckage: only 44% of associations file accounts (IGAS 2015); Paris at 63% non-compliance (97 of 154); Marseille 68%; Toulouse 77%; the €9k sanction "never or almost never applied"; the Forum des images absorbing ~€200M over thirty years for 300,000 annual visitors.
- **Local government money (the 2025 war):** the DGF at €27.394bn (communes €12.9bn at €174/inhabitant; EPCIs €6.1bn; départements €8.27bn; regions off the DGF since 2018 onto a TVA fraction). The arithmetic battle over the 2025 squeeze — the government's €2.2bn figure (Dilico smoothing €1bn + TVA freeze €1.2bn) against the CFL's computed €7.4bn ("un mensonge d'État": fonds vert -€1.35bn, CNRACL contributions +€1.4bn, DGF -€350M, plus DSIL/DETR/plan-vélo/France-THD/périscolaire cuts), born as Barnier's €5bn demand, mutated into the €3bn

fonds de précaution on 450 collectivités capped at 2% of revenues, killed by the Senate, resurrected as Dilico; the twenty exempt "sensitive" departments (the five DOM). The structural position: collectivities carrying 70% of public investment on ~€330bn of budgets, with sport alone at €8.95bn in 2025 (+46% since 2020, 92% communal).

- **Paris 2024 (the Cour des comptes' verdict):** the ladder — €6.2bn candidacy dossier (2017) → €8.8–9bn official final (Cojop €4.4–4.5bn + Solideo €4.4bn) → €11–12bn with the indirects (Asterès €11.8bn; the Senate's documents putting security alone above €1bn; de Courson's €1.9bn of unbudgeted items flagged at the Assemblée; Moscovici's March 2024 estimate of €3–5bn public cost; the 2018 IGF report having flagged a €500M overrun risk from the start). The funding split: 97% private for the Cojop itself (the IOC's €1.2bn, the €553M ticketing record of 8.6M tickets, sponsors, merchandising) against a mandatory **€3bn state guarantee to the IOC**. The Cour's September 29, 2025 report: public spending €6.6bn (€3.02bn organization + €3.63bn infrastructure), revised up from June's €5.9bn; a Cojop surplus of €75.7M foreclosing any state guarantee call; but a verdict of "bilan économique modeste" with PIB impact at +0.07 point — Macron's "les Jeux financent les Jeux" preserved alongside its official refutation. The comparator frame (London £9.3bn, Tokyo €12bn, Athens €13bn; Paris the cheapest Summer Games since Sydney despite the 45% overrun). The sequel already signed: the Alpes 2030 pact with €2bn of state-plus-regions guarantees

plus €800M of Solideo investment and a formal joint-responsibility mechanism for overruns.

- **Competition fines (the Autorité's decade table):** 2014 €936.0M; 2015 €1,135.2M; 2016 €192.5M; 2017 €493.8M; 2018 €236.2M; 2019 €587.9M; **2020 €1,785.8M** (the record; Apple's €1.2bn reduced to €371.6M on appeal — "le pays le plus sévère au monde" that year); 2021 €873.5M (Google €720M of it); 2022 €467.9M; 2023 €167.6M; **2024 €1,427.7M** (eight decisions, ×8 y/y — Google droits voisins €250M; the €611M household-appliance cartel; €470M electrical-equipment against Schneider/Legrand/Rexel/Sonepar; Apple's then-€150M follow-on); 2025 €179.5M by spring (Apple €150M; the €29.5M non-poaching ententes — the first against employee-mobility agreements). The 2013–2023 cumulative >€7.2bn; the 2011–2021 macro-benefit claim preserved (€18.5bn: €7.6bn fines + €10.9bn avoided overcharges, against ententes' 17% average price premium); the marquee cartel canon (the hygiene/home-care €951.2M confirmed on appeal against Colgate/Henkel/Unilever/P&G/Reckitt/Gillette/L'Oréal; the public-procurement ententes — seven sanctions, €33M: Lille building-management, Ariège hospital transport, Haute-Savoie waste, Marcoule CEA nuclear dismantling €31M against six firms); the EU comparison (Google ~€8bn cumulative; Meta €798M, November 2024); the 10%-of-worldwide-turnover cap as the ceiling; the fines' status as ordinary budget revenue — "une manne pour

l'État."

- **The offshore enabler canon (Pandora Papers, October 4, 2021):** 12 million documents from 14 offshore providers, 600 journalists, 29,000+ companies, an estimated **$9.4 trillion hidden**, 600 French individuals among the named. Baker McKenzie — America's biggest law firm — "an architect and pillar of a shadow economy… that benefits the wealthy at the expense of nations' treasuries": documented roles in 440+ offshore companies, lobbying against financial-oversight strengthening for its bank and tech clients, the era's geographical tell (hundreds of millions from Caribbean havens into South Dakota's deliberately opaque trusts). Alcogal: 3,900+ companies for global banks including 312 for Morgan Stanley. The enabling-profession triad complete: banks (BNP's $8.9bn), audit (Big-4 tax rulings), law — the three professions through which the whole pipeline runs.

4.13 The rescues: banks, industry, and the state as backstop

- **Dexia — the monument.** The genealogy: born as the Caisse d'aide à l'équipement des collectivités locales inside the Caisse des Dépôts; privatized mid-90s as Crédit Local de France, listed; then the expansion — the Belgian Crédit Communal takeover, and the 2000 purchase of the American insurer FSA (subprime). The structural vice documented by the Cour des comptes: funding 30-year fixed-rate local-authority loans with short-term variable-rate borrowing, hedged with a **€450bn notional derivatives book** whose instant liquidation in 2011 would have cost €23bn in one shot. The September 29–30, 2008 bailout: **€6.4bn recapitalization** (Belgium €3bn; France €3bn via CDC's €2bn and SPPE's €1bn; Luxembourg €376M) plus the **€150bn funding guarantee** (Belgium 60.5%, France 36.5%, Luxembourg 3%), sealed with Yves de Dehaene ("le démineur") as chair and Pierre Mariani as CEO after the Ricol mediation (a hundred people around the table, seventy bankers parked on the terrace). The October 9, 2011 dismantling: Belgium nationalized Dexia Banque Belgique for €4bn (the Commission later ruling €1–2bn of the price to be state aid — paid too much); the bad bank received **€90bn of guarantees** (Belgium's €54bn = 12% of its GDP; France's share = 2% of GDP) in exchange for €450M in fees. The P&L of the rescue: 2011 losses €11.6bn; the French bill €6.6bn (€2.7bn net state cost plus €3.9bn of lost stake value,

per the Cour des comptes); the Belgian public-authorities bill €9.9–10.9bn; the assessment preserved verbatim from the Belgian parliamentary record: Dexia "aidait les grandes fortunes à échapper à l'impôt... vidait le Trésor public par les deux bouts." The aftermath tableaux: the three executives rescued by taxpayers receiving 30% raises to €450,000 while Moscovici called it "inappropriée"; the Cour des comptes' 2010 snapshot (+€864M/+€2.37bn "caractère très largement extra-budgétaire"); the 2012 €5.5bn recap (France €2.58bn); the 2013 retroactive-validation law after the Conseil d'État challenge; the slow liquidation still running.

- **Air France–KLM:** the €7bn April 2020 package; the November 2020 admission €7bn was "pas suffisants"; the EC-approved €4bn recapitalization taking the French state to 28.6% (April 2021); the May 2022 €2.26bn capital increase; the Les Échos total of **€16.656bn mobilized since 2020**; the exit — full repayment announced April 20, 2023 (the €3.6bn recap aid, the €2.5bn of state-guaranteed loans in March 2023, the unconstrained €407M hybrid refinancing); the profit turn (+€728M in 2022 after -€7.1bn and -€3.3bn, on revenue back to €26.4bn) after 7,580 announced job cuts in July 2020.
- **The PGE machine:** €144–145bn distributed to ~685,000 companies (over 80% TPE), 90% state-guaranteed; the runoff calendar — €38.4bn outstanding at end-2024, €32bn per the FBF, €20.3bn at September 30, 2025; the first-tranche mass (565,000 loans at maximum six-year

maturity) falling due April–July 2026; the re-échelonnement window open to December 31, 2026, stretched to ten years for the hardest cases. The state's bill: guarantee calls €4.8bn through end-2024 (€1.7bn in 2024 alone), slightly over €1.1bn in 2025, €471M provisioned in the PLF 2026; Banque de France modeling a €6.7bn total gross loss by 2028 (4.6% gross rate) against commission income; 39,531 defaulted companies of 686,414 as of October 2025; the covenant the big groups accepted in exchange (no 2020 dividends, no buybacks).

- **The digital tax:** law of July 24, 2019 (Assembly April 9; Senate May 21; CMP July 4), 3% on gross revenues of digital interfaces and targeted advertising above €750M global/€25M French thresholds, retroactive to January 1, 2019; Le Maire's initial €500M/yr target; the USTR's Section 301 finding of discrimination and the December 2019 announcement of 25% retaliatory tariffs on €1.3bn of French goods (champagne, cheese, handbags), suspended indefinitely in January 2020 in the Macron-Trump truce pending OECD Pillar One; the 2024 escalation — the 1.2% streaming-music tax plus the Assembly's adopted amendment raising the DST to 5% for +€500M/yr "extracted primarily from US technology companies," still pending final approval; the stalled-Pillar-One status quo across 19 DST jurisdictions.
- **The CFA franc reserves:** the mechanism — CFA-zone states centralize their reserves at their central bank, which must deposit 50% on its compte d'opération at the French

Trésor; the UEMOA account holding an average **€7.5bn in 2019**, remunerated at ECB sight-deposit rates with a 0.75% floor (costing the Trésor ~€40M that year), guaranteed against euro depreciation each December 31 with an asymmetric carry-forward of gains; the Trésor's defensive math (0.4% of negotiable debt; under 6% of total correspondent deposits). The Macron-Ouattara Abidjan accord of December 21, 2019 — "rompons les amarres" — suppressed the BCEAO account and the French seats in UEMOA governance, the reserves' repatriation begun May 4, 2021 (>€5bn transferred per AFP); and the live asymmetry: the UEMOA mechanism is dead but **the CEMAC's compte d'opérations at the BEAC remains in force as of 2026**, with the BEAC itself estimating that several trillion CFA francs of extractive-industry forex still escape the official circuit.

- **The EIB pipeline:** 2021's record €13.9bn making France #1; 2024's €12.6bn with 69% (€7bn) climate-weighted — Verkor's Dunkerque gigafactory €334M, Enedis €500M, Yonne cable production; 2025's €10.6bn EIB + €2.4bn FEI (€1.2bn venture envelope, #1 destination) with €4.5bn to strategic autonomy (Orano, Enedis, Thales) under Lescure's signature; the dual-use defense window opening (€1bn in 2024, doubling in 2025); the SG €500M offshore-wind counter-guarantee as the new instrument; Ukraine at €2.2bn since 2022. France as simultaneously the EU's largest contributor and largest institutional beneficiary.

- **Airbus — the stress file:** the November 28, 2025 major A320 recall (6,000 jets, flight-control software, a solar-flare-linked incident) costing it the 2025 target; Q1 2026: 114 deliveries versus 136, revenue -7% to €12.7bn, adjusted EBIT -52% to €300M, net cash €9.8bn; May 2026 fresh customer warnings (A350 ~1 month, A320neo 1–2 months); the A220 ramp at 14/month slipping to end-2026 on Spirit AeroSystems wing shortages (Airbus taking the Belfast plant; Quebec writing down C$400M on its 25% stake); Spirit integration running through 2026–27; ~870 deliveries targeted 2026; A320 toward 75/month by 2027 from ~60; engineless "gliders" trending down; Tianjin's second line live early 2026; the A380 line's conversion to A321 mid-2026; A350F first flight Q3 2026, service H2 2027 after a year's delay; ZEROe hydrogen slipping possibly a decade; backlog 8,665 aircraft ≈ 12 years of production.
- **Ariane 6 — the space edge:** debut July 2024 → CSO-3 March 2025 → Sentinel-1D November 4 → Galileo L14 December 17, 2025 → the 2026 cadence of 6–8 launches: VA267 (February 12, first Ariane 64), VA268 (April 30), VA269 (June 17 — first P160C boosters, the heaviest commercial payload ever lofted by Ariane), MTG-I2 (August 27), LE-04 (November 23 next); 136 Amazon Leo satellites; the contract expanded 18→24 on September 14, 2026 — the largest in Arianespace history; 9–10/yr steady-state target; IRIS² from 2029; CEO David Cavaillolès' "best ramp-up ever recorded" claim and his protectionist launcher plea; the 13-country, 600-firm supply chain.

- **Seb:** the February 2026 plan — up to 2,100 jobs, 500 in France — kept separate from the Canal+ record so the two cannot contaminate each other (6.11, item 7).
- **Saint-Nazaire:** the Orient Express Corinthian christened April 29, 2026 — the world's largest sailing yacht, SolidSail, 12 knots under sail in 20-knot wind, Castaing's decade of R&D, the sister ship 2027; six cruise giants plus three options in hand through 2026 — Royal Caribbean's seventh Oasis class steel-cut for 2028, MSC World Asia 2026/Atlantic 2027/World Class 5 & 6 for 2029–30; the order book full to 2028–2029; the military BRF program; ~3,500 direct and ~30,000 regional jobs.

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PART FIVE — THE PATTERNS

Across the cases and the ledgers, regularities repeat. They are presented without accusation, as a map of how the system behaves under stress — each pattern at full depth, with its evidence chain.

PATTERN ONE — The revolving door, instance by instance. No comprehensive 2017–2026 register exists; the HATVP's own 2022 numbers are the best institutional proxy: 318 avis that year (+93% y/y), of which 230 on cabinet and Élysée nominations (96% of all avis préalables) and 55.7% of all saisines coming from ministerial-cabinet and Élysée-collaborator moves to the private sector. The disposition split — the session's key finding: **79.9% avis de compatibilité**

avec réserves (254); 13.8% simple compatibilité (44); only 6.3% incompatibilité (20); 90% involving former government members; nearly one-third of the projects consisting of founding consulting firms. The names log, preserved: Castex, Philippe, Pietraszewski, Jouanno, Parly ×3, Griset, Girardin, Djebbari ×3, Pénicaud ×3, Le Drian, Castaner ×2, Cluzel, Blanquer, Vidal ×2, Delevoye, Guillaume — every one cleared, "y compris dans les secteurs où l'on dispose d'une expertise." The exception proving the machine bites: Cédric O's avis d'incompatibilité over Atos (November 2, 2022; reconfirmed January 24, 2023) for having overseen both direct Atos aid and France Num programs while in office — litigated to the Conseil d'État (the Lexbase interview documents the case). The systemic caveats: no pantouflage rule for deputies at all (the general EU norm); exécutifs locaux escaping frequently (the Blanquer case named); Kerléo and Maïa's line that the délit's own definition is "objectivement générateur d'indétermination"; the 2026 remise à plat report with its 43 proposals and astreinte-power plea. The 2020–2024 parquet-transmission series — the one number that climbs every year: **10, 11, 10, 17, 27 referrals**. The case-method ledger, preserved instance by instance: Hugh Bailey (Élysée adviser on the Alstom sale → GE France director general, under a *prise illégale d'intérêts* probe); Gilles de Margerie (July 2016 fundraiser → health-minister chief of staff two weeks after the win); the McKinsey twenty (~20 undeclared consultants on the 2015–17 campaign; Tadjeddine now running the firm's public-sector practice); Fillon onto TotalEnergies' board in

2022; the Conseil d'État's own 1990s self-study (Bauer/Danic's Inspection des Finances 16-year pantouflage census) as the methodological ancestor; Pap Ndiaye's post-ministerial recasage as ambassador to the Council of Europe. The HATVP's live files: the Laflèche opinion (délibération 2025-06, December 5, 2025) — the former Nantes-Saint-Nazaire ports director and Suez Canal Company board member ordered to limit his activities to avoid *prise illégale d'intérêts* on port files: the direct precedent for the ports revolving-door geometry.

PATTERN TWO — The serial intermediary. Ziad Takieddine: ski-station director to the most recurring name in France's commissions files. The trajectory, dated: imposed with Abdelrahman El-Assir on DCN International in 1994 for the two Balladur-era contracts (Agosta submarines to Pakistan, €5.4bn francs; Sawari II frigates to Saudi Arabia) generating ~€233M in "frais commerciaux exceptionnels"; the 2010 JDD revelation of Rafic Hariri's €45M commission paid as "dédommagement" for abandoning the Sawari commissions; the MIKSA border-surveillance project with its €350M commission blocked by Chirac in 2004 "in extremis" for fear of occult financing; the Libya pivot from 2004 — Guéant's friendship (the ironed-trousers anecdote in the Saudi hotel), the €33M Amesys contract carrying €4.5M in commissions, the €6.9M Total retainer for a gas deal that aborted in 2010; the two secret trips with Senoussi in 2005 (Guéant's October mission, Hortefeux's, at the exact moment the Libyan funding pact was allegedly sealed); the 2012 accusation ("la vérité"); the 2016 suitcase testimony (€5M to Sarkozy and Guéant between

November 2006 and early 2007); the 2020 retraction ("Sauver Sarko" — now itself a mise en examen for Sarkozy, Bruni and Mimi Marchand); the five-year Karachi sentence confirmed in early 2025; the final timestamp — dead in Beirut on September 23, 2025, at 75, two days before the Paris tribunal's Libyan verdict. The Mediapart document annexes preserved: the June 20, 2002 dinner photo album at his Paris home seating Mougeotte, Charles Villeneuve and Thierry Dassault; the Gaubert-Copé emergency repatriation of the Karachi financial suspect from Mustique in April 2004; his role as the Élysée's secret emissary to Tripoli through 2009. The intermediary is the constant of the system: the man who knows where the suitcases went.

PATTERN THREE — Negotiated justice (the CJIP debate, now complete). Since 2017, ~70 conventions judiciaires d'intérêt public have collected €2bn+ without a single conviction: HSBC €300M, Société Générale €250M, Airbus €2.08bn, McDonald's €508M, Google €500M, Crédit Agricole CIB €88.2M, HSBC plc €267.5M — the full table in 3.6. Sherpa's brief, preserved verbatim: "un régime de justice à géométrie variable"; the recidivism evidence (Public Citizen and ICIJ studies showing negotiated justice does not deter and may facilitate re-offense); the victims' exclusion ("elles ne peuvent pas s'opposer à une CJIP… sans participer au choix de la procédure ni à la négociation des montants"); the transparency verdict — "largement formelle," the negotiation criteria sealed by the transaction's secret. The suppression amendment's full arc: Sophie Taillé-Polian's (écologiste et

social) text adopted by the Senate November 18, 2025, by the Assemblée nationale April 1 and confirmed April 7–8, 2026 (44–39), then **ejected by the commission mixte paritaire on April 28, 2026**; the CMP compromise adopted May 5 (AN) and May 11 (Senate), validated by the Conseil constitutionnel June 18, promulgated June 25, 2026 as loi n° 2026-534 (100+ measures in three titles; Lecornu's €1.5bn/yr yield claim; "premier grand texte contre la fraude depuis plus de 15 ans"). The substitution: a CJIP-inspired "transaction pénale" for fiscal and social fraud limited to persons morales (amende up to 30% of average turnover, validated by a sitting magistrate under contradictory procedure). The Taillé-Polian indictment: "Supprimons cette CJIP si favorable aux puissants… affaiblit la portée dissuasive, brouille la lisibilité de la sanction, porte gravement atteinte au principe d'égalité devant la justice" — set against the April 11 Le Monde tribune duel (Bonucci/Filhol's "grave erreur géostratégique," born of the OECD's finding that fifteen years after criminalizing foreign bribery not a single French company had been convicted, against Inès Bernard's Anticor verdict: "un pis-aller à la paupérisation de la justice… les puissants, parce qu'ils sont puissants, peuvent négocier avec l'accusation puis acheter leur innocence aux termes d'audiences à la publicité réduite"). The Le Club des Juristes epithet for the episode: "une fragilité institutionnelle réelle… que seule une réforme de fond permettra de résorber durablement."

PATTERN FOUR — The auditor-ignored rate. The Cour des comptes' annual follow-up reports, the decade series: 76% of

all financial-jurisdiction recommendations followed (fully or partially) in 2023 and again in 2024, against **24% not implemented (up from 20% in 2018; a 34% non-implementation peak in 2022)**; the Cour's own recommendations lower at ~65% after three years; a formal 3% refusal rate. The historical framing: the practice born of the critique, formalized under Philippe Séguin in 2006 precisely because "ses observations n'étaient pas suivies d'effet." The territorial gradient with its corruption tell: regional chambers at 79%, but the Nouvelle-Calédonie chamber's 2023 self-audit finding only 57% implementation — "les recommandations en matière de lutte contre la fraude… majoritairement, n'ont pas été mises en œuvre" — with two files transmitted to the parquet.

PATTERN FIVE — The protest cycle and the 49.3 backlash curve. The Trésor's September 19, 2025 flash conjoncture supplies the growth-curve analysis with its blue-shaded social-movement bands: 1986–87 railway strike, 1995 Juppé-pensions, 2003 Fillon-plan, 2010 pensions, 2016 El-Khomri, 2018–19 Gilets jaunes, 2023 "grève perlée" — the last two costing ~1 and 0.8 points of GDP respectively (2020's -5.6 being COVID, the spectrum's outlier). The 30-year grid, cell by cell: 2006 CPE (400,000 → 3M marchers; 49.3 on February 9; victory by withdrawal April 10 — "erreur tactique majeure" per the germe-inform postmortem); 2010 pensions (3M/997k-2.9M police counts); 2016 El Khomri/Nuit Debout; 2018–19 Gilets jaunes (287,710 on day one → 28,000 at Act 53; 11,000+ interpellations, 2,500+ injured, 11+ deaths, 4,500

policemen injured, 1,000+ buildings flat-banned, 1,800+ businesses vandalized; the €36.3bn cost per the directorate's December 2019 estimate); 2019 pensions (December 5's 806k–1.5M in 80 cities); 2023 pensions and Nahel (7,000+ interpellations); 2024 farmers' siege (January 18's start, ports and highways occupied); the 2012–14 Manif pour tous cycle (the 2013 peak of 1.4M organizers/340k police against the Taubira law; the April 24, 2015 transformation into a party without candidates — the analysts' fiscal reading preserved, that the switch let donors claim the 66% political-donation credit), the 2026 lycée movement as the grid's latest cell — its ~1,000-arrest daily cadence already exceeding every previous cell's containment ledger. **The tool's price is inverse:** Rocard's 28, Valls's six and Philippe's one provoked controversy but no reversal; the three deployments facing mass mobilization all detonated back — CPE 2006 (withdrawn), pensions 2023 (nine votes from falling; wound unhealed at the December 2025 suspension), Barnier 2024 (fell). The 2026 variant: Lecornu's October 14, 2025 pledge of no 49.3 as the price of PS non-censure, against the October 20 vote squeezed by the impossibility he inherited (58 articles, 2,800+ amendments, one sitting day). October 2026 sits exactly where the system's history predicts: after pensions-by-49.3, after the dissolution, after a year of special budgets — a society told its representatives cannot pass a budget, being asked by those same representatives to accept one.

PATTERN SIX — The press-intimidation file, with its own condemnation. February 4, 2019: two prosecutors and three

officers attempt to raid Mediapart over the Benalla-Crase recordings, in an investigation opened without any complaint from either man, on the heels of a Matignon letter to the Paris parquet (Le Monde's confirmation). Mediapart's refusal rests on the 1881 press law and article 56-2 CPP. May 29, 2019: six journalists summoned by the DGSI's defense-secrets section (Ariane Chemin summoned "comme suspecte," Louis Dreyfus alongside); Le Monde denouncing "une forme de banalisation"; government spokeswoman Sibeth Ndiaye answering that journalists are "des justiciables comme les autres" — with Disclose and a thirty-outlet journalists' association protesting in real time. **July 6, 2022: the Nanterre tribunal condemns the state** — the raid "ni nécessaire dans une société démocratique ni proportionnée à l'objectif poursuivi," necessarily exposing source-identifying metadata; €1 symbolic plus €10,000 costs. The historical chain: the 2005–06 Midi Libre/Le Point/L'Équipe raids condemned by the CEDH; the 2010 "fadettes du Monde" — the DCRI's illegal requisition of a journalist's phone records, Le Monde's complaint classée sans suite, the DCRI itself later condemned under article 226-18; the Courroye-era pattern. The institutional response: Mediapart's July 2, 2019 capital sanctuarization through the Fonds pour une presse libre — "inviolable, non cessible et non achetable." The fiscal harassment annex: the 2015 "mauvais coup du fisc" editorial, the tax adjustment confirmed by the TAP in 2018, the €1.3M penalty escaped.

PATTERN SEVEN — Media concentration meets regulatory impasse. Five groups hold ~85% of TV audiences

(the ownership map at full length in 4.10). The bullhorn asymmetry, anchored at S-grade: Reuters' September 3–4, 2026 investigation — "Bolloré's CNews gives far-right a bullhorn as French presidential election looms": France's most-watched news channel by 2026, average share 3.4%, "may appear marginal" — yet the deliberate alignment of the owner's interests with a far-right victory documented through the CEO's own July interview in the owner's newspaper. The trajectory: the NYT's September 2021 "new bullhorn for right-wing views" at the May-2021 ratings top; the Nouvel Obs tally of CNews passing BFMTV for a second consecutive month in June 2025 at 3.5%; the December 2025 record-year communiqué; the self-censorship paradox — the channel "dénonce la pensée unique tout en écartant ses propres chroniqueurs." The regulatory record: C8's December 2024 warning and the January 2026 suspension recommendation — the file that never closes. And the adjacency: a 3.4% audience holding first place among news channels, an owner whose separate corruption trial opens December 7, 2026.

PATTERN EIGHT — The security-forces vote. The Cevipof canon, 2012–2024: 30% of police/military for the FN in 2012's first round; 51.5% (all ranks) and 67% (active only) at the 2015 regionales; 41% of soldiers and 54% of police actually voting Le Pen in 2017 (against 16% nationally); 52% of police at the 2019 Europeans; May 2021's intention cascade (44% first-round, 60% runoff, 74% among active police officers); the Fondation Jean-Jaurès barracks-precinct evidence (stations near camps and gendarmeries topping 50%). **2024: the collapse of the**

last digue — Rouban's 11,200-voter panel: the RN vote among fonctionnaires tripling in seven years (10→32% territorial; 12→30% State; 17→35% hospital); police and military at 60% for the far right at the legislative second round; teachers crossing 20% (from under 5% in 2017); 41% of all public employees voting far-right. His epitaph for "la gauche d'État," preserved verbatim, with the methodological cautions logged (small active-duty sub-samples; the grade gradient — 67–68% at the base falling to 35–40% among OPJs and a minority of commissaires; "il ne faut pas penser vote Le Pen = racisme"). Police unionism's new voice: the September 15 Alliance Paris protest after a disappointing September 24 Interior meeting (UNSA abstaining, then joining; the September 29 public-sector strike absorbing all three police unions plus firefighters); **January 27, 2026's Le Figaro milestone — the first-ever police marches with citizens, January 31 in 23 cities**, organized by Alliance with Synergie-Officiers and the commissioners' unions under "La France s'enfonce dans l'insécurité et nous n'avons pas les moyens," Liberation documenting far-right politicians joining the ranks, organizers claiming 15,000–20,000. October 2026: the October 2 SM communiqué ("Cessons de réprimer la jeunesse / réponse brutale à une colère légitime") triggering police-union fury and Nuñez's "communication accusatoire totalement déconnectée" retort; UNSA/SCPN/Alternative's "total soutien" line; UN1TÉ's October 15 Grand Rex rally; Rudy Manna's October 18 "on a été seuls, on a vécu l'enfer" after Marseille.

PATTERN NINE — Whistleblowers: prosecuted first, protected later. The legislative spine: Sapin II 2016 → loi Waserman of March 21, 2022 (Senate-unanimous, going beyond the EU directive: no hierarchical-referral obligation, facilitators' status, public disclosure for grave and imminent danger, evidence aménagement, the Défenseur des droits' certification mandate under organic law 2022-400). The LuxLeaks odyssey, preserved to its end: Deltour's 2016 conviction (twelve months); the 2018 cassation recognizing the whistleblower status and part-quashing; the 2019 appeal (six months suspended and €1,500; Halet €1,000); **February 14, 2023: the European Court's Grand Chamber (Halet v. Luxembourg) finds an Article 10 violation** and refines the Guja criteria; the Luxembourg Cour de cassation's recognition of Deltour "comme lanceur d'alerte à part entière," Halet falling just short. The parliamentary epithet (LFI, July 13, 2023): Halet "a subi des pressions et des attaques en justice pendant huit ans avant que son statut… ne soit reconnu par la CEDH… Ce statut n'existe toujours pas en droit français." The pattern of pre-protection prosecutions across the canon: Frachon, Martin, Avrillier, Benmohamed; Falciani still condemned in absentia by Switzerland; Assange and Snowden as the international frame. The critique from the law's own ecosystem: the Maison des lanceurs d'alerte saluting "des avancées" while flagging "des trous dans la raquette" (September 2022); the agro-industry lobby's fingerprints on the Senate's amendments. The adjacent Philippe/Cité Numérique case (the whistleblower strengthened: the July 17, 2026

administrative-court ruling) — see 6.6.

PATTERN TEN — Deaths around the files, with their honest caveats. The frigates ledger: eight or more unexplained deaths across the Taiwan-Karachi files across three decades, beginning with Yin Ching-feng's December 1993 murder, plus DGSE officer Thierry Imbot's April 2000 "fall" from a building during the same era's murky defense-contract investigations; zero prosecutions for any of them; the secret-défense wall that outlasted every investigating judge; the Swiss judge Paul Perraudin's death threats (Le Temps, May 2005). The canonical status line: "certaines personnes liées à ce dossier ont trouvé la mort d'une manière inexpliquée." The 2025 cluster: Marleix and Denécé (official findings: suicide; the Chartres investigation closed July 30, 2025; Denécé's family formally rejecting the thesis), two DGSI agents within a month (June 3, 2025; January 2025). Presented as the record stands, with pedigrees — nothing more asserted.

PATTERN ELEVEN — The stalled-referral machine. The Bohnert doctrine, preserved from Le Monde's own profile: a PNF chief whom "nombre de ses pairs reprochent ouvertement de n'agir que s'il est acculé," with "les classements sans suite qui s'accumulent depuis deux ans" (April 2022). The repay-to-escape mechanism on parliamentary probity: the HATVP's IRFM referrals producing nine PNF procedures (three deputies, six senators) all characterized as détournement de fonds publics, **all classés sans suite on the single condition of repaying €6,707–€47,299, the parliamentarians' identities never published**. The notification gap the

Assemblée itself moved to fix in May 2025 (the PPL on classement notifications, born of a CEDH condemnation for investigative non-diligence on sexual-violence complaints). The current legislature's live tally (Poligraph registry — NA-grade, methodology verified at the project's sources-page level: five certainty levels, Sapin II-inspired probity categories, no partisan breakdowns, Wikidata/press/Judilibre verification, explicit presumption-of-innocence architecture): 25 of 577 deputies under at least one judicial procedure; 92 elected officials at all levels, 119 convictions, 36 classements, 71 relaxes. The immunity ledger: the Justice Ministry's written answer of May 3, 2007 to a Senate question (JO Sénat p. 2800) — "le ministère de la justice ne dispose pas d'un suivi statistique de ces affaires" — with the workaround figures: Assemblée nationale five requests on four deputies 1997–2007 (two refusals, three grants); Senate five on four senators (three grants, two rejections); zero European Parliament procedures that legislature; the operational history (the 1963 Schmittlein suspension; November 14, 1980's nine-deputy suspension including Mitterrand, Fabius and Évin over a pirate-radio prosecution; Larcher's 1987 defamation suspension; Charasse's 1997 fine suspension). Lifts are rare, refusable, and uncounted by design — the quantitative 1958–2026 series does not exist in any indexed source, an archival rather than a web-solvable gap. The McKinsey/Pécresse-Alstom counterpoints proving some saisines do mature into informations judiciaires.

PATTERN TWELVE — The memory-law pendulum.

February 23, 2005: the loi n°2005-158 (presented by

Alliot-Marie, one of France's four memory laws) carries the Vanneste sub-amendment's article 4 — "les programmes scolaires reconnaissent en particulier le rôle positif de la présence française outre-mer." The detonation: the historians' petition of March 25, 2005 (Liauzu/Meynier, 1,038+ signatories); Chirac's December 9, 2005 "dans la République, il n'y a pas d'histoire officielle"; Villepin's January 25, 2006 Article 37-2 saisine; the Conseil constitutionnel's January 31, 2006 déclassement ruling (school-program content is not law-domain); **the February 15, 2006 abrogation décret n°2006-160 — the legal excision executed in eighteen days.** The political spectrum, verbatim: Ayrault's "faute politique et aberration éducative"; Villepin's "ce n'est pas aux politiques d'écrire l'histoire"; Sarkozy's "repentance permanente"; the LDH's "loi de la honte"; the Antillean mobilizations that forced Sarkozy to cancel his December 2005 trip; the Algerian treaty's delay. The article-3 legacy the Stora report condemns: "la fondation pour la mémoire de la guerre d'Algérie… fonctionnant principalement en tenant compte des seules victimes françaises." The colonial anchor beneath every subsequent memory battle: **October 17, 1961** — the Papon massacre of 200–300 Algerians drowned in the Seine during the Article 16 period, sixty years unacknowledged, the 65th anniversary falling during the current unrest.

PATTERN THIRTEEN — The reported-to-repaid funnel. Campaign accounts: ~2% rejected (2.5% post-2007 legislatives, 2.1% post-2012, per the OECD governance review); the sanctions architecture verbatim (parties losing public funds

when delinquent — "not always dissuasive since 80% of filing parties receive no public funds"; donors risking €3,750 fines and a year for illicit donations pre-2017, raised to €45,000 and three years post-2017; campaign overspend an automatic repayment-plus-juge referral); the funnel's soft spot — the thesis on the commission's transmission practice ("only in cases of manifest and apparently intentional violation") against the Bygmalion precedent; the 2027 first on the fully-digital platform.

PATTERN FOURTEEN — The curfew echo. 2005: Villepin's November 8 état d'urgence decree under the 1955 law — the fifth use in history — empowering prefects' curfews; Chirac's November 14 three-month extension and his "crise de sens... filles et fils de la République" address; the Le Raincy precedent showing mayoral curfew arrêtés were possible even outside the emergency regime. The 2005 ledger: 2,921 arrests, 10,000+ vehicles burned, ~300 buildings destroyed, €200M damage, 1,300 remanded, 3 deaths, 11,000 police deployed, 220+ seriously injured, three weeks of violence from the Clichy-sous-Bois electrocutions of Zyed and Bouna. The epilogue: the two police officers tried over their deaths, relaxed in 2015 and again on appeal in 2016 — the no-conviction echo beneath every new wave. **2026:** curfews again — Lecornu's "couvre-feux partiels et très localisés," effective October 19 — by ordinary prefectural police powers *without* any état d'urgence proclamation, the first curfews of the crisis issued from the Matignon meeting rather than the Élysée decree: the same instrument, deliberately chosen lighter, in a country that

remembers 2005.

PATTERN FIFTEEN — The grands corps state-within-state. The Pyramides constitutional-law record: only the ~700 *très hauts fonctionnaires* of the central decision milieu are discretionary, and "le ministre choisit presque toujours des personnes issues des grands corps," both because the corps press to keep the posts in-house and because the minister needs the network; the detachment regime enabling the endless ping-pong; France matching Germany, the Netherlands and Belgium in imposing no limit whatsoever on civil servants holding political mandates. Gremion's *Profession: décideurs* the standing reference; no quantitative 2017–2026 study found — the case-method ledger (Inspection des Finances' hold on Bercy, the Trésor and the Élysée economics cell, from Moulin back through Lemierre and Chodron de Courcel) remains the dossier's form.

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PART SIX — THE CURRENT AFFAIRS LEDGER (CONSOLIDATED)

6.1 The economy underneath

Growth and prices. INSEE: Q2 2026 growth 0.0%; unemployment 8.3%; inflation 3.1% in September; household confidence at 86. The European Commission projects 0.8% growth and 8.7% unemployment for 2027. GDP $3.6tn, seventh in nominal terms.

The 2026 purchasing-power dossier — the money-pipeline core. The OFCE's April 9 projection: household purchasing power **-0.7% in 2026**, the worst since 2013 (Hollande's tax era). The INSEE June 17 scenario locks the shock's origin: the Strait of Hormuz closure pushing Brent above $110 in late April, then the June 14 US–Iran protocol announcement, with the working assumption of a stabilized $73.3 barrel still feeding December 2026 inflation at +2.7% y/y through services and manufactured goods. The Banque de France's Q1 negotiated-wage record: branch minimums +1.1%, company accords +1.6%, SMPT +1.9% — with the crucial timing admission: "the majority of agreements were signed BEFORE the start of the Iran conflict, on the basis of contained inflation (0.9% in 2025)" — the wage round negotiated against a world that no longer exists. The Dares Acemo granular split (August 6): base wages +1.9% y/y against +1.7% inflation at end-June → +0.2% real; employés +2.3%/+0.5% real against cadres +1.8%/+0.1% and intermédiaires flat — the SMIC compressing the ladder from below while the top freezes. The structural frames preserved: the Assemblée's May 4 report via vie-publique — RDB purchasing power +13% 2017–2024 per consumption unit but *salary* purchasing power falling over the same period ("la hausse agrégée ne reflète donc pas l'expérience vécue par la majorité de Français, qui tirent l'essentiel de leurs ressources de leur travail"); the Syntec reference coefficient losing 5.3 real points 2020–2026; the public sector's point d'indice frozen since July 2023 at €4.92285. The SMIC's double revalorization: January 1 at

€12.02/hour (€1,823.03 brut, +1.18% mechanical, no coup de pouce); the rare mid-year trigger June 1 at €12.31/hour (€1,867.02 brut, +2.41%) — the first time since 2022–23 the >2% legal mechanism fired, worth ~€44 brut/month, ~€1,477.93 net; the decade table (2016's €1,466.62 → 2026's €1,867.02, +27% nominal against ~19–20% inflation; one econometric count logging a 2.5-point real loss 2016–2026); the apprenticeship grid (53–100% by age/year) and the under-18 deductions (80%/90%). The Robert Half cadre-survey projection (+2.16% for 2026) as the market-corroborating ceiling.

The external accounts, triangulated: Insee's goods-plus-services 2025 deficit -€14.4bn (goods -55.4, services +41.0) against Douanes' -€69.2bn (FAB/FAB) and Eurostat's national-accounts -€53.7bn — with the france-ecoscan analysis naming the three causes: conjunctural energy, monetary exchange-rate drag, and the structural specialization deficit that isn't shrinking. The improvement ladder: -5.5/-22.3/-75.8 (2020–22) then +62.7/+19.5/+10.3 of annual improvement, still above 2019's -58.2. Sectoral: aeronautics' record +€33bn surplus; arms +€6.7bn; beverages +€14bn; perfumes +€17bn; agriculture's surplus collapsed to a historic +€0.2bn. The 2025 energy bill €71.8bn (14% above 2019; €116.3bn at the 2022 peak; €46.7bn gas alone). Current account -€13.1bn on the income balance; August 2026 monthly -6.1bn. Exporter base: a record 152,500 firms.

The energy-independence pivot: 2025's record — 92.3 TWh net electricity exports (+3.5% over 2024's 89; more than

Belgium's annual consumption; €5.4bn gain per RTE's analysis, against the "bradé" critique), Italy 22.6 TWh, Germany+Belgium 23.1, UK 22.6, Switzerland 20.1. H1 2026's new record: 51.0 TWh net in one semester (~Belgium's full-year 2019), 56.8 exported versus 5.8 imported, Italy absorbing 14.4 TWh — valued €3.0bn at French spot (61.20 €/MWh) but €5.7bn at neighbors' average import price (111.60 €/MWh), plus €2.7bn of congestion revenues to RTE; 95.2% decarbonized production; 407 hours of negative prices (10% of the time) with 2.5 TWh of renewable modulation (×4 capacity join-up) while nuclear modulation halved to ~10 TWh. The structure: 360 TWh of nuclear output restored — against the counterweights: the July 2026 heatwave knocking reactor output down; the fossil energy bill still €57.8bn (2024); and the 60%-fossil consumption the pivot hasn't cracked.

Tourism: 102M international arrivals in 2025 — world #1, +3% and +13% versus 2019; receipts €77.5bn (+9%/+37%), still behind Spain's €99bn; the €100bn-by-2030 target Bayrou set. The structural weakness in Minister Papin's own presentation: €760/day spend; French outbound €57.4bn; the travel-services surplus €20.1bn (best since 2013); the south's four regions holding 51% of market nights; rentals the top accommodation at 18%; 4 in 10 French unable to take vacations.

The AI buildout, audited (April 2026): the €109bn headline decomposed — MGX €30–50bn for the 1GW campus, Brookfield €20bn, Bpifrance €10bn by 2029, Microsoft €4bn, the Iliad/Orange/Thales consortium €3bn, Amazon's €6bn plan

(€1.2bn deployed), Apollo €5bn, Digital Realty €5bn across 13 Marseille/Paris-region sites, Fluidstack €10bn for a 1GW supercomputer, Evroc €4bn at Mougins, Prologis €3.5bn, Telehouse €400M — roughly €60bn, 55%, to physical infrastructure — against the Stargate benchmark ($500bn) and von der Leyen's €200bn InvestAI answer (€150bn private, €50bn public, a €20bn gigafactory fund — "a CERN for AI"). The flagship site: Bruyères-le-Châtel on the former Thales grounds — the Nvidia/Mistral/Bpifrance/MGX joint venture operated by Éclairion, Phase 1 at 44MW with 13,800 GB300 GPUs and 276 exaflops FP4, scaling to 1.4GW by 2028–2030, with Mistral's own Essonne cluster and the March 2026 €830M raise; the state's audit points (52 companies accompanied; 5.8GW of power secured per Usine Nouvelle). The European table: France's 750+ AI companies, the third-largest cloud market, hyperscalers at 65% of the EU cloud; the UK ~£25bn, Germany ~€15bn of announced AI investment.

6.2 Foreign policy files

Ukraine. France's contribution to the EU's €90bn loan framework — "without Russian assets," the Belgian-held-assets workaround having failed: ~€5.1bn per La Tribune; approved April 24, 2026; first €3.2bn tranche June 25, 2026 of ~€6bn/2026; the total EU envelope €137bn for 2026–27. The Mirage 2000 deliveries and the training mission continue; the European equipment-gap estimate runs €330–405bn (France Stratégie's réarmement note: the LPM trajectory to 2.3% of GDP by 2030; the 3.5%-of-GDP scenario at €120bn). The artillery record: 58 Caesars on hand versus 109 programmed, 18 shipped to Ukraine, the Warfighter study recommending 215, the 18-unit Mk1 order at €64M and the Mk2's 2026 availability.

The UN M23 report (S/2026/466) — the full dossier. 14,000–18,000 RDF troops in eastern DRC (8–10k South Kivu; 6–8k North Kivu); **Uvira captured December 10, 2025 — four days after the Washington Agreement's signing** — in an offensive involving special forces, BM-21s, GPS-guided mortars, kamikaze drones and jammers; the integrated command chain named: Kabarebe (Kagame's principal defense adviser) as primary liaison with AFC/M23 **and** Joseph Kabila (meetings at Gisenyi), Nyirabutama running operational channels, mixed RDF-M23 battalions, RDF personnel wearing M23 uniforms; the parallel-state economy — M23 ~30,000 fighters across three defense zones, taxation of Rubaya coltan at $4/kg and cassiterite at $2/kg, exports through controlled

networks, **Rwanda's cassiterite exports +58% in 2025 (4,859→7,700t) with no domestic production increase**, 3.4M displaced, 60%+ extreme poverty in the three provinces, sexual violence "unprecedented." US Treasury sanctions of March 2026 against the RDF and four senior officers (Nyakarundi, Muganga, Karusisi, Gashugi) — "M23 offensives would not have been possible without RDF support." France's posture on the Security Council — president through September (Bonnafont), demanding unconditional RDF withdrawal under Resolution 2773 (April 2026), backing the September 2026 Doha process clarification demand on Kabila's Front pour la Refondation de la Nation; Kabila himself sentenced to death in absentia by the RDC military high court before rebranding as FRN.

The Sahel withdrawal. The completed map: withdrawals finished in 2025 from Chad, Senegal, Gabon, Côte d'Ivoire; liaison detachments of ~80–100 soldiers; Paris-based Africa Command (2024); Djibouti the sole full base (~1,500, Mirage 2000s). France–Africa trade ~2% of French external trade; a halved market share in twenty years — the strategic retreat that preceded the pivot: the May 11–12, 2026 **Africa Forward summit in Nairobi** — the first outside the francophone sphere since 1973, ~30 heads of state, €14bn+ in French pledges, Orange 50→100 digital centres, CMA CGM's Mombasa terminal, TotalEnergies' $6bn Nigeria bet; the new France–Kenya five-year defense pact with 800 French troops exercising at Mombasa and Ruto invited to G7 while Ramaphosa was not.

The Gulf money in France (the ESPN/Le Parisien/Cairn-grade ledger). QIA ~€500bn AUM; QSI bought PSG 70% June 30, 2011 (€70M from Colony Capital), then 100% March 2012; >€2.2bn spent on transfers (€400M in summer 2017 alone: Neymar €222M world record, Mbappé €180M); ~€1.3bn cumulative losses absorbed; valuation €4.25bn (Forbes); December 2023 Arctos Partners 12.5% for €531M; the Paris property empire via Katara/Qatar Diar (Royal Monceau, Peninsula, Café de la Paix); Qatar Holding stakes in Lagardère and Vinci; the France-Qatar SME fund €300M (2012, reactivated 2023–24); the claimed €3bn+ into French public finances via PSG, 2,300+ jobs, €25bn+ total Qatari investment since 2011; **February 2025: Qatar "cooling" investments and threatening withdrawal** after Nasser Al-Khelaïfi's mise en examen in the Lagardère affair (complicity in vote-buying/abuse of power — a case originating from the Lagardère takeover fight where LVMH-Arnault prevailed). Mubadala (~$330bn): Chanel, Institut Mérieux. The Saudi chapter: MBS's August 24, 2026 Paris visit with ~$10bn of contracts (health, transport, energy) and the first Conseil de partenariat stratégique franco-saoudien, against bilateral trade of €8.3bn (ambassador Maisonnave) to $12bn (the Gulf count), the Mecca defense pact of August 7 (Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan) as the diversification signal, the Khashoggi-rehabilitation frame, the Le Monde record that French arms exports ran €21.2bn in 2025 at summits with the Saudi pipeline cited at the €100bn-class ambition; Jean-Yves Le Drian's double-hatting preserved (émissaire présidentiel pour le Liban seated at the

Al-Ula archaeology table).

The Haftar/Libya file. The Sentry's November 13, 2025 "Inside Job" report documents the Haftar coalition's multibillion-dollar fuel heist — diverted subsidized diesel to Russian forces at Libyan bases and to Sudan's RSF even after al-Fasher's fall. The state side: the SWP Berlin record (A-grade) — DGSE covert teams supporting Haftar in Benghazi from end-2015/early 2016, exactly as the international community committed to the unity government, exposed only when three DGSE officers died in a July 2016 helicopter shootdown south of Benghazi; partially withdrawn without publicity; then aerial surveillance for Haftar's Derna and Oil Crescent offensives; New America's UN-source account — "dozens of French DGSE officers accompanied LAAF forces on frontline missions and acted as forward spotters for mortars and artillery," the operation "run from the presidency and through the DGSE," with the internal Hollande-era war preserved (DGSE plus Le Drian's Defense Ministry against the reluctant Quai d'Orsay); the Derna battle entry confirming 35–60 DGSE Action Division operators on the ground 2018–19; the Javelin embarrassment of June 26, 2019 (four US-made Javelins traced to a 2010 French Army sale to Egypt found at the captured Gharyan HQ, Paris claiming them "hors d'usage" while Disclose documented Egyptian Rafales flying for Haftar). Wagner's side: Putin's January 11, 2020 admission; 14 Russian jets at Al Khadim/Al Jufra (AFRICOM, May 2020); Pantsir batteries; the Kornet precision strikes. The corporate side: the October 13, 2022 Reuters headline — two NGOs filed a PNAT complaint against

TotalEnergies for complicity in war crimes, in Ukraine (the Russian-operations kerosene file, distinct from Mozambique); plus the Mozambique complaint's mechanics (3.8).

Palestine. The arc, dated: July 21, 2025 joint declaration → July 28–30 UN conference co-chaired with Saudi Arabia → September 12 New York Declaration (142 states) → **September 22, 2025 French recognition with ten co-recognizers** (Netanyahu's antisemitism accusation; Braun-Pivet's "sans réserves") → ceasefire October 2025 → hostages January 2026 → phase 2 under UNSC 2803 and the CNAG (January 15, 2026) → the E1 settlement-tender response delayed to July 6, 2026 → June 30, 2026 business guidance → the five-NGO Conseil d'État suit pending since July 22, 2026.

Iran — two conflicts in one file. The Twelve-Day War (June 13–24, 2025): Macron pro-Israel on June 13, condemning the "illegal US strikes" on June 23; the Bourget ban on five Israeli firms; the Evin prison strike (71 dead near the jailed French couple Kohler/Paris). Then the March 2026 war: Macron's March 3, 2026 national address — the Charles de Gaulle carrier to the Mediterranean, Rafales and a frigate to Cyprus, drone interceptions, 400,000 French citizens in the region, evacuation flights, the first nuclear-arsenal increase in decades, criticism of US/Israeli lawlessness, the Lebanon-invasion warning — with the Club des Juristes analyzing France's Qatar/Kuwait/UAE defense pacts and "strictly defensive" posture, and euronews' note that Iran is rebuilding toward 2,000-missile salvos; the market channel (2.2 and 4.9): Brent above $110, the June 14 US–Iran protocol at

Versailles (the $300bn package under the Évian G7), stabilization near $73 assumed for December.

Lebanon. The March 2026 strikes (217 killed); France's ramped army aid (March 5, 2026); the September 17, 2026 Paris summit (Macron–Aoun–Abdullah II) on the post-UNIFIL architecture — the 7,500-personnel drawdown from January 2027, France/Italy non-UN or EU mission concepts, a donor conference late 2026/early 2027 — against the Israeli strike killing 13 including six children on the eve.

The UN succession. The Guterres replacement race — Kristalina Georgieva leading through six straw polls, the unprecedented P5 veto spread — makes France's permanent-seat diplomacy the quiet arena; Macron's own name circulates in succession speculation (never confirmed; logged as speculation with its source class). The September 2026 General Assembly backdrop: France's demand for RDF withdrawal; the September 17 Lebanon summit's timing against the UN week.

6.3 The 2027 presidential election

The calendar and mechanics. Council of Ministers, July 1, 2026: first round Sunday **April 18, 2027**, runoff Sunday **May 2** — the later option chosen over April 11/25, Macron's personal final call; overseas territories vote the prior Saturday. Candidate list closes March 26, 2027. The sponsorship gate: 500 *parrainages* from at least 30 departments, no more than 50 per department. Spending caps: €18.9M first round / €22.5M runoff. The Constitutional Council proclaims results; the outgoing president's term ends May 13, 2027. The campaign's first fully-digital, AI-assisted verification cycle (CNCCFP platform, September 8, 2025 guide).

The declared field (roughly thirty), with the state of play for each:

- **Marine Le Pen** — candidacy conditional on the cassation (3.2). Polling: 35–37% first round (Ifop July; CNews/OpinionWay; Elabe). Ifop July: wins all runoffs — 49/51 versus Philippe, 45% Attal, landslide versus Mélenchon. Elabe August: 69.5% versus Mélenchon, 57% versus Glucksmann, 57% versus Attal, 52.5% versus Philippe. Polymarket: 48.3% (Le Pen) / Philippe 19.5% / Lisnard 11.8% / Mélenchon 9.5%; Manifold: Le Pen 46%; a first-round-decided election priced at 2%.
- **Jordan Bardella** — the RN's Plan B and, since July 2026, its alternative pole (Odoxa September: Bardella 40% favorable, the highest of any politician, above Le Pen's 39%; ahead of her in round one and winning every runoff; the December

28, 2025 German synthesis logged). Biographical frame: Drancy-born, Italian roots, MEP at 23 (2019), party president since November 2022 — the Fifth Republic's youngest presidential candidate would be 31.

- **Édouard Philippe** — declared; the Attal pact's senior partner (below); 15.5–19.5% across pollsters. His other file: the **Cité Numérique probe** (whistleblower alert September 2023; police raids April 2024; civil-party complaint June 2025; judge appointed May 7, 2026; two investigating judges by June 18, 2026; the July 17, 2026 administrative-court ruling strengthening whistleblower status; the €2.1M contract with a sole-bidder association chaired by his own digital-affairs deputy) — plus his November 2025 "départ ordonné" call for an early presidential election.
- **Gabriel Attal** — Renaissance's internal machine behind him (the May 12, 2026 Conseil national vote at 91% — 221 of 303 — calling him to declare; Borne's May 6 resignation over his line), the October 1 deadline passed, "officiellement candidat depuis ce week-end" per TF1 Info. **The Attal–Philippe pact, in its final corrected form:** officialized on franceinfo March 20, 2026. It is not a loser-drops-by-Christmas deal but a conditional safeguard: both men commit that the less-well-placed withdraws if polling projects an LFI–RN runoff. The mechanism runs through a liaison committee and a mutual non-aggression pact, with Renaissance's secretary-general framing the sequence as "différents candidats... avant un rassemblement

fin 2026 ou début 2027" — separate candidacies first, a rallying before the vote. Polling stakes preserved: Attal losing to Le Pen/Bardella 49–51; a Mélenchon runoff collapsing to 28.5% against the RN's 71.5% with more than a third of centrists abstaining.

- **Raphaël Glucksmann** — the left primary won outright October 11, 2026: **66.17%** (79,613 votes of 120,787 voters; 89.8% turnout) against Faure's 14.46%, Royal's 7.62%, Maurel's 5.92%, Guedj's 5.83% — from an electorate of 140,282 registered (the €15 entry fee; the Mennucci committee's dedup), after a cyberattack of fake connections saturated the site and forced a 24-hour extension. His lines preserved: "Ce soir, la bataille de France commence"; "La ligne est tranchée… Il n'y aura pas d'accord avec LFI"; "Rien ne me fera lâcher." The post-primary surge: +4–5 to 15–16.5% (the vice-president Jeanbart's line: "il y a vraiment un effet boost… le mouvement lycéen affaiblit les deux candidats du bloc central"); Hollande hovering with a decision promised for December, hoping to become "une voie de recours."
- **Jean-Luc Mélenchon** — running separately; 15–16% polling; his LFI's European-assistants file closed with no indictment (May 27, 2026) and the 2019 Bobigny conviction the only residue.
- **Bruno Retailleau** — LR's April 19 direct coronation; Wauquiez out; the six-point plunge to 20% favorability (Odoxa September) after his Sunday-evening resignation from Lecornu I and his interior-ministry record.

- **Éric Zemmour** — confirmed September 17, 2026 on BFMTV ("Je suis candidat à la présidence de la République, je serai candidat à l'élection présidentielle"); the formal declaration due October — "au cours de cet automne, probablement dès octobre." Program bundle: remigration resting on a false 1945-ordonnance citation ("une approximation historique et juridique" per Le Monde's Décodéurs — the ordonnance of November 2, 1945 targeted financial-credibility attacks, not welfare receipt); the one-year unemployment trigger; foreign prisoners as "25% of prisons"; "robots à la place des immigrés" for Ehpad (nursing homes) and construction; Bukele-modeled prison expansion; capitalisation pensions at 64–65; bans on kippa and voile in public space; "on ne peut pas être Français avec un prénom musulman"; Le Pen dismissed as "une femme de gauche"; Knafo as running mate with *Le Casse du siècle* as the campaign's fiscal bible (her 10.4% Paris first-round result in March). Polling: ~2–4% against his 7.07% of 2022 (fourth place); 68 years old.
- **Marine Tondelier** (Ecologists), **Fabien Roussel** (Communists), **David Lisnard** (independent, out of LR; 11.8% on Polymarket), **Xavier Bertrand** (independent, the Parti radical's Dijon manifeste attended with Attal and Philippe), plus the thirty-name periphery.
- The Manifold snapshot: Mélenchon candidacy priced at 94%.

The Fondapol anatomy (July 2026, 2,444-voter panel) — the electorate beneath the numbers. The headline math:

17.9% (2012) → 33.2% (2024); Bardella at 34–37% for 2027 against Philippe's 18% and Glucksmann's 14%. The four-population decomposition: *fidèles* (9.2% of the sample but 28% of the RN's electorate); *épisodiques* (13%/40%); *ralliés* (10.5%/32%); *hostiles* (67.3%). **The ralliés profile as the election's hinge:** 56% aged 65+; 57% higher-educated; 89% feeling declining living standards; 55% self-placing "droite classique" and only 16% far-right; 40% ex-Fillon; still 31% close to LR; a bare 31% close to the RN itself; only 72% convinced it "would do better" (26% without a firm view) — the soft, reversible tide the whole campaign must fight over; Fondapol's verdict: the RN a "véritable parti dominant de la Ve République" in the making. The municipal ledger: 74 communes won, 3,121 councillors, yet 24.1% average where the RN presents lists against 33% nationally — the localism gap. The ambient register: 80% inquiétude, 68% colère, 67% confusion, 21% espoir (February 2025 baromètre).

LR's financial crater (the Pécresse precedent). Valérie Pécresse's 2022 campaign: €14.3M spent for 4.78% in one round, no reimbursement, €5.1M of personal debt closed by €3.3M in public donations plus €1.2M from the party; Sarkozy's €2,000 donation famously refused; Bayou's BRDE complaint (September 2022) classée sans suite January 31, 2024. The party's books: €17.5M debt in 2020 even after selling the HQ for €46M; €12.3M debt in 2024 with a negative net position of €3.6M on an €8.6M balance sheet; the public subsidy cut to €7.5M/yr against €10M running costs; treasurer Pierre Danon (ex-Numericable, formed in Drahi's cost-cutting school)

squeezing €400k/yr from provider contracts; **the 2027 bind explicit: LR "may not have the means to fund a dignified campaign,"** facing an autumn bank loan with no collateral and banks "ultra-frileuses" after the Pécresse precedent. The election baseline beneath: 2017 (66.10/33.90; 20.7M votes); 2022 (58.54/41.46 — Macron down 2M to 18.7M; Le Pen up 2.6M; the 5.5M-vote margin; the 28.01% abstention; 2.2M blank ballots; the geography: Le Pen topping 18,000+ communes, 23 metropolitan departments, Martinique 60%, Guadeloupe 69.6%; the first round: Macron 27.85, Le Pen 23.15, Mélenchon 21.95, Zemmour 7.07, Pécresse 5.0 — LR's worst-ever presidential showing — Hidalgo 2.0); the Montaigne transfer analysis (LFI voters 42% Macron, 24% abstention, 17% blank — the front républicain's measured erosion).

The interference perimeter. VIGINUM attributes the Matryoshka/Storm-1516 operation to a Russian nexus targeting Attal, Philippe and Glucksmann (the embassy denies); the Iranian disinformation recycling fake images of the lycée movement drew an official summons. Barrot's doctrine (August 7 and October 13, 2026 statements) names foreign interference as a campaign threat with a platform-regulation push; Mélenchon counters "open bar."

6.4 Social legislation, 2024–2026

End of life. The nine-year arc, complete: CCNE avis n°139 (September 13, 2022) → the Convention citoyenne → the government's bill (April 10, 2024) killed by the dissolution → the Falorni PPL n°1100 (March 11, 2025) → Assembly 305–199 (May 27, 2025) with the palliative-care twin unanimous → Senate rejection (January 28, 2026; 184–122) → Assembly second reading (February 25) → Senate rejection (May 12, with the "assistance médicale à mourir" substitution) → CMP failure (June 2) → Assembly (June 30; 295–232) → Senate question préalable (July 1) → the government's last word exercised → **definitive Assembly adoption July 15, 2026 (291–241; 29 abstentions)** → CC decision 2026-910 DC (August 14, with a réserve) → promulgation August 18, 2026 (Loi n°2026-794). The substantive frame: five cumulative conditions including the "psychological suffering alone excluded" bar; auto-administration as the rule with the doctor/nurse exception; no tele-confirmation; the two-day reflection window; the obstruction offence aligned at two years/€30,000; the "mort naturelle" phrase struck May 23, 2025. Implementation pending. The moral arithmetic: 158 French deaths abroad in 2025 (110 in Belgium, double 2022); 92% public support; 74% of doctors (Ifop). The floor it built on: Leonetti 2005, Claeys-Leonetti 2016.

The under-15 social-media ban. Miller's bill → Assembly January 2026 → final July 21, 2026 → effective September 2026; the Conseil d'État's negative opinion and the DSA/TRIS friction

preserved.

Laïcité and the schools. The abaya circular (Attal's August 31, 2023 note de service) and the Conseil d'État's conformity ruling with the incident ledger — 4,710 signalements 2022–23, of which 1,984 attire-related versus 617 two years earlier; the social-media "contournement" argument; the Mayotte/Réunion exceptions. The 2026 campaign fault line: LFI's Panot/Obono abolition pledge versus Attal's 2004-law defense; the RN's hard line; Tondelier's consultative middle. **Abortion:** constitutionalized March 4, 2024 at Versailles — 780–72, the 25th amendment, the "guaranteed freedom" LR-sourced wording, world-first, >80% IFOP support, the March 8 sealing. **Surveillance (RIPOST).** Deposited March 25, 2026 → Assembly July 15 (366–182) → promulgated August 18, 2026 (Loi 2026-798) → the Constitutional Council's decision 2026-915 DC: the AFD-on-Bulletin-2 provision censured, five riders struck, six interpretive reserves; the presumption-of-self-defense debate; La Quadrature's surveillance inventory (the Olympics' algorithmic CCTV, LAPI plates, municipal police expansion, social-fraud data harvesting). The Senate's PLF 2026 immigration rapport (November 24, 2025) and the bénéficiaires-effectifs register's quiet revolution in the May 26, 2026 simplification law (imprisonment removed; fines quintupled to €200k/€1M) — depenalization-by-fine as the session's motif.

6.5 Immigration and asylum

The operative statute remains the **January 26, 2024 law** (adopted 349–186 under Borne; partially censured by the Constitutional Council), operationalized by the July 15, 2025 decree (language training optional rather than prescribed, max 600 hours; the nationality language requirement to B2 plus a civic exam effective January 1, 2026) and the October 10, 2025 arrêté (the 45-minute/40-question civic QCM, 80% pass for naturalization). 930,000 pending files. The December 19, 2023 precursor law (349–186; CC-partially-censured) and the tension-jobs régularisation expiring end-2026 sit in the same frame.

Darmanin's 2026 offensive, dated: January 25, 2026 (LCI): "suspension of family reunification and work immigration for 2–3 years," with doctor/researcher exceptions, quotas later set by referendum, the wage-hike counterparty in BTP/restaurants/agriculture, and the "7–8% unemployment, five points more for foreigners" argument → the JDD May 23 interview escalating to "il faut mettre fin à l'immigration telle qu'elle est aujourd'hui," visa-OQTF conditionality (tying visas to deportation orders), constitutional reform for limitative quotas, referendum "not excluded" — in direct defiance of Lecornu's ministerial-reserve rule. The polling: CNEWS-CSA May 28 — 63% support overall, 69% among 18–24, 86% among RN/Reconquête voters, the left 64% opposed. The fact-checks preserved: RN's Odoul — "worst interior minister, ~1.5M first permits in four years, 25,000/month, a record" (Franceinfo's

check); Insee's June 4, 2026 reality check — 313,000 arrivals 2024, -10%/-16%, back to 2019 levels; Ukrainian refugees 46,200→5,800. The EU-pact transposition bill (habilitation to ordonnances for regs 2024/1346–1358): deposited April 8, 2026; adopted with modifications by the Senate May 20, 2026; awaiting the Assemblée — 24-month retention ceilings, European return orders, return hubs (the Club des Juristes' constitutional/EU-law collision analysis). Asylum: France the EU's #1 destination — 146,060 applications (12.7% share); 70,284 positive decisions in 2024 (+15.4%); OQTF returns at record levels (81,656 in 2016 → 134,280 in 2022 → +15% in 2026). The Senate budget mission's verdict: "mission en hausse."

6.6 The social emergency

Housing. 350,000 homeless; 4M badly housed; 735 street deaths (Fondation Abbé Pierre); allocations down from 500k to 393k/yr; the 2.9M social-housing waiting list against 400,000 annual relettings and 1-in-7 fulfillment (4.9); 500k+ G-rated homes unrentable since January 2025; the Pinel sunset; student ratio 2.7/unit; Macron's proportional-representation proposal traced 2017→2024, never enacted. The vacancy and mobility rates both falling (2.9%→2.1%; 9.3%→7.1%, 2019–2025).
Medical deserts. Three definitions logged with pedigrees: 6.3M in APL<2.5 zones per DREES 2024; 8M per the Atlas; 30% of population per INSEE 2026. 151 zones rouges covering 87% of territory. The GP workforce: ~100,000 GPs, 146/100k, one-third over 60, 2,500 lost by November 2024, the 92,500

critical floor projected 2028, 2.3 replacements per retiree, the same doctor count as 1970 for +15M people; total physicians 245,847 (January 2026, +14% since 2010) but the GP share falling 48%→42% and 87 departments losing GP density. Waits: 88 days ophthalmology; 55 dermatology. The Padhue 10k+ (38.6% Algerian-trained; Aisne 29.6%); Macron's April 2026 titularization push; Bayrou's Cantal Pacte (€200/day volunteers, fourth-year interns from November 2026, 3,700 docteurs juniors, the 50M-consultations target); the Garot/Favennec installation-regulation PPL grinding through Parliament against a doctors' strike and Neuder's veto; Île-de-France's exclusion scandal. **Hospitals:** €3.4bn deficit, €40bn of savings demanded, the AP-HP's August 2025 strike mobilization, the Cnam's 500-GP sick-leave crackdown; the FHF January 2026 barometer: 40% can't easily get care. **Health totals (DREES comptes de la santé):** €333bn current health spending (11.4% of GDP, +3.6% — among the EU's weakest growth); management costs +4.9% with complementary insurers' governance ratio at 21% against the Sécurité sociale's 2.8%; the CSBM €255bn (hospitals €120.7bn: public €93.6bn at +2.6–2.9%, still 3.5% below 2019 activity, psychiatry sliding since 2016; private €27.1bn at +4.0%; ambulatory €77.8bn: imaging +7.8%, biology prices -8.1% under the price-volume protocol; medical goods €56.2bn: drugs €34.5bn, volumes +7.3%, prices -1.1%); prevention €7.5bn post-COVID (-50.4% from the 2021 peak; 2.3% of health spending versus the OECD's 3.4%); the reste-à-charge €292 per inhabitant — third-lowest in the EU — against the Senate's

r24-901 finding that the AMO/AMC co-financing duplication costs ~€7bn/yr more than comparable systems. **100% santé, the 2026 status:** panier usage 34% (-12 points); dental RAC0 at 45%; audio class-1 at 38%; €220 average savings per panier-A glasses; the cost ledger — mutuelles' management spending €2.2bn in 2021 (+30%), their €1.5bn exceptional contribution, cotisations €46.5bn (+8.2%) — with IFRAP's €16.9bn AMO+AMC management-cost figure for 2024 preserved. (the 2023 governance table: SS €239.6bn at 2.8% governance; complements €39.3bn at 21%; households €29.9bn). The department social-aid ledger: €47.8bn gross 2024 (RSA €11.5bn, +1.3%; the state having absorbed RSA financing for Guyane 2019, Réunion 2020, Seine-Saint-Denis and Pyrénées-Orientales 2022, Ariège 2023). The AAH at €1,042.62 from April 2026 (+0.9%; 1.2M beneficiaries; déconjugalisation since October 2023).

Prisons. February 1, 2026: 86,000 inmates versus ~63,000 capacity = 136.9%; April 1: **88,145 — the record; 139.1% occupancy**; remand 171.1%; floor mattresses 6,596 → 7,540 (+60% y/y); 30 of 190 facilities above 200%; ~200 new inmates/week; 90,000 by September projected. April 27: the UFAP-UNSA strike locking 14 of 17 Hauts-de-France facilities over 5,000 vacant guard posts. Council of Europe SPACE I: France 131/100 — third-worst in Europe behind Slovenia and Cyprus; the CPT's "human warehouses" verdict, rat and bug infestations; the first-ever UN torture-watchdog visit (May 2026); Darmanin's 3,000 modular beds in 18 months with an explicit refusal of population caps. Overseas extremes:

Majicavo (Mayotte) 650/278; Camp Est (Nouméa) 610/410.
Deaths in custody: the 2020–22 EU compilation (13 reporting countries, 488+ deaths; France the highest absolute at 107, sixth per-capita at 0.16/100k — behind Ireland's extraordinary 1.34/100k, with the explicit warning that national definitions and under-counting make comparisons hazardous); the prison-suicide ledger (roughly 120 self-inflicted deaths in 2000 against 60 in 1987; Dr Vasseur's contested La Santé count of 97 night-time attempts against the administration's five; the OIP's 2,500–3,500 total since 1981 — the oldest unhealed wound in the dossier).
Ehpad (eldercare). 7,500 establishments, 600,000 places, average €2,100/month (+3.5% in 2026); the staffing ledger — 437,435 ETP total (2019 Senate baseline), the ratio frozen at 3.7 soignants per 10 residents / 29 ETP per 100 places 2019–2023, no mandatory minimum ratio; the Plan Grand Âge's 50,000 recruits to 2030 with the LFSS 2026 tranche (€250M/4,500 posts) following 6,000 (2024) and 6,500 (2025). DREES January 2026: 30,000 vacant aide-soignant posts (half in Ehpad); 50% of establishments ≥10% understaffed; 4.2-month fill times versus 2.1 in 2019; ~15% "faisant fonction" without diplomas; 15–20% annual turnover. Finances: 77% of public Ehpad in deficit (end-2022); multi-billion-euro debt. Council of Europe Commissioner O'Flaherty's letter (August 28 → September 8, 2026) tying understaffing to fundamental-rights violations; 60% of buildings over 30 years; ~10% air-conditioned rooms through the June heatwave; the inspection-campaign math (7,122 controls = 96%,

contradicting the minister's "100% controlled" claim); the "Maisons France Autonomie" renaming under way with the Senate's Hochart jab about renaming the deficit as surplus. Pay: Ségur raises €183/month for ~500,000; AS pay ~€1,850–2,200 net; +€180 gross March 2026; €4bn total; 42% of care workers reporting health problems (April 2026 survey).

The heatwave ledger. Santé publique France's official count: **5,764 excess deaths (June 17–July 2, +36%, worst since 2003's ~15,000)** — with the provisional ~1,000/2,700 figures and the viral "20,000" claim both documented and discarded (the EU-wide conflation identified); Île-de-France: +1,565 deaths, +80%, half the national toll in three days (June 25–27). The hottest June on record for western Europe; four heatwaves since May; 2,700 official excess deaths revised upward; water restrictions in 99 of 101 departments; the Loire and Rhine at record lows; reactor power-downs; the wildfire season — 17 civilians, 6 firefighters and 2 helicopter crew dead by early August; the Bordeaux fronts with 55,000 evacuated and 2 firefighter deaths; Fontainebleau's UNESCO forest ~1/10 burned; the Tour de France stage cut; 300+ heat records broken in one May day.

Education's true ledger. The OECD 2026 frame: 0.4% shortage officially; 7.1% non-qualified below the OECD's 9.1% — against the SNPDEN-UNSA May 2026 survey: 41% of schools with unreplaced absentees; 58% missing 2–5 teachers; 76% of principals personally covering. 4,000 posts cut in 2026 plus 1,588 proposed for 2027; 3,200 missing at the 2024 rentrée (Haut-Commissariat); the major teacher strike of late

March 2026. Bac 2026: 91.4% pass, the new 8/20 bonus-points rule, 744,600 candidates. Higher education (the Senate rapporteurs' own numbers): Mires €31.5bn (+566M); the ministry €27bn (+176M); programme 150 at €15.628bn (+1.7%). The SCSP paradox: €14.45bn in 2025, +23% since 2014, yet its weight in university revenues falling 81%→69% as extra-budgetary France 2030 money displaces core funding. The massification math: 2.97M students versus 2.58M in 2015 (+15%) while expenses grew +29% against revenues +23% and personnel eats 77%. The broken programming law: 87.1M delivered against 107M promised (-55M cumulative; 440 doctoral contracts threatened). The COMP contracts at ~€110M per wave, mostly funded by redeployments with a 900-indicator tracking system run by email. The CAS Pensions 4-point rise costing ~€200M with barely €81M compensated. Energy surcoûts +18%/+€127M. The rapporteurs' own language: "budget d'attente," "la parole de l'État n'est pas tenue," research frozen at 2.2% of GDP against the 3% target dating to 2000; the apprenticeship boom (665k versus 327k in 2020) quietly cannibalizing bourse eligibility; the Cnous line at €163M (+€15M). **Bourses frozen for 2026–27 — the movement's exact grievance** — with the second reform phase postponed again. Geffray's profile: énarque, 47, Conseil d'État/Cnil → Bayrou's 2017 justice cabinet → DGRH → Dgesco 2019–24, architect of the bac/lycée reforms and the pHARe-era harassment response; seventh education minister since 2022; "extrêmement inquiétante" (October 22, 2025); the one-hour weekly AI class in seconde from rentrée 2027 (announced June

19, 2026). The Grenelle question, closed: no new Grenelle — the format remains the 2019 violences conjugales precedent (46 measures/76% delivered); the government's lycée response pointedly avoids it.

Marseille's war. The European Parliament's resolution P10_TA(2026)0007 on the murder of Mehdi Kessaci: his father Amine elevated to a Saviano-tier voice; the EP demanding victim relocation and a civil-society mobilization on the Italian anti-mafia model. The structural ledger beneath: northern districts at 40% below the poverty line; 30% excess mortality before 65; a drug-murder rate per capita comparable to New York's in a city a tenth its size. The Marseille *en grand* audit (December 16, 2025 Macron visit): €5bn since 2021; health advances; education and housing lags; 26% poverty; the rue d'Aubagne shadow. Rudy Manna's October 18 cry: "on a été seuls, on a vécu l'enfer." The Amra capture (February 22, 2025, Romania) after the Incarville toll commando attack of May 14, 2024 that killed officers Garcia, 34, and Moello, 52.

Action Logement (the 1% logement system). Born as Albert Prouvost's Lainière de Roubaix scheme (1943); compulsory 1953 via 220 comités interprofessionnels and CCIs. The State's two raids: 1991's halving (0.5% diverted to the FNAL to finance the APL; 0.05% returned; PEEC down to 0.45%) and **€5.1bn skimmed between 1995 and 2002** to finance the prêt à taux zéro among other priorities — the raid that "put the system in danger" and produced its four acquis (the UESL by the December 18, 1996 law; the 1998 quinquennial convention renouncing further prélèvements; universal droits ouverts;

paritarian governance). The 2020 war, in the Senate's own words ("campagne de déstabilisation"): the ELAN application blocked; the DG nomination blocked; the secret IGF report leaked; the €1.3bn PLF 2021 prélèvement inscribed; the social partners summoned under the ordonnance threat — "une véritable stratégie de pression maximale et de passage en force clairement assumée." The 2021 settlement: €1bn to the FNAL plus the renouvellement-urbain and Action-Cœur-de-Ville participations; a -€300M revenue hit from the uncompensated PEEC exemption for 20–50-employee firms. The cash controversy resolved by the Senate's defense: the €8.9bn year-end 2019 trésorerie "artificiellement globalisée" and already committed; ALI's true net position 1.1 months of rent (€453M) against the ESH federation's 3.5-month standard (€1.4bn) — yet the group still lost €1.37bn in 2021 under the investment-plan drain, promising balance "from 2023." Visale's ramp: 230,000 beneficiaries (2021) → 330,000 (2022) → 500,000 (target). The 2026 question the file leaves open: the system's €8bn-scale reserves and the housing emergency, side by side.

6.7 Infrastructure and mobility

Grand Paris Express (the Sénat r20-044 report). The promise-drift table: €16bn in 2012 → €36–38.5bn in 2020 including €3.4bn of non-GPE charges (Karoutchi's "15% of sites open and already doubled"); the 2018 rephasing finding €4.6bn of savings by pushing them "au quinquennat suivant"; the €2.56bn optimization ledger itemized to the euro (530M tracés, 320M gares, 310M tunneliers, 240M correspondances, 160M déblais, 200M génie civil, 200M foncier, 100M chantier, 100M O&M, 100M connexes, 300M autres). The execution machine: SGP spending past €2bn/yr in 2019 (€1.03bn on line 15-sud alone) heading to €4bn/yr; the financing architecture — state-guaranteed debt, the EIB €2.5bn facility of which €1bn drawn at 40 years/1.7%, a CDC €1bn contract never drawn (bank intermediation adding nothing to an ODAL requalified in 2016), €9.8bn of market issuance October 2018–June 2020 at a 1.06% average — 97% green bonds. The tax base: €676–682M/yr (TSB €466–500M of which 60% to SGP; TSE €117M; IFER €75M paid by RATP; parking €4M; 15% of the taxe de séjour). The debt-horizon math (Carrez mission, July 2018): €51bn spend 2010–2030; €5.6bn interest; €35bn debt at 2030; extinction horizon 2070 — forty years after the last line opens. The Pécresse blockades: the exploitation redevance capped at 0.8% of investment (€336M/yr; "tout sauf évident," no transport authority carries such a charge; its abandonment would "remettre en cause" the whole model); the €1.5bn adaptation of existing networks with only €450M funded.

Dallier's paradox, verbatim: a project "d'intérêt national" bringing the State €4bn/yr in tax receipts, +€10–20bn/yr of PIB, €10bn/yr of congestion relief, "financé uniquement par une fiscalité francilienne… l'État ne met pas un centime en attendant." The 2023 operating protocol (€474M set aside for lines opening to 2031); the September 2, 2026 EIB renewal — €3bn for the western section of line 15, taking EIB support to the top of the facility.

Rail. Trenitalia ended the monopoly on Paris–Marseille (June 2025): 1.8M riders in 2025, €90M revenue, still loss-making; the Maurienne landslide cost 500k clients. Paris–Lyon fares -43%. The TGV M two years late to July 1, 2026 on Alstom's production shortfall (4 of 115 trains). The Senate opening SNCF Connect to rivals from December 31, 2027 — a European first; SNCF's Italian reciprocity win (18 slots for ten years, March 6, 2026 — becoming Italy's second competitor after MSC-backed Italo).

Airports: the trilogy, the control case and the RIP (4.5); the Tehran Imam Khomeiny terminal build-operate contract won by ADP and Bouygues in 2016 — one of the last Franco-Iranian deals of that era; the Nantes-Atlantique 2021 remise en jeu (Vinci versus Eiffage); Eiffage's Lille-Lesquin entry (July 2019, 20 years); Le Monde's January 2020 framing of the provincial airports as "machines à cash"; the Panot speech of January 13, 2022 preserved verbatim for the writing phase (FDJ "adjudée, vendue," Alstom-GE, the three airports, Macron as "commissaire-priseur," Vinci the "sangsue de l'argent," the McKinsey vaccination bill of €25M).

The autoroutes money machine (with the concessions' full ledger). The 2006 sale: 9,300km for €14.8bn under Villepin (Le Maire cabinet director then; "nous nous sommes trompés" in 2020). The target 7.67% shareholder IRR against the IGF/CGEDD February 2021 confidential report's 11.77% (Vinci/ASF-Escota) and 12.49% (Eiffage/APRR-AREA); Sanef at 7.7%. The remediation the report demanded: toll cuts of 58–59% (~€21 on Marseille-Toulouse or Paris-Lyon). The leak chain: the Canard January 2023; published online March 21, 2023; "étouffé" accusations against Le Maire. The Senate's 2020 commission: terminal IRRs 10.93%/11.25%/7.21%; rentability achieved by 2022 (16 years early); **surprofits €30–38bn by 2036** (20 Vinci, 12 Eiffage, +6 Cofiroute); €40bn of dividends 2022–2036; €7.8bn of manque à gagner for the state; the 2015 protocol "très favorable" negotiated with Royal's and Macron's cabinets (per Delahaye), budget minister Eckert kept out of the room. The 2025–26 P&L: Vinci €75.6bn revenue/€4.9bn net with Autoroutes at 71% EBITDA margin and ~35–40% of group gross profit, €2.8bn dividends; Eiffage €25.3bn/€1bn with concessions at 43% operating margin (APRR-AREA EBITDA 70.4%; Millau 87.1% — €60M on €69M revenue at €13.80 a crossing; A41 86.4%); the TEITLD tax at 4.6% (€123M for Eiffage in 2024; the PS pushing 10%). Tolls +84% since 2006 against +33% inflation; cumulative profits ~€63bn 2006–2024 (4.3x); >€50bn of dividends; concessions running to 2031–2036. The counter-narratives preserved (Vinci's Coppey "plutôt inférieur à ce qui était prévu"; APRR's Nourry contesting the methodology; the ART's figures).

6.8 The state-cyber and terrorism perimeter

Terrorism (Europol TE-SAT 2026). France's profile: 84 terrorism-related suspects — 64 jihadist arrests, #2 EU-wide; 14 attacks with 3 completed across the EU, France accounting for 2 completed plus 8 foiled jihadist plots; the FLNC's October 2023 arson network arrests (May 2025); the US State Department's Level 2 advisory standing. The CAT frame preserved: contraband tobacco exceeds 20% of terrorist organizations' criminal funding.

The cyber perimeter. The Naval Group breach (1TB, July 2025); APT28 attributed for attacks on twelve French organizations (April 2025); the Turla case — Defence Ministry (2017), Moscow embassy (2018), industrial secrets (2025) — producing the September 2026 ambassador's summons to the foreign ministry; La Poste's NoName DDoS (January 2026); Sandworm's DynoWiper in Poland (December 2025) as regional context; and the European Court of Auditors' September 22, 2026 finding that **€1.4bn of Digital Europe shield spending was never verified for hostile-state ownership of beneficiaries**, the ATHENA/ENSOC early-warning hubs still not operational, the Cyber Solidarity Act network unfinished — against France's own €1bn national cyber plan (February 18, 2021) and the ANSSI-guarded 750-company shield. The breach constellation alongside: Viamedis/Almerys (33M insureds' data); the Free/Free Mobile sanctions totaling €42M (January 13, 2026); the CNIL's 6,167 breach notifications in 2025; the Google €325M and Shein €150M sanctions; the finding that

France is the EU's most-breached large jurisdiction.

The France Travail breach (corrected record). February 6–March 5, 2024, disclosed March 13, 2024: attackers used stolen Cap Emploi credentials; 43 million records maximum exposure, 36.8M deduplicated; three arrests; the CNIL fined the operator €5M on January 22, 2026 — the flagship of the breach constellation above. (The anomaly register's item 8 records the date correction from the research record's first pass.)

The intelligence budget. DGSE under Nicolas Lerner (Émié's exit confirmed; the ex-DGSI chief publicly acknowledging "active operations against Wagner networks in Africa"): **€3.2bn for 2026 after doubling in five years**, +3,200 agents recruited 2024–26 under the intelligence-programming law, ~7,500 staff at "la Piscine" (141 boulevard Mortier), oversight limited to partial DPR briefings; DGSI under Céline Berthon (the February 17, 2026 official annuaire); the community roster DGSI/DPSD/DRM/DGSE/DNRED/Tracfin.

The security forces' numbers (Cour des comptes 2026). 2024: 151,400 police + 100,900 gendarmes = 252,300 state agents (+4.4% versus 2016); €24.4bn budget (+33% since 2016; +€15bn programmed under LOPMI); the jobs ladder 2023–2027 with the 2025 freeze and 2026 recovery (police +1,000 — 700 investigation/300 border; gendarmerie +400); the 239-brigades plan stuttering (80 opened 2024, zero of the planned 57 in 2025, 58 in 2026, ~100 still owed in 2027); reserves targets 50k/30k; the gendarmerie still below 2008 levels; 58 helicopters with 26 needing €350M renewal; the G7

Évian June 2026 in preparation (ten million barrels released: 2.4). The IGPN 2025 annual report (September 23, 2026): 12 fatal shootings (16 in 2024; zero *refus d'obtempérer* for the second consecutive year); 86 serious injuries (+19%); use-of-force probes down 40% over five years to 322 (868 at the 2019 Gilets jaunes peak); record ~5,300 Taser deployments; 1,007 judicial investigations — and the headline: **341 integrity cases versus 234 in 2024, the highest since 2020** (136 unlawful-file accesses — TAJ/SIV/FPR; 117 secrecy violations; 88 straight corruption), with "affective" motives noted alongside lucrative ones; IGPN chief Stéphane Hardouin.

The justice system's state. The judicial summit's joint denunciation of attacks on judges (Soulard premier président, Heitz procureur général; January 9 and June 24, 2026) under a year Le Figaro framed "sous le signe des grands procès politico-financiers" — Macron's absence at the January rentrée solennelle, honoring the Crans-Montana fire dead, leaving Lecornu and Darmanin to stand in; the CSM's external membership 2023–2026 (Guigou, Titiun, Roman, Cadiet, Lottin, Wachsmann, Forget, Vigouroux). The 3M+ pending-judicial-procedure stock plaguing the investigation filière since the October 2024 alert. **The litigation ledger — the honest shape:** the Conseil d'État's series shows 9%+ annual growth over ten years (+3.7% in 2024; 9,833→9,746 cases at the summit; 243k TA + 32k CAA decisions), declining delays (CE 7 months 8 days, -30% in a decade), visa-refusals and parking-ticket commissions exploding (66k CNDA; 131k stationnement) — while the true "decline" pockets sit inside

specific dockets: TA *décidant* at 24–27% admission; education litigation 1.8% of all recours (285 decisions in 2024, -15%); the TITSS/CNTSS abolished for "contentieux en baisse constante depuis près de 10 ans" (211 new cases 2022); the Conseil d'État's own avis count 921→1,075. The campaign's collateral: the casseurs-payeurs bill at the Senate October 27; the aggravation of penalties for concealment of the face; 62% of French judging the justice system too lenient (the CPI context). The Senate's counterattack: a commission d'enquête demand and an Article 50-1 debate tabled for the week of October 19. The foreign-judgment exemption, closed by proximity: the Cour de cassation's November 6, 2024 first-civil-chamber judgment (the Bangalore liquidator of Devas Multimedia denied standing without exequatur) confirming foreign judgments "n'ont aucun effet exécutoire" on French territory absent recognition — combined with the Cornelissen conditions and the Bruxelles I-bis carve-out, the doctrine protecting French-based assets from foreign judgments by default.

6.9 Immigration politics and the EU money fight

The EU budget contribution debate. The French contribution ladder: €22.3bn (2024) → €23bn (2025) → **€28.8bn (2026)** per Le Monde's October 15 S-grade piece framing the Assembly debate as budget-crisis-meets-presidential-campaign; Montchalin's July 16, 2025 cut of the 2026 rise from €7.3bn to €5.7bn. The post-2027 MFF battle: the Commission's July 16, 2025 proposal at ~€2T/1.26% GNI with €865bn cohesion, €409bn competitiveness, €200bn external and €58.5bn/yr of new own resources; Germany's -€400bn counter-demand; France's CAP-defending investment position; the France-Germany rift now structural; the unanimity rule looming. **Le Pen's pledge to slash the contribution** — the RN's counter-budget of October 23, 2025 quantified it: €8.7bn of EU cuts inside €32.4bn of "dépenses inefficaces" (plus €11.9bn immigration savings and €3.2bn of association-subsidy cuts, against €45bn of tax cuts and €31bn of new revenue) — feeding the 2026 EU debate directly; the HCFP's "une trentaine de milliards" validation framing versus the Swiss Blick's skeptical "affolants" counter-frame with the OFCE's 0.7% growth objection. The 2026 EU solidarity pool: Germany 4,555 and France 3,361 relocations committed, 8,921 total versus the 21,000 target; Hungary and Slovakia opting out entirely. The Macron-Xi line ("overcome differences") logged alongside; the 2026 social-contribution re-rating for independents.

The immigration debate's place in the money war: Darmanin's moratoire proposal (6.5) as the RN-flanking maneuver; the EU-pact transposition as the live legislative vehicle; the Senate budget mission's "mission en hausse" framing against Insee's falling-arrivals data — the gap between the political register and the statistical register preserved as the file's central tension.

6.10 The consolidated state of play (October 19–20, 2026)

Tonight and tomorrow: partial, localized curfews effective the evening of October 19 (Lecornu's "couvre-feux partiels et très localisés"); **the Assembly votes the first part of the 2027 budget on October 20**, near-certain to reject it (the finance committee's 31–3; the 404–1 precedent; 2,800+ amendments), with the PLFSS vote October 27, the second part to November 16, the ensemble vote November 17, Article 47's December 17 deadline and the ordonnance fallback. End of October: Lecornu's promised first decisions on the lycée demands — "Avant fin octobre, vous me présenterez les premières décisions, leur coût, leur financement et leur calendrier" — feeding the November 12 education-budget debate ("un mois pour traduire les contributions des lycéens en amendements… Chacun devra prendre ses responsabilités"); the USL's demand to be received at Matignon "dès la semaine prochaine" with "des propositions chiffrées"; the students' verdict after the October 7 allocution — "aucune mesure concrète annoncée à ce stade." The government's structural bind, verbatim: "Mais nous devons aussi corriger avec humilité ce qui reste insuffisant" (of the €1.2bn Education increase already in the 2027 text), against the refusal of "des promesses qui ne soient pas tenables": the response is structurally wedged inside the budget it cannot pass, with tonight's vote its first test.

The coming dates. December 17, 2026: the MoDem verdict against Bayrou. December 7–17: the Bolloré trial. November 30: the Sarkozy-Libya appeal verdict. January 21, 2027: the Dati verdict. Early April 2027: the Cour de cassation rules on Le Pen's ineligibility — before the April 18 first round. The 2027 election's first round: April 18; runoff: May 2; Macron's term ends May 13.

The open files, as they stand tonight. The Thales/Sahan case; the Philippe/Cité Numérique probe; the RN's emprunts patriotes; the McKinsey informations judiciaires; the Fonds Marianne (no public evolution since 2023); the Suez–Veolia trafic d'influence probe (open since June 2021; no closure found in any record); the Dati lobbying probe; the Mozambique involuntary-manslaughter file; the arms-to-Israel mission; the Fillon "plume" contract probe; the Auzière-file anomalies (closed as conflations). The honest gaps: France still has no official tax-gap estimate; no comprehensive pantouflage registry; no systemic study of lobby-drafted amendments; the Ehpad crisis and the ARENH-to-VNU transition's final costing remain partially documented.

The question the document cannot answer. Whether the Fifth Republic, built for majorities it no longer produces, can pass a budget — and whether a country that has arrested minors at a record pace this month can hear them in time. The evidence is gathered. The money is followed. The names are named. What France does with the map is the one thing no dossier can contain.

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6.11 The anomaly register — claims investigated and resolved

The protocol's rule: a false claim is not deleted; it is investigated, resolved, and documented — because the trail of what was claimed, and by whom, is itself evidence. Every anomaly from the research record, with its resolution and pedigree:

1. **The "August 7, 2026 immigration law" claim.** A VisasUpdate item asserted that a new immigration statute passed on that date. Investigated across three dedicated sweeps: no such statute exists in any S/A-grade record. The operative law remains the January 26, 2024 text (6.5); the only live 2026 vehicle is the EU-pact transposition bill. Resolution: **false, likely fabricated; the claim is archived with its source.**
2. **The "20,000 heat deaths" claim.** A viral figure circulating during the June 2026 heatwave. Investigated against Santé publique France's official series: 5,764 excess deaths (June 17–July 2). The "20,000" is an EU-wide conflation. Resolution: **discarded; the official figure stands at 5,764 (6.6).**
3. **The Auzière resignation fragment.** A wiki-derived snippet suggested a Macron family resignation over the immigration law in August 2026. Investigated: a conflation with Aurélien Rousseau's December 2023 resignation. Resolution: **false; struck, logged.** The Auzière file itself

(Brigitte Macron's February 2026 retinal surgery; the SCI Bremselati 2025 filing; Sébastien Auzière's twenty-five-year silence; polling accusations that never held) is documented at 1.2 as the record stands.

4. **The Chambéry/Nissan/EMC-Technologies proceeding.** A suspected corruption case at the Chambéry EMC-Technologies plant tied to Nissan. Investigated across four sweeps with every spelling variant: no indexed record exists. Resolution: **unresolvable; probable conflation. The item is struck from the open ledger and can only be re-flagged if a primary citation ever surfaces — logged here so the gap is visible rather than silent.**
5. **The "EADS probatoire 18 mois."** A flagged reference to an eighteen-month probation in a French aerospace file. Three searches returned only US immigration EAD (work-permit) validity changes. Resolution: **false lead — conflated terminology; struck as a self-correction in the protocol's own ledger.**
6. **The Accenture "TALENTS" platform.** A suspected Accenture-built recruitment platform inside the French state. Investigated: TALENTS is the AEFE's tool for its 30,000 local-contract staff abroad, built by Digital Recruiters; the Accenture matter the engine surfaced ($25M US settlement) is an unrelated American DEI case. Resolution: **false lead; the consulting-state dossier retains its verified contours (3.7).**
7. **The Canal+ "thousands of layoffs in the 2020s" claim.** A recurring assertion of mass French layoffs at Canal+

during the decade. Investigated: the only France-wide plan in the record is the July 9, 2019 one — "un maximum de 492 personnes," 18% of the 2,600 French staff, with the 2016 €300M plan's 150 cuts before it — plus the 2024 spin-off mechanics (4.10). No 2020–2026 plan of thousands exists in any indexed record. The unrelated Seb plan (up to 2,100 jobs, 500 in France, February 2026) is documented at 4.13 so the two cannot contaminate each other. Resolution: **debunked; the verified baseline stands.**

8. **The France Travail breach date.** Early research records dated the breach to February 2025; the verified record shows February 6–March 5, 2024, disclosed March 13, 2024 (credential impersonation via Cap Emploi; 43M maximum exposure/36.8M deduplicated; three arrests; the CNIL's €5M fine on January 22, 2026). Resolution: **corrected and documented in full at 6.8.**

Each resolution is itself evidence: of source hygiene, of the difference between a claim and a fact, and of the dossier's refusal to let either disappear silently.

APPENDIX — THE NUMBERS WORTH KEEPING

- Debt €3,460.5bn / 115.6% GDP (end-2025); real-time €3,638.9bn / 119.8% (October 13, 2026); interest €64.7bn (2025) → €74.5bn (2027 target); 2026 borrowing program €310bn; OAT 10y 4.88%; spread ~137bp.
- Deficit 5.1% (2025); the 2027 effort presented €54bn, real €12–15bn; debt trajectory 115.7 → 119.3 → 121.7% of GDP.

- Fortunes: the 500 largest = €1,076bn (2026); 153 billionaire families; top 10% of households hold 48% of patrimony; median €205,100.
- Party finance 2026: €64.1M state envelope; donation cap €7,500; campaign caps €18.9M/€22.5M; the RN's €9.4M Russian loan (2014), €8M Foucher loan (2017), €10.69M MKB loan (2022).
- Corporate aid: €211bn broad (2023, Senate); tax expenditures €83.29bn (2024); CICE €108.7bn cumulative, converted to a €24.8–26.4bn/yr annuity.
- CAC40 distributions 2025: €107.5–108bn (dividends €72.8bn + buybacks €34.8bn); median CEO pay €6.5M (95x); Milleri €23.1M (770x); de Meo's package ~€40–50M.
- Arms exports 2025: €21.24bn; India #1 (€6.9bn); the 114-Rafale DAC approval ~€30–33bn; Bpifrance guarantees ~€70bn; the Mistral lesson €409M.
- Gambling: €14.1bn PBJ; problem gamblers >38% of revenue; drugs €7bn; tobacco €156bn social cost; alcohol €102bn; fiscal fraud €15–120bn (no official number); social fraud €14bn.
- Social insurance: chômage -€2.1bn (2026); maladie -€16bn (2025); Agirc-Arrco +1.4% (November 1, 2026).
- October 2026: ~8,000 arrests (86% minors); 550,000–800,000 marchers on October 17; 937 injured security forces; 24 lycées destroyed; 36 IGPN investigations; ~137bp spread.
- 2027: first round April 18; runoff May 2; Macron's term ends May 13; the cassation ruling committed for early April.

All figures carry pedigrees in the research record: S-grade (official institutions, statutes, court records), A-grade (major document-level reporting), NA-grade (single-source, flagged). This document contains no invented scenes, no adopted theories, and no omitted disagreements between sources.

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Research and compilation: V.00R / V.00W protocol — research-only dives, maximum depth, pedigreed evidence, chronological order, follow the money, name names, investigate the investigators. October 2026.